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Two women among 9 held, cops bust interstate heroin syndicate



NATION: Pg 5

Health Ministry directs states, UTs to bolster surveillance amid Ebola outbreak



FILM: Pg 14

Lupita dismisses racist backlash over her casting in 'The Odyssey'

After Modi, Shah meet, Bengal CM Suwendu vows crackdown on corruption, infiltration

'CENTRE TO PROVIDE RS 39,000 CRORE THROUGH JAL SHAKTI MINISTRY'

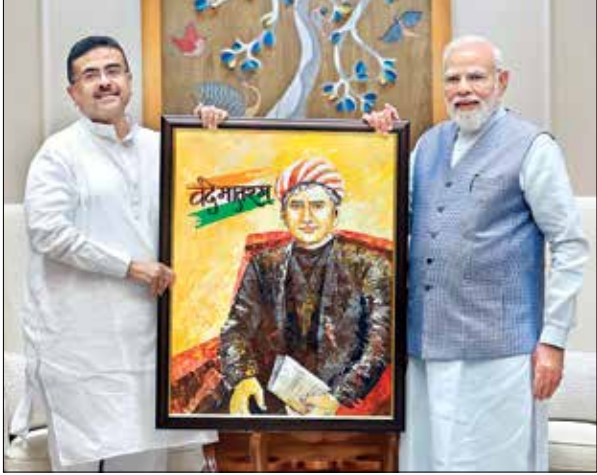
SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Following the meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home minister Amit Shah on Friday, West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari outlined an aggressive governance agenda focusing on corruption probes, border security, implementation of central schemes, healthcare reforms and closer coordination with the Centre.

Speaking to reporters at Banga Bhawan, Adhikari said his government would reopen and pursue all major corruption cases that surfaced during the previous regime.

"The previous government did not allow central agencies to investigate cases like the teacher recruitment scam, corruption matters and the RG Kar case. We have allowed that. All corruption cases will be investigated," he said.

The Chief Minister also reiterated his government's headline position on illegal infiltration and border man-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah meet West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari, in New Delhi



ANI

agement. "There is no need to spend taxpayers' money on keeping infiltrators in jails. They will be deported as soon as they are caught," he said, adding that the state would not bear the cost of detention centres for undocumented migrants.

The new government has already announced measures

to strengthen border management, including a 45-day deadline for handing over land required for pending border fencing projects to the BSF. The state has also proposed transferring suspected illegal migrants detained by state and railway police to the BSF.

On development projects,

Adhikari said the Centre had assured substantial financial support to Bengal. "The Centre will provide Rs 39,000 crore through the Jal Shakti Ministry, and projects worth Rs 35,000 crore have already been sanctioned," he said.

He added that pending issues related to central welfare scheme allocations,

stalled partly over renaming disputes, would soon be resolved.

Healthcare reforms also featured prominently in Adhikari's announcements. He said a meeting between the state government and the Union Health Ministry would be held on Saturday

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CLOSER LOOK

» Adhikari said his government would reopen and pursue all major corruption cases linked to the previous regime, including the teacher recruitment scam and the RG Kar case

» The Chief Minister reiterated a hard-line stance on illegal infiltration, stating that suspected undocumented migrants would be deported quickly instead of being kept in detention centres at public expense

» Adhikari announced that the Centre would provide Rs 39,000 crore through the Jal Shakti Ministry, while projects worth Rs 35,000 crore had already been sanctioned for Bengal

» Adhikari confirmed the implementation of Ayushman Bharat in West Bengal and announced discussions with the Union Health Ministry regarding the proposed 'Ayushman Mandir' initiative

SC refers UAPA bail law dispute to larger bench for clarity

Grants interim bail to 2 accused

TAKEAWAYS

» Issue concerns prolonged incarceration versus strict bail limits under Section 43D(5).

» Court defended January denial of bail to Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam

» Judges said denial followed accused-specific

» Right to SPEEDY TRIAL remains a constitutional safeguard against indefinite detention



assessment, not rejection of Article 21 protections

» Court said K A Najeeb does not guarantee automatic bail after trial delays

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday referred to a larger bench the legal question of how courts should deal with bail pleas under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act when accused persons face long periods of incarceration before trial, while granting interim bail to two accused in the 2020 Delhi riots conspiracy case and revisiting the debate triggered by its earlier refusal to release Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam.

A bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and P B Varale granted six months' interim bail to Abdul Khalid Saifi and Tasleem Ahmad, both under-trial prisoners in the Delhi riots larger conspiracy case, while making clear that the broader issue of whether prolonged detention can override the strict bail restrictions under Section 43D(5) of the UAPA requires an authoritative ruling by a larger bench.

The court said the controversy had arisen because two benches of equal strength in the Supreme Court appeared to have taken differing approaches to the question of bail under anti-terror laws, particularly in relation to the 2021 K A Najeeb judgment, which held that constitutional courts can grant bail in UAPA cases where the right

HC grants Umar 3-day interim bail to meet mother before surgery

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Friday granted Umar Khalid three days of interim bail in the February 2020 northeast Delhi riots larger conspiracy case under the UAPA, allowing him to meet his mother before her surgery. A bench of Justices Prathiba M Singh and Madhu Jain said it was taking an "empathetic view" and allowed release from June 1 to 3. Delhi Police had suggested a police-escorted visit, calling the surgery minor. Khalid's 15-day plea was earlier rejected by a trial court. The riots left 53 dead and over 700 injured. The Supreme Court had upheld denial of regular bail in January. MPOST

to speedy trial is violated.

The development follows sharp observations earlier this week by another Supreme Court bench of Justices Ujjal

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RBI hands govt record Rs 2.87L cr dividend amid West Asia conflict

Not in favour of rate hikes to defend rupee, prioritises inflation

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India on Friday approved a record surplus transfer of Rs 2.87 lakh crore to the central government for the financial year ended March 2026, handing the exchequer a major fiscal cushion at a time when the economy is facing higher import costs, volatile oil prices and supply chain strain linked to the West Asia conflict. The pay-

KEY POINTS

- » Payout is 6.7 per cent higher than last year's Rs 2.69 lakh crore
- » RBI's net income rose to Rs 3.96 lakh crore in FY26
- » Balance sheet expanded over 20 per cent to Rs

91.97 lakh crore

- » Contingent Risk Buffer set at 6.5 per cent of balance sheet
- » Financial conditions, crude oil prices challenges for external sector outlook: RBI article

out, larger than last year's Rs 2.69 lakh crore, comes as policymakers weigh how to man-

age pressure on the rupee and inflation without resorting to sharp

Continued on P4

CONDITIONS MAY PREVAIL TILL MAY 28

Unforgiving heat in most places as 97 of world's 100 hottest cities fall in India

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi: A punishing heat-wave continued to grip large parts of India on Friday, with temperatures staying above 40 degrees Celsius across many regions even where there was slight relief, while heavy rain triggered flash floods in Arunachal Pradesh and weather agencies warned of more extreme conditions in the days ahead. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) said heatwave to severe heatwave conditions are likely to per-



A man pours water on his face to beat the heat on a hot summer day, in Bhubaneswar, Friday

PTI

sist across the plains of northwest, central and east India, along with parts of peninsular India, over the next six to seven days, even as some hill

states saw rain, thunderstorms and snowfall.

Data from AQL.in showed the scale of the heat, with 97 of the world's 100 hottest cities on Friday afternoon located in India. At 2:50 pm IST, Balangir in Odisha topped the list at 48 degrees Celsius, followed by Sasaram in Bihar at 48 degrees and Varanasi in Uttar Pradesh at 47 degrees. The only non-Indian cities in the top 100 were Dhangadhi, Nepalgunj and Lumbini Sanskritik in Nepal, where temperatures ranged from 45 to 46

Continued on P4

Tulsi Gabbard quits as US Intelligence chief, citing husband's health

WASHINGTON: Tulsi Gabbard resigned as President Donald Trump's director of national intelligence on Friday, saying she needed to step away as her husband battles cancer. She is the fourth Cabinet official to depart during Trump's second term.



In her resignation letter, which she posted on social media, Gabbard said she told Trump she would leave office on June 30. She said her husband had recently been diagnosed with a rare form of bone cancer and "faces major challenges in the coming weeks and months."

"At this time, I must step away from public service to be by his side and fully support him through this battle," she wrote in the letter, which was earlier reported by Fox News.

AGENCIES

EC announces polls for 26 RS seats on June 18; NDA likely to lose one seat

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The NDA is likely to lose one Rajya Sabha seat in the biennial elections for 26 seats in 12 states across the country, while the Congress-led opposition is set to gain three. The Election Commission has announced elections for the Rajya Sabha seats falling vacant following the completion of the six-year term of sitting members, while two seats are being filled through bypolls after resignations.

Among the prominent leaders whose terms are ending are former Prime Minister HD Deve Gowda, Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, senior Congress leader Digvijaya Singh, Union Minister George Kurian and BJP leader and Union Minister Ravneet Singh Bittu.

Continued on P4

Will bring back Bengal deportees from Bangladesh for citizenship check: Centre to Supreme Court

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: The Supreme Court on Friday recorded an assurance from the Union government that certain Bengali-speaking individuals deported to Bangladesh on suspicion of being illegal migrants would be brought back to India for verification of their citizenship claims.

The matter relates to Sunali Khatun, her husband Danish Sheikh and their son Sabir Sheikh, besides Sweety Bibi and her two sons, Kurban and Imam. While the Centre had

earlier agreed to bring back Sunali Khatun, who was then pregnant, and her son on humanitarian grounds, the present assurance concerns the remaining persons whose citizenship claims are yet to be verified.

A bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Justice Joymalya Bagchi and Justice Vipul Pancholi was hearing petitions filed by the Centre challenging the High Court's directions ordering their repatriation.

Appearing for the Union government,

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THREE NEPALI CLIMBERS HAD DIED EARLIER

Tragedy strikes Everest summit as two Indians die while descending

MPOST BUREAU

KATHMANDU: Two Indian mountaineers died while descending Mount Everest after reaching the summit, Nepalese officials said on Friday, taking the death toll on the world's highest peak to five in the current climbing season as record traffic and crowding renew concerns about safety on the mountain. The climbers, identified as Arun Kumar Tiwari and Sandeep Are, became critically exhausted during their descent despite rescue efforts by Sherpa guides. Their deaths came during a season that has seen unprecedented climbing numbers, with hundreds of permits issued and a record one-day summit total from the Nepal side.

Rishi Bhandari, secretary general of the Expedition Operators Association of Nepal, said Are reached the

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The deceased were identified as Arun Kumar Tiwari and Sandeep Are
- » Are summited Everest on Wednesday before falling ill during descent
- » Tiwari reached the summit Thursday at around 5.30 pm
- » Both climbers suffered severe exhaustion despite repeated rescue attempts by Sherpa guides
- » Are died after being brought down

8,848.86-metre summit on Wednesday, while Tiwari summited on Thursday at around 5.30 pm.

According to expedition officials,



Arun Kumar Tiwari Sandeep Are

to Camp II early Friday

- » Tiwari died near the Hillary Step during descent assistance efforts
- » Authorities are working to bring both bodies back to Kathmandu

Are fell ill during his descent after reaching the summit. Nivesh Karki, director at Pioneer Adventures, which organised the

Continued on P4

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: The Madhya Pradesh government on Friday handed over the investigation into the alleged dowry death of Twisha Sharma to the CBI, while her husband and main accused, Samarth Singh, was taken into custody by Jabalpur police after arriving at the district court to surrender.

Meanwhile, the Madhya Pradesh High Court



Samarth Singh surrenders before a court in Jabalpur

ANI

ordered a second autopsy to be conducted by a specialised AIIMS Delhi team, following a request by her family.

The court also issued a notice to Twisha's mother-in-law, Giribala Singh, a former district judge, on pleas seeking cancellation of her bail over alleged non-cooperation with the police.

The decision to recommend a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe came a day after Twisha Sharma's family met Chief Minister Mohan Yadav and sought a central agency investigation into the case.

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HC ORDERS SECOND AUTOPSY

MP govt hands over Twisha dowry death case to CBI; husband taken into custody

CBI arrests Pune-based lecturer for 'leaking' NEET UG physics paper

NEW DELHI: The CBI arrested Pune lecturer Manisha Sanjay Havaladar for allegedly leaking NEET UG 2026 physics questions. The agency said she accessed the paper as an NTA expert and shared questions with co-accused Manisha Mandhare. NEET was cancelled after the May 3 exam. Eleven arrests have been made; retest is on June 21. See P5

Why reservation for children of IAS officers, asks Top Court

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday raised broader questions about whether children from families that have already achieved social and economic advancement through reservation should continue to receive benefits under the Other Backward Classes (OBC) quota, while hearing a case involving a Karnataka candidate denied reservation benefits on creamy layer grounds. Justice BV Nagarathna observed that educational and financial progress often leads to social mobility, questioning whether reservation should continue across generations in such cases.

A bench of Justices BV Nagarathna and Ujjal Bhuyan was hearing a petition challenging a Karnataka High Court ruling that upheld the exclusion of a candidate from OBC reservation after authorities found him to be part of the creamy layer.

The bench said that if reservation continued in such cases, "we will never get out of it."

The case concerns a candidate from the Kuruba community, listed under Category II(A) among Karnataka's backward classes, who had been selected as Assistant Engineer (Electrical) in Karnataka Power Transmission Corporation Limited under the reserved category. However, the District Caste and Income Verification Committee refused to issue a caste validity certificate, saying his family fell within the creamy layer.

The candidate's annual family income was assessed at about Rs 19.48 lakh. Authorities noted that both his parents are government employees and that

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DRUGS WORTH Rs 16 CRORE SEIZED

Two women among 9 held, cops bust interstate heroin syndicate

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has busted an interstate narcotics syndicate, arresting nine people and seizing heroin and crude opium worth around Rs 16 crore, an official said on Friday.

Police said a Rohini team unearthed a drug supply network operating between Manipur and Delhi-NCR while probing a case registered at Budh Vihar police station under the NDPS Act.

According to police, 1,568 grams of heroin and 506 grams of crude opium, capable of producing around 1.5 to 2 kilograms of heroin, were recovered during the operation.

A bike and a car allegedly used for transporting narcotics were also seized.

“The probe began after the arrest of Sameer Ahmed, 21, and Ashish Soni, 29, on April 17, with 300 grams of heroin. A team later arrested Manoj Soni alias Vicky, identified



as the source supplier to the duo,” Joint Commissioner of Police (Northern Range) Vijay Singh said. During interrogation, Soni shared details about other members of the supply chain, following which police raided Tilak Nagar on April 21 and arrested Sandhya (30) with around 278 grams of heroin.

Police said Sandhya was allegedly part of a family-based drug trafficking syndicate. Her husband, identified as Vicky alias Aakash, is currently lodged in jail in an NDPS

case and has previous criminal involvement, while her mother-in-law is also in jail in a narcotics case, police said.

“Further investigation led police teams to Bareilly in Uttar Pradesh, where Mehnaz alias Bezi (51), was arrested on May 7 with 58 grams of heroin. She was allegedly an active supplier in the Bareilly region and had previous involvement in two NDPS cases,” the officer said.

At Mehnaz’s instance, police arrested Yunus from Shahjahanpur in Uttar Pradesh

TAKEAWAYS

» Police said Sandhya was allegedly part of a family-based drug trafficking syndicate

» Her husband, identified as Vicky alias Aakash, is currently lodged in jail in an NDPS case and has previous criminal involvement, said police

on May 12 and recovered 578 grams of heroin from him. Yunus, who also has two previous NDPS cases against him, was described by police as a major interstate heroin supplier and a crucial link in the syndicate.

“Yunus disclosed that he procured crude opium from Manipur and refined it at his residence to prepare heroin for supply in Delhi-NCR. Based on his disclosure, a police team travelled to Imphal on May 20 and conducted raids

in several areas of Manipur to identify the source suppliers. During surveillance, two accused -- Mohammad Istafam (28) and Phundreimayum Amjad Ali (34) -- were apprehended while allegedly delivering crude opium in a Bolero vehicle,” he said.

Police said 506 grams of crude opium were recovered from a hidden cavity inside the gearbox of the vehicle. The substance was identified as raw latex extracted from the opium poppy and commonly used in the preparation of heroin. Earlier, another accused, Sabbir, a resident of Barabanki in Uttar Pradesh, was arrested on May 17 with 300 grams of heroin. Police said he was an active member of the interstate supplier syndicate.

Police said the arrests helped them expose the linkage of the narcotics network and uncover an important interstate supply chain operating from Manipur to Delhi through Uttar Pradesh.

Woman dies by suicide after citing torture by her in-laws

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NOIDA: A 32-year-old woman allegedly died after consuming a poisonous substance in Greater Noida, and her husband has been arrested on charges of abetment to suicide, police said on Friday.

The incident comes close on the heels of an alleged dowry-related death of a 24-year-old woman, Deepika Nagar, in a Greater Noida village last Sunday and months after another alleged dowry death in Greater Noida in August 2025, when a woman identified as Nikki Bhati was allegedly set ablaze by her husband and in-laws over a demand for Rs 36 lakh.

The deceased, identified as Sonika Bhati, was originally from Bulandshahr and had a love marriage with Subhash Sharma around 12 years ago, police said. According to the police, Sonika’s father, Rakesh Singh, alleged that his daughter was being subjected to physical and mental harassment by her husband and in-laws. He told the police that Sonika had called him on May 20 and told him about the alleged harassment. Police said that on Thursday, Subhash informed

Shalimar Bagh: Teen caretaker found dead at employer’s house

NEW DELHI: An 18-year-old woman working as a caretaker in a Shalimar Bagh house here allegedly died by suicide inside a locked room, an official said on Friday.

Police are investigating whether her family’s opposition to her marrying the man of her choice drove her to allegedly kill self, the official said. The victim’s family members suspected foul play and demanded a fair probe.

“It looked like someone killed her and then hanged her. Police must investigate the matter properly and check CCTV footage of the home where she worked,” they said.

A police officer said, “During preliminary inquiry, it was found that the room where the woman was working was

locked from the inside. The homeowner later broke down the door and rushed her to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared her brought dead.” Police said the deceased was employed as a caretaker in Northwest Delhi area.

“The woman was acquainted with a 20-year-old man, a resident of Azadpur, and she had expressed her desire to marry him, but her family members had opposed the relationship,” the officer said. Police said they are examining all angles and recording statements of the family members. The victim’s sister said she had left home for work around 9:30 am. Later, they received a call from her employer informing them about her death, she said. PTI

Rakesh Singh to come to the Government Institute of Medical Sciences (GIMS) hospital in Greater Noida, where he found his daughter had passed away

after allegedly consuming a poisonous substance.

Kasna Police Station officials said that further investigation is underway.

2007 JAMIA NAGAR RIOTING

Court discharges 12, slams probe, frames charges against 13

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Friday discharged 12 surviving accused in the 2007 Jamia Nagar rioting case, rapping the prosecution for “concocted investigation” having “stock involvement of police witnesses” for identification, while terming several arrests as “contrived and pre-determined”.

In a 95-page order, Special Judge Vishal Gogne, who also ordered framing of charges against 13 accused, further slammed Delhi Police for serious lapses, particularly the failure to conduct a test identification parade, which he termed a “requirement of essence and not just prudence”.

According to the prosecution, on September 22, 2007, a riotous mob of around 1,500 people attacked the Jamia Nagar police post personnel.

It said the local police had taken steps to remove a market which was creating a hindrance to people going for offering Namaz during the month of Ramzan.

The prosecution claimed that 12 local leaders instigated the mob to kill the policeman

and burn down the police station, following which the post was set ablaze, several vehicles were torched, a service pistol, 10 live cartridges, valuables and a wireless set were looted, and multiple police officials were injured, of whom five suffered grievous injuries.

The judge rapped the prosecution while discharging the accused persons. He said, “In the present investigation, it does weigh with the court that not only did the police officials avoid conducting a test identification parade (TIP) of the 11 persons who were arrested at the identification of at least two police persons each; the investigating officer (IO) even failed to consider the possibility of seeking arrest upon identification by one police witness while enabling TIP through the second police witness.” The judge said the absence of TIP proceedings, lack of public witnesses and generic police statements created serious doubts over the arrests, adding that the evidence against the 13 accused fell short of establishing “grave suspicion”. PTI

GZB: Two elderly men found dead

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: Two elderly men were found dead inside a flat near DLF Colony in Ghaziabad’s Shalimar Garden on Friday, police said. The deceased were identified as Rakesh Sharma (75) and his caretaker Nempal Singh (60). Residents alerted police after noticing a foul smell from the flat. Officials said the

bodies appeared to be four to five days old and no external injury marks were found.

Police suspect natural causes behind the deaths. Sharma, originally from Delhi’s Welcome area, had been bedridden due to prolonged illness, while Nempal, who lived with him, worked as his caretaker. The bodies have been sent for postmortem examination.

Minor girl raped & blackmailed with videos of the act; man held

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 13-year-old girl was allegedly raped by a 30-year-old man here, who apparently recorded the act and later blackmailed her with the clips, subjecting her to repeated sexual assault, police sources said on Friday.

The accused was arrested after the victim’s family lodged a complaint on May 21, with police registering an FIR under charges of rape, criminal intimidation and provisions of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, a source said.

The incident took place in northeast Delhi’s Khajuri Khas area.

“The victim had recently shifted to a rented accommodation in Khajuri Khas area with her family. The girl’s family in their statement alleged



Using the videos to threaten her, the accused continued to sexually assault the 13-yr-old girl

that she came in contact with the accused as the latter frequently visited her sister, who lived in the same building where the girl stayed earlier,” the source said.

The accused later approached the girl on social media. Subsequently, the two

started meeting each other. The girl alleged the accused first took her to a friend’s house and later to a factory where he raped her and recorded videos of the act.

“Using the videos to threaten her, the accused allegedly continued to sexually assault the minor at different locations,” the source added.

The matter came to light after the accused allegedly misbehaved with the girl in front of his friends, following which the traumatised girl narrated the ordeal to her mother.

Based on the complaint, police arrested the accused and initiated further investigation.

A police officer said efforts are underway to recover electronic evidence, including the purported videos which were allegedly used to blackmail the girl.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has busted an illegal forex trading call centre operating from Indore in Madhya Pradesh and arrested six people allegedly involved in duping victims across the country through fake online investment schemes, an official said on Friday.

According to the police, the accused allegedly ran a sophisticated fraud operation using a fake trading platform to lure people into investing in forex and online trading products by showing fabricated profits and trading gains.

Police said the syndicate cheated victims out of around Rs 1 crore by convincing them to invest in gold, silver, Nifty, Bank Nifty, and cryptocurrency-linked assets.

“The operation was unearthed during an investi-

gation into a complaint filed on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (NCRP), who alleged that a woman induced him to invest in forex trading,” the officer said.

Police said the victim was repeatedly persuaded to transfer money under various pretexts, including leverage charges, GST, penalties, TDS and account unlocking fees. During the investigation, it was found that the complainant had transferred more than Rs 10.5 lakh into multiple bank accounts allegedly operated by the fraudsters, they said.

“A team carried out technical surveillance, mobile tracking, IMEI analysis and scrutiny of financial transactions before tracing the network to Indore,” the officer said.

Based on inputs and local intelligence, police conducted a raid at the scamster’s place in

Indore’s RNT Marg, where they allegedly found a fully operational illegal call centre.

Police said 41 people, including 35 tele-callers, were present at the office and were actively contacting potential victims and persuading them to invest money through the fake trading platform.

The six arrested accused were identified as Kartik Aggarwal, alleged mastermind and owner of the operation; Raja Aggarwal, co-owner of the call centre; and team leaders Harsh Keshre, Nikhil Bhale, Deepak Umah and Vipin Yadav.

Police said the syndicate used fake identities, mule accounts and layered banking channels to evade detection, while victims were lured through fake trading profits. Cash, foreign currency and digital equipment were seized.

Delhi signs MoU with SBI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi e-Governance Society (DeGS) under the IT Department of the Delhi government has signed an MoU with the State Bank of India (SBI) to introduce an integrated e-payment system, ‘e-Pay’, on the Delhi Government eProcurement Portal. The initiative aims to streamline online tender payments and make the procurement process faster, transparent and efficient.

Officials said the system will automate several manual payment processes, reduce delays and improve accountability in government tenders. A key feature is the integration of Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) functionality, enabling real-time payment verification and eliminating the need for physical demand drafts, making the

‘The system will automate several manual payment processes, reduce delays and improve accountability in government tender’

process paperless for bidders.

The partnership with SBI will provide secure digital payment support and MIS integration across the procurement ecosystem. IT Minister Dr Pankaj Kumar Singh said the initiative reflects the government’s push towards digital governance, transparency and ease of doing business under Chief Minister Rekha Gupta’s technology-driven administration.

Overnight protest by DU women’s hostel residents leads to extension

NEW DELHI: A late-night sit-in protest by women students residing at the University Hostel for Women (UHW) of Delhi University (DU) led to success on Friday after the hostel administration agreed to extend the residency deadline till June 30 and assured restoration of basic amenities.

The protest held on the intervening night of Thursday and Friday, was sparked by issues related to drinking water shortage, non functional air conditioners, and concerns over hotel residency rules, students said.

A member from the UHW Residents’ Association said that several final year students are preparing for NET exami-



A protest had earlier been held over the same issues, including inadequate drinking water...

nations scheduled for the end of June, while Delhi University semester examinations are also underway.

“Despite paying hostel fees till June, students were told they

would have to pay Rs 450 per day if they stayed beyond seven days after examinations,” the student said.

The member added that a protest had earlier been held on May 16 over the same issues, including inadequate drinking water and malfunctioning air conditioners in the mess.

“We were verbally assured that the problems would be resolved within seven days, but there was no progress,” the student said. Another hostel resident, Anshika Kumari, a PhD student in DU’s Hindi department, said students had been facing irregular water supply, poor-quality drinking water, and insufficient seating in the reading room for months. PTI

AHEAD OF BAKRID

Police steps up security arrangements

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has stepped up security arrangements across the national capital ahead of Eid-ul-Azha (Bakrid), with intensified foot patrolling, vehicle checking, picket inspections and a series of Aman Committee meetings being conducted across multiple districts, officials said on Friday. Police said community-outreach programmes, guard briefings and coordination meetings are being organised to ensure peaceful celebrations during the festival.

In Shahdara district, a meeting was held at the office of the deputy commissioner of police (DCP), where senior officers interacted with local representatives and community members, asking them to adhere to government norms and regulations.

“Special emphasis was laid on three



key elements -- coordination, vigilance and public participation -- to ensure that the festival is celebrated in a peaceful and harmonious atmosphere,” a senior police officer from Shahdara said.

Officers urged residents to maintain communal harmony and immediately report any suspicious activity or rumour-mongering.

In East Delhi, police have conducted interactive meetings with resident welfare associations (RWAs) and market welfare associations (MWAs) at several

places as part of confidence-building measures ahead of the festival.

“Station house officers (SHOs) are holding separate Aman Committee meetings, while personnel are organising Prahri meetings at multiple locations,” an officer from East district said.

The meetings are aimed at strengthening coordination with local residents, traders and volunteers to ensure peaceful celebrations and smooth management of public movement during the festival period, the officer added.

The Northeast district police, assisted by additional forces, has also intensified foot patrolling in sensitive areas and crowded markets.

Delhi Police intensified patrolling, vehicle checks and security deployment across markets, religious places and transport hubs, while the Delhi government banned public slaughter and sacrifice of protected animals during Bakrid.

GGM: Rapido cab driver arrested for ‘obscene act’ with woman passenger

OUR CORRESPONDENT

GURUGRAM: A Rapido cab driver has been arrested for allegedly masturbating in the presence of a woman passenger in a moving cab in Gurugram, police said on Friday.

The driver was identified as Vijay Kumar (23), a resident of Banihari village in Uttar Pradesh’s Prayagraj district. Police have seized the cab and are questioning him. He will be produced before a court on Saturday, officials said.

According to police, the complainant lives in Gurugram and works as a software engineer in a logistics company.

At around 8:15 am on Thursday, she booked a cab through the Rapido app to go to work.

Woman recorded a video of the incident and asked the driver to stop the vehicle. After she got out of the cab, the accused fled

Shortly after she boarded the vehicle, the driver allegedly unzipped his trousers, exposed himself and began masturbating in her presence while the cab was in motion, police said.

The woman recorded a video of the incident on her mobile phone and asked the driver to stop the vehicle. After she got out of the cab, the accused fled the spot,

police said. The woman informed the Police Control Room and shared the video with police personnel after they reached the spot.

An FIR was registered on her complaint and the investigation handed over to Inspector Suman, Station House Officer (SHO) of the women’s police station at Sector 51, the officials said.

Using technical surveillance and the cab-booking details, police traced the accused and arrested him from the Bhondsi area within two hours of the incident, they added. During questioning, the accused admitted that he worked as a cab driver on the Rapido platform and had picked up the complainant on Thursday morning, police said. Further investigation is underway.

IMD ISSUES ORANGE ALERT TILL MAY 27

Heatwave tightens grip on Delhi-NCR

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi-NCR is expected to remain under intense heatwave conditions until May 27, with the India Meteorological Department (IMD) issuing an orange alert for the national capital and surrounding regions. The prolonged spell of extreme heat has pushed temperatures well above normal, while unusually hot nights have added to public health concerns across the city.

According to the IMD, Delhi recorded its first “warm night” of the season on Thursday. The minimum temperature at Safdarjung, considered the city’s official weather station, settled at 31.9 degrees Celsius, which was 5.2 degrees above the seasonal average. It was also the hottest May night recorded in Delhi in the last 14 years. Earlier warm night conditions this year were observed on April 9 and 10.

Meteorologists classify a “warm night” when the day-



time maximum temperature crosses 40 degrees Celsius in the plains and the night temperature remains at least 4.5 degrees above normal. A heatwave is declared when the maximum temperature exceeds 40 degrees Celsius and remains 4.5 degrees above normal, or when it crosses

45 degrees Celsius. Severe heatwave conditions are recorded when temperatures are at least 6.5 degrees above the average.

The IMD has warned that both daytime and nighttime temperatures are likely to remain extremely uncomfortable over the next few days. The

continuing heat has increased the risk of dehydration, heat exhaustion and heatstroke, especially among outdoor workers, elderly residents and people with existing health conditions.

Delhi reported its first major heatstroke case of the season on Thursday when a 24-year-

HIGHLIGHTS

» The prolonged spell of extreme heat has pushed temperatures well above normal, while unusually hot nights have added to public health concerns across the city

» According to the IMD, Delhi recorded its first ‘warm night’ of the season on Thursday. It was also the hottest May night recorded in Delhi in the last 14 years

old man travelling by train was admitted unconscious to Dr Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital. Hospitals across the city have started strengthening emergency preparedness as patient inflow related to heat stress is expected to rise. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the Delhi

government has activated relief measures in “mission mode” to reduce the impact of the heatwave. She stated that 13 mobile heat relief units are operating across crowded areas of the city, distributing cold drinking water, oral rehydration solution packets, first aid supplies, cotton towels and caps to residents. Medical experts have also urged people to remain cautious during the ongoing weather conditions. Doctors warned that dehydration and electrolyte imbalance can become life-threatening if ignored. They have advised people to drink sufficient fluids, avoid prolonged sun exposure and completely stay away from alcohol during the heatwave period. The continuing spell of extreme temperatures has once again highlighted the growing challenge of climate-linked weather events in densely populated urban centres like Delhi-NCR, where concrete infrastructure and pollution often worsen heat stress.



Delhi’s 100-park OXYGEN PLAN

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Amid rising pollution levels in the capital, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday announced plans to develop 100 “oxygen parks” across the city, aimed at increasing green cover and improving public health. The announcement was made during the foundation stone laying of a three-acre green park in Mukmelpur village of Burari.

Laying the foundation stone, the Chief Minister said the Mukmelpur project reflects the government’s broader vision of combining environment protection with community well-being. “The Mukmelpur park would not merely serve as a green zone but would emerge as a centre for health, social interaction and positive living for local residents,” she said.

The project, spread across nearly three acres, has been sanctioned Rs 1 crore by the Forest Department, while an additional Rs 1 crore will be provided from the Chief Minister’s MLA discretionary fund. Gupta directed officials to ensure the park is developed with modern amenities and high-quality landscaping, making it a model green space for the region.

Designed as an eco-friendly public space, the park will include walking tracks, energy-efficient decorative lighting, seating huts, a landscaped pond, green lawns and hundreds of trees. Once completed, it is expected to benefit residents of Mukmelpur as well as

nearby villages including Jindpur, Bakhtawarpur and Hiranki.

Highlighting the government’s environmental priorities, the Chief Minister said, “Alongside building modern infrastructure, protecting the environment and improving citizens’ quality of life remain key priorities of the government’s vision for a developed Delhi.” She also reiterated the target of planting 14 lakh saplings this year under various greening initiatives.

Referring to Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s campaign, she added that the government is committed to “Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam” and translating the vision of environmental protection and a developed India-developed Delhi into reality.”

The Delhi BJP spokesperson also supported the initiative, stating, “The Mukmelpur park would not merely serve as a green zone but would emerge as a centre for health, social interaction and positive living for local residents.” The spokesperson further said, “Today, every resident of the Burari Assembly constituency is expressing gratitude to Chief Minister Rekha Gupta for giving the area its first 3-acre park.”

The government has also announced Rs 20 crore worth of development works in the Burari constituency, including sewer lines, drinking water pipelines and drainage improvements, along with broader infrastructure projects worth nearly Rs 10,000 crore across villages and outer Delhi areas.

City Briefs

SACRIFICE OF COWS, ‘GOVANSH’ ILLEGAL, WILL ATTRACT CRIMINAL ACTION: GOVT

NEW DELHI: Sacrifice of bovine species, cows, calves, camels, and other prohibited animals is completely illegal in the city and will attract a criminal case, Delhi Development Minister Kapil Mishra said on Friday, days ahead of Eid. According to a post on X by Mishra, the government has directed residents to strictly follow all rules and regulations during the festival on May 28. The minister warned that any person found carrying out an illegal sacrifice would face criminal action. He also said sacrifice in public places, including roads, streets, lanes and open public areas, is strictly banned. According to the government’s guidelines, illegal buying and selling of animals in markets, roads and streets will not be permitted.

CBI ARRESTS DELHI FOOD AND SUPPLY DEPT OFFICIAL IN BRIBERY CASE

NEW DELHI: The CBI has arrested an assistant commissioner of the Food and Supply Department here in connection with an alleged bribery case, officials said Friday. The agency arrested the officer in a trap operation on Thursday while allegedly accepting Rs 10,000 as a bribe. The accused demanded Rs 100 per ration card for allotment and distribution of 475 ration cards, it alleged.

CENSUS OFFICIALS FACE HURDLES IN MIGRANT-HEAVY NEIGHBOURHOODS

NEW DELHI: Out of the total 45,864 house listing blocks (HLBs) in the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) area, enumeration is currently in progress in 30,819 blocks, officials said on Friday. According to census officials, enumerators engaged in the ongoing census-related exercise in Delhi are facing difficulties in several outer districts of the city, with officials citing a lack of cooperation from landlords and challenges in reaching migrant populations living in rented accommodations. The field operations began on May 16 across MCD areas of Delhi for the Houselisting and Housing Census (HLO) under Phase I of Census 2027. A single HLB contains roughly 150-200 houses.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The condition of one of the two patients admitted to the RML Hospital over suspected heat stroke has improved while the other remains critical, hospital authorities said on Friday.

The national capital is under the grip of a spell of heatwave conditions, with Thursday recorded as the warmest May night in nearly 14 years.

Both patients were brought to the hospital on Thursday in an unconscious state with extremely high body temperatures and were immediately put on ventilator support and immersion cooling therapy.

The younger patient, a 24-year-old student from West Bengal, was admitted around 1.45 am after falling ill while travelling on a train, doctors said. “He was travelling in a train and was suffering from

CLOSER LOOK

» Both patients were brought to the hospital on Thursday in an unconscious state with extremely high body temperatures and were immediately put on ventilator support and immersion cooling therapy

» The younger patient, a 24-year-old student from West Bengal, was admitted around 1.45 am after falling ill

vomiting, tiredness and loose motions. He was brought to the hospital by attendants in a state of unconsciousness. We immediately put him in ice water and tried to cool him down,” Dr Ajay Chauhan, Director Professor of Medicine at the hospital, said on Thursday. Doctors instituted

while travelling on a train

» Doctors instituted immersion cooling therapy and later shifted him to the medical ward, where he continues to remain under intensive medical management

» The second patient, a man aged around 50 years, was brought to the hospital by police at around 10.45 am on Thursday in an unconscious state with very high body temperature

immersion cooling therapy and later shifted him to the medical ward, where he continues to remain under intensive medical management.

The patient had symptoms including vomiting, loose motions, altered sensorium, faecal incontinence and extremely

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a significant move aimed at easing financial pressure on residents and bringing transparency to urban infrastructure funding, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday announced a major overhaul of water and sewer Infrastructure Charges (IFC), shifting the system from area-based assessment to water demand-based calculation.

Addressing a press conference at the Delhi Secretariat, the Chief Minister said the revised framework is designed to make

the system more citizen-friendly and development-oriented. She said, “IFC will now be determined on the basis of actual water demand rather than the total area of a building.” She added that the charges will apply only to new construction or additional construction, while redevelopment projects with no increase in water demand will be exempt. Non-FAR areas and open spaces will also be excluded from calculations.

The Chief Minister further announced significant relief for different categories of colonies. “Properties located in E and F



category colonies will receive a 50 percent concession in IFC,



CM Rekha Gupta on Friday flagged off a ride-sharing service at the Indira Gandhi International Airport

‘DWARKA HAS THE POTENTIAL TO EMERGE AS A MAJOR HUB FOR GLOBAL INVESTMENT’

Delhi must evolve from ‘Metro’ to ‘Metropolis’: L-G

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Friday outlined a vision for transforming the national capital from a “metro city” into a “metropolis”, with a strong focus on integrated governance, sustainable urban ecosystems and global partnerships. He also said Dwarka has the potential to emerge as a major hub for global investment, innovation and knowledge-based industries.

Speaking at an event focused on Indo-Japanese relations in

Delhi, the L-G said the city had entered a new phase where the emphasis must shift from isolated infrastructure projects to integrated ecosystem building. “A metropolis is not defined only by infrastructure. It is defined by efficiency, sustainability, innovation, and quality of life,” Sandhu said.

He stressed that Dwarka’s development presents “the most important opportunity” for Delhi’s future growth. According to him, the sub-city can evolve into a destination for international companies, research centres and technology hubs through proper



planning and policy support. “Dwarka can be envisioned not just as a residential area, but as a hub for knowledge-based industries, innovation centres, and global partnerships,” he said.

The L-G highlighted five major focus areas for Delhi’s transformation, smart mobility, sustainable development, water and environmental management, disaster resilience and integrated governance.

On transportation, Sandhu said the future of urban mobility lies in better integration between metro systems, buses, digital platforms and last-mile con-

nectivity. “The future of urban transport lies in integration, where metro systems, buses, last-mile connectivity, and digital platforms work seamlessly together,” he said. He added that AI-based traffic management and real-time monitoring systems could improve commuter experience across Delhi.

Addressing environmental concerns, the LG said Delhi’s growth requires cleaner energy, green mobility and efficient infrastructure. He referred to Japan’s expertise in hydrogen energy, electric mobility and sustainable urban systems as

examples Delhi could adopt.

He also stressed the importance of climate resilience, pollution control, wastewater recycling and flood management in ensuring long-term urban sustainability. On disaster preparedness, Sandhu said Delhi could learn from Japan’s experience in resilient infrastructure and emergency response systems.

Quoting Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the L-G said, “India and Japan are natural partners and trusted friends working together for global good.”

Delhi BJP completes mega training camps across 252 mandals

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi BJP has successfully concluded the Pt. Deendayal Upadhyay Mega Training Camps in Shahdara and Mayur Vihar districts, marking the completion of organisational training across 252 mandals and 12 districts in the Capital.

Delhi BJP president Virendra Sachdeva said the camps were designed to strengthen organisational discipline and equip workers, especially new members, with a deeper understanding of the party’s history, working style, media engagement and social media outreach.

“These training camps have not only familiarised party workers with the party’s history, development, working style, and the importance of media and social media usage, but the collective night-time recreational activities and morning yoga sessions have also fostered a new sense of team spirit,” he said.

Union Minister of State Harsh Mahotra said organisational training has been central to his political journey. “Organizational work inspires us every moment to serve the

people, and it is because of the training received in the RSS and BJP organization that I am able to discharge my responsibilities today as a Union Minister of State,” he said.

Addressing workers earlier, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta urged party members to take governance initiatives to the grassroots level. “Every BJP worker is dedicated to the nation, and we must take the message of the Delhi Government’s developmental works to the last person in society,” she said.

Organisation General Secretary Pavan Rana said the ideological commitment of workers remains strong. “Every BJP worker is dedicated to the nation, ‘Vande Bharat’ flows through every vein because most of our workers are volunteers associated with the RSS family, which comprises 74 affiliated organizations,” he said.

The camps, held over two days in Rajokri, included sessions on booth management, media strategy, social media use, public speaking and welfare schemes. Leaders noted that informal activities like games and yoga sessions also helped build coordination and reduce stress among participants.

RUBIO ALSO SCHEDULED TO VISIT KOLKATA, AGRA AND JAIPUR

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio to begin 4-day India visit today

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: US Secretary of State Marco Rubio will arrive in India on Saturday for a four-day visit -- his first to the country since taking office -- aiming to repair bilateral ties that have been under strain since mid-last year.

The top US diplomat is scheduled to hold wide-ranging talks with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, in addition to attending a meeting of the Quad foreign ministers in New Delhi.

While the Jaishankar-Rubio talks are set for Sunday, the Quad meeting will take place on Tuesday. Besides his engagements in New Delhi, Rubio is also scheduled to visit Kolkata, Agra and Jaipur, people familiar

with the matter said.

There is a possibility of the US Secretary of State calling on Prime Minister Narendra Modi as well, it is learnt.

“There’s a lot to work on with India, they’re a great ally and partner. We do a lot of good work with them so this is an important trip,” Rubio said on Friday about his trip to India.

Ways to bolster India-US ties in energy, trade, investment, critical technology and people-to-people ties exchanges are likely to dominate the talks between Jaishankar and Rubio, the people cited above said.

The two sides are also expected to deliberate on the West Asia crisis and its economic impact including on energy supplies.

The US Secretary of State’s

trip to India comes over five weeks after Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri undertook a three-day visit to Washington DC that focused on stabilising the ties after a spell of uncertainty and strain.

The relations between the two countries witnessed a major downturn after Washington imposed punitive tariffs on India and President Donald Trump made controversial assertions regarding his role in de-escalating the India-Pakistan military clashes last May.

Over the next few months, the US president repeatedly and publicly claimed that he had resolved the military conflict between the two neighbours and saved millions of lives as it was going in the direction of a full-scale war.

From Page 1 CM Suvendu

the proposed ‘Ayushman Man-dir’ initiative. He also confirmed that the Ayushman Bharat scheme had been implemented in West Bengal.

“The previous government did not implement it because of vote-bank politics,” Adhikari alleged.

The government is also considering introducing Mohalla Clinics on the Delhi model to improve access to affordable primary health-care, particularly in semi-urban and rural areas.

In another administrative move, Adhikari said his government had implemented the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), replacing provisions that earlier operated under the Criminal Procedure Code framework. He also said long-pending census work had resumed.

The Chief Minister further criticised the previous administration for not implementing flagship central schemes such as the Vishwakarma Scheme and Fasal Bima Yojana.

“We have formed the new government. Whatever needs to be done for the state will be done. We will adopt our reforms and policies step by step,” he said.

Adhikari was on a two-day visit to New Delhi. On Thursday, he met Union Home minister Amit Shah, before meeting Modi on Friday. Discussions during the visit are also expected to include the finalisation of names for the new state cabinet. State BJP president Samik Bhat-tacharya was also in New Delhi earlier this week.

UAPA bail

Bhuyan and B V Nagarathna, which while granting bail in a separate UAPA case had questioned the January 5 ruling that denied bail to Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam.

In Friday’s order, the bench defended that January decision, saying the refusal to release Khalid and Imam was not because Article 21 protections were placed below the statutory bar on bail under the UAPA.

“Bail was declined to two appellants not because Article 21 was treated as subordinate to Section 43D(5), but because, upon an accused-specific evaluation, the court found that their role, the prima facie material attributed to them, and the attendant concerns of trial integrity did not, at that stage, justify overriding the statutory embargo,” the bench said.

It added that even in that ruling, the accused had been allowed to renew their bail pleas after protected witnesses were examined or after one year, showing that the court viewed Article 21 as an ongoing constitutional safeguard.

The bench said the principle laid down in K A Najeeb cannot be read as a blanket route to bail in all delayed UAPA trials, nor as justification for endless incarceration.

“The ratio of the K A Najeeb case is neither a charter for indefinite incarceration under the cover of Section 43D(5) nor a mathematical command that the mere passage of time, divorced from all surrounding circumstances, must automatically result in bail,” the court said.

At the same time, it reaf-

firmed that the right to speedy trial remains a core constitutional protection and that pre-trial detention cannot simply become punishment through delay.

The court also addressed the institutional disagreement between coordinate benches, saying differences in legal reasoning are not unusual, but such conflicts must be resolved through established judicial procedure.

“Judgments of this Court are not to be answered by counter-observations from another bench of equal strength. The discipline of precedent demands a higher institutional method,” the order said.

It added that where one bench has reservations about the reasoning of another bench of equal strength, especially on the interpretation of a binding larger bench ruling, the proper course is to refer the issue to the Chief Justice of India for constitution of an appropriate bench. “A coordinate bench cannot, by strong observations, effectively unsettle the ratio of an earlier coordinate bench while continuing to sit in equal strength,” the court said.

The Centre strongly backed the call for a larger bench, arguing that the issue has implications far beyond the Delhi riots case.

Appearing for the Delhi Police, Additional Solicitor General S V Raju argued that delay in trial alone cannot become a universal ground for bail in terrorism-related prosecutions.

He cited examples of convicted Mumbai terror attacker Ajmal Kasab and Lashkar-e-Taiba founder Hafiz Saeed to make the point that complex cases involving large numbers of witnesses and international evidence may take years.

“If you take the case of Ajmal Kasab, there are a large number of witnesses. Will you grant him bail, given that he has been in jail for 7 or 8 years? It can’t be done,” Raju argued. He added: “Suppose if Hafiz Sayeed is brought from Pakistan and tried, and he is in jail for 5 years because there are a large number of witnesses, will you release him on bail?”

Raju also pointed to the scale of the Delhi riots, in which 53 people were killed, and argued that courts must examine the role of each accused rather than apply a general rule based solely on time spent in custody. “This can’t be how it has to be applied. It has to be applied to the facts of each case,” he said.

The legal debate stems from conflicting interpretations of past rulings.

In the January 5 Gulfisha Fatima judgment, the Supreme Court granted bail to five accused in the Delhi riots conspiracy case but denied relief to Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam, saying they occupied a higher level in the alleged conspiracy.

That judgment held that prolonged incarceration, though a serious constitutional concern, could not by itself guarantee bail.

But on May 18, another bench, while granting bail to Syed Iftikhar Andrabi in an NIA case, said earlier rulings including Gulfisha Fatima and Gurwinder Singh could not be used to justify indefinite detention under the UAPA. That bench said the principle that “bail is the rule and jail is the exception” flows from constitutional guarantees under Articles 21 and 22.

Friday’s order seeks to settle that legal uncertainty.

The Supreme Court said the central question is how constitutional protections for liberty should operate in cases where Parliament

has consciously imposed stricter bail standards through anti-terror legislation.

RBI hands

interest rate increases that could hurt growth.

In a statement issued after the 623rd meeting of its Central Board, the RBI said the approved transfer to the government stood at Rs 2,86,588.46 crore for the 2025-26 accounting year, a rise of 6.7 per cent from the previous year.

The central bank said its net income before risk provisioning and transfers to statutory funds rose to Rs 3.96 lakh crore in FY26 from Rs 3.13 lakh crore in FY25. Its balance sheet expanded 20.61 per cent to Rs 91,97,121.08 crore as of March 31, 2026. The board, chaired by Governor Sanjay Malhotra, reviewed domestic and global economic conditions along with risks to the outlook before approving the transfer. Deputy Governors Swaminathan J, Poonam Gupta, Shirish Chandra Murmu and Rohit Jain attended the meeting, along with other board members including government nominee Nagaraju Maddirala, Secretary in the Department of Financial Services. As part of the same decision, the board transferred Rs 1.09 lakh crore to the Contingent Risk Buffer, significantly higher than the Rs 44,861 crore set aside the previous year. The CRB now stands at 6.5 per cent of the balance sheet, down from 7.5 per cent in 2024-25, within the permissible range of 4.5 to 7.5 per cent under the bank’s Economic Capital Framework.

The surplus transfer comes at a time when India’s external sector is facing growing strain from the West Asia conflict. India imports about 88 per cent of its crude oil needs, making it vulnerable to spikes in global energy prices. Higher crude costs, rising fertiliser prices and a weakening rupee have raised concerns about imported inflation and pressure on public finances.

In its May Bulletin released on Friday, the RBI said financial conditions, crude oil prices and capital flows remained key risks to the external sector outlook.

“The financial conditions, crude oil prices and capital flows continue to pose challenges to the external sector outlook,” an article on the state of the economy in the bulletin said.

The bulletin noted that the conflict in West Asia continued to disrupt commodity markets, trade flows and supply chains, adding to volatility in financial markets.

At the same time, the RBI said India entered this phase from a position of relative macroeconomic strength, with domestic demand continuing to support growth. It said industrial and services activity remained resilient in April, while summer sowing had progressed well due to above-normal pre-monsoon rainfall and healthy reservoir levels.

Consumer inflation rose to 3.5 per cent in April, largely driven by food prices, while core inflation remained steady, according to the bulletin. The RBI noted that headline inflation remained within its tolerance band, though supply-side price pressures would need close monitoring.

Separately, sources familiar with the central bank’s thinking said the RBI does not currently view interest rate hikes as the preferred response to defend the rupee, despite grow-

ing market expectations of tighter policy. The rupee has fallen nearly 6 per cent since the Iran conflict began in late February and touched a record low of nearly 96.96 against the US dollar on Thursday. Interest rate swap markets are pricing in at least 40 basis points of tightening over the next three months and more than 100 basis points over the next year.

However, officials are said to believe smaller rate increases would have limited effect in stabilising the currency while increasing borrowing costs in an economy already facing slower growth risks.

“There doesn’t seem to be an urgent need for the central bank to jump into rate hikes,” one source said. The RBI is understood to be considering alternative options in coordination with the government, including measures linked to non-resident Indian dollar deposits and tax changes for debt investors.

The central bank’s April forecast of 6.9 per cent economic growth for the current financial year may be revised lower, according to one source. Inflation, projected at 4.6 per cent in April, may also come under renewed pressure if oil prices remain elevated and the weaker rupee feeds into domestic prices.

Wholesale inflation rose to 8.3 per cent last month, while retail inflation stood at 3.48 per cent in April, still within the RBI’s 2 to 6 per cent target range.

The Monetary Policy Committee is scheduled to announce its next decision on June 5, with most economists expecting rates to remain unchanged, though some market participants are preparing for tighter policy.

Will bring

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta submitted that the Centre had decided to bring the individuals back and examine their citizenship status before taking any further action. He clarified that the statement was being made in the “peculiar facts” of the case and should not be treated as a precedent for other matters. The Solicitor General also reportedly submitted that it might take 8-10 days to bring the persons back.

Senior advocate Sanjay Hegde, appearing for the respondents, requested the bench to formally record the assurance. The court subsequently incorporated the Centre’s stand in its order passed during the hearing.

The apex court noted in its order that the government would facilitate the return of the respondents and verify their claims of Indian citizenship, adding that their continuation in India would depend on the outcome of the enquiry.

The Calcutta High Court, in September 2025, while acting on habeas corpus petitions filed by the relatives of deported persons, had directed the repatriation of Sunali Khatun, her husband, Danish Sekh and son Sabir Sekh. In another petition, the High Court directed the repatriation of Sweety Bibi and her sons, Kurban and Imam.

Twisha dowry

Twisha, 33, a model and actor from Noida, was found hanging at her matrimonial home in Bhopal’s Katara Hills area on May 12. Her family has accused her husband and in-laws of dowry harassment and

activity from early June may offer some relief.

Punjab saw a slight easing, with temperatures falling below 40 degrees in several areas after light showers in places including Phagwara, Hoshiarpur, Jalandhar and Pathankot. Amritsar recorded 39.1 degrees Celsius, while Bathinda logged 44 degrees, down from 45.6 degrees on Thursday. The Punjab government revised working hours in government offices, schools and colleges from 9 am to 5 pm to 7.30 am to 1.30 pm.

In neighbouring Haryana, the heat remained severe. Rohtak recorded 45.3 degrees Celsius, five degrees above normal, while Hisar reached 43.1 degrees. Chandigarh recorded 39.9 degrees.

Rajasthan continued to bake, with Chittorgarh the hottest in the state at 44.2 degrees Celsius. Phalodi, Bikaner and Churu also crossed 44 degrees. The IMD said dry weather would continue for most of the state over the coming week, though a western disturbance may bring thunderstorms, light rain and gusty winds on Saturday. Temperatures may dip briefly before rising again from May 24, with severe heatwave conditions likely in parts of west Rajasthan.

Southern states also faced difficult conditions. In Tamil Nadu, more than 15 districts recorded temperatures above 39 degrees Celsius, with Chennai reaching 42 degrees. Heatwave conditions are expected over coastal Tamil Nadu and Puducherry, though isolated rain is possible.

In contrast, Kerala braced for heavy rain. The IMD issued an orange alert for Alappuzha and yellow alerts for six other districts, warning of flooding

abatement to suicide, while the Singh family has claimed she was addicted to drugs. Twisha had been married for just five months to lawyer Samarth Singh.

In a notification, the Madhya Pradesh Home Department said the state government had granted consent under Section 6 of the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946, extending the CBI’s jurisdiction across the state for investigation of the case.

The order said consent had also been granted to probe any related offences, including abetment or criminal conspiracy linked to the matter.

Samarth Singh had been evading arrest since an FIR was registered against him and his mother, former district judge Giribala Singh, following Twisha Sharma’s death.

He reached the Jabalpur district court on Friday evening to surrender after withdrawing his anticipatory bail plea from the Madhya Pradesh High Court.

With the plea withdrawn, Singh no longer had legal protection from arrest and was subsequently taken into custody by police.

His anticipatory bail application had earlier been rejected by a Bhopal sessions court, after which he approached the high court on Thursday.

Giribala Singh, a retired district and sessions judge, had secured anticipatory bail from a Bhopal court last week. She is also named in the FIR and was removed as chairperson of the Bhopal Consumer Court after being named in the case.

Police registered an FIR against Samarth Singh and Giribala Singh under Sections 80(2), 85 and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, along with provisions of the Dowry Prohibition Act.

Police had earlier announced a cash reward of Rs 30,000 for information leading to Samarth Singh’s arrest and had also moved the court seeking revocation of his passport.

Meanwhile, police have issued a third and final notice to Giribala Singh, directing her to record her statement in connection with the investigation. Sources said that if she continues to avoid cooperating, police may seek cancellation of her anticipatory bail.

Separately, Twisha’s father, Navnidhi Sharma, has moved the Madhya Pradesh High Court seeking cancellation of the anticipatory bail granted to Giribala Singh.

EC announces

According to the notification, the 24 regular vacancies are spread across Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Manipur, Meghalaya, Rajasthan, Arunachal Pradesh, Karnataka and Mizoram and two by-elections in Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu.

One vacancy is from Maharashtra after NCP leader Sunetra Pawar resigned from the Upper House after getting elected to the Maharashtra Assembly from Baramati. She is also serving as Deputy Chief Minister in the state government.

The second bypoll is for the Tamil Nadu seat vacated by AIADMK MP Ve Shanmugam. All eyes will be on Tamil Nadu, where actor-politician Vijay and his party Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) are being closely watched. With the majority in the Assembly, speculation is rife over whether TVK will attempt its maiden Rajya Sabha entry or support a Congress-backed

in low-lying urban areas, traffic disruption and possible landslides. Heavy to very heavy rainfall is forecast in parts of the state through early June.

In Arunachal Pradesh, flash floods caused widespread damage in Upper Subansiri district after heavy rainfall. Officials said key bridges, including an RCC bridge at Nyo Koro near Ningping village and another linking Longte village with Giba headquarters, were washed away. Seven kutcha houses in Ningping were badly damaged, along with farmland, livestock and other property.

The District Disaster Management Authority urged residents to stay away from rivers amid forecasts of more heavy rain, thunderstorms and lightning in several districts.

Hill states saw some respite. In Himachal Pradesh, thunderstorms and heavy showers brought relief in Shimla, Kufri and Fagu, while Rohtang Pass received fresh snowfall. The weather office said rain and snow may continue until May 25. Uttarakhand is expected to see thunderstorms and gusty winds in hill districts, though plains are likely to remain dry.

In West Bengal, heavy rain is forecast in northern districts until May 26, while southern districts are expected to face hot and humid weather with thunderstorms in some areas.

The IMD said heatwave conditions are likely through May 28 in parts of Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Punjab, Haryana, Delhi and Rajasthan, with other states including Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Jharkhand, Telangana and Vidarbha also expected to face extreme heat on different days.

candidate as part of possible opposition coordination.

In a statement, the EC said the elections for the Rajya Sabha seats will be held in 10 states where 24 incumbents are retiring on different dates beginning June 21 to July 19. Of the total 26 seats where elections are being held, the NDA currently has 18 and the Congress four while one seat is with the JMM and three are with the YSRCP.

The NDA is likely to get 17 seats in these elections, while the Congress will get five, the JMM two and the TVK one. The NDA currently has 149 MPs in the upper house while the opposition has 78 and non-aligned regional parties have 17 MPs in the 244-member house.

In Andhra Pradesh, the TDP will win all four states for the Council of States and the BJP will bag all four seats in Gujarat. In Jharkhand, the JMM-Congress alliance is likely to win both the seats, but the BJP which has 21 seats of its own may try to bag one seat with the help of cross-voting by four opposition members.

In Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, the Congress will get one seat each while the BJP will win two seats in each of the states, going by their current numbers.

In Karnataka, the Congress will win three seats and the BJP will get only one seat.

Rajasthan has a total of 10 Rajya Sabha seats. The BJP and the Congress currently have five members each. Given the present strength of parties in the 200-member Rajasthan Assembly, the BJP is expected to win two of the three seats, while the Congress is likely to secure one.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Why reservation

their combined income crossed the prescribed threshold.

During the hearing, Justice Nagarathna questioned the continuing use of reservation benefits by families that had already progressed. “If both parents are IAS officers, why should they have reservations? With education and economic empowerment, there is social mobility,” she said. She added that if reservation continued in such cases, “we will never get out of it”

The judge also pointed to the petitioner’s family circumstances, noting that his father’s basic pay was Rs 53,900 per month and his mother’s basic pay was Rs 52,650 per month.

Appearing for the petitioner, advocate Shashank Ratnoo argued that salary income should not be the deciding factor in determining creamy layer status for government employees. He said the classification depends on the service status of the parents, such as whether they belong to Group A or Group B, rather than salary levels alone.

Ratnoo argued that treating salary as the main criterion could unfairly exclude lower-ranking government employees such as clerks, drivers, and peons. He also submitted that salary and agricultural income should not be counted, and only income from business or other sources should be considered.

He further argued that including all income categories would blur the distinction between OBC reservation and the Economically Weaker Sections (EWS) quota.

The petition challenges a Karnataka High Court division bench ruling that overturned an earlier single judge decision in the candidate’s favour. The high court held that the

Central government’s September 8, 1993 office memorandum excluding salary income from creamy layer assessment applied only to Union government reservations, not Karnataka’s quota system.

The Supreme Court has issued notice on the plea, indicating the matter will undergo further examination.

Everest summit

expedition, said Sherpa guides rescued him from higher on the mountain and brought him down, but he died shortly after reaching Camp II early on Friday. Bhandari said guides had worked through the night to try to save him.

“One climber became extremely exhausted during the descent. Sherpa guides worked really hard to save his life,” Bhandari said.

Tiwari also ran into trouble while descending after summiting. Officials said he became unwell near the Hillary Step, a steep and technically difficult section just below the summit. Karki said he died there on Thursday evening while being assisted by four Sherpa climbers. Bhandari said Tiwari had been descending with experienced Sherpa guides, but rescue attempts were unsuccessful.

Efforts are underway to bring the bodies of both climbers to Kathmandu, expedition officials said.

The latest fatalities bring the Everest death toll this season to five. Three Nepali climbers had died earlier during the expedition period.

The deaths came as Everest recorded one of its busiest climbing periods. On Wednesday alone, 274 climbers reached the summit from the Nepal side, setting a new record for the highest number of ascents in a single day. The previous one-day record was 223 summits in May 2019.

Three Indians were part of Wednesday’s record-setting group: Sandeep Are, Tulasi Reddi Palpu-noori and Ajay Pal Singh Dhaliwal. Another Indian climber, Lakshmi-kanta Mandal, reached the summit on Thursday. This season has also seen successful ascents by 21-year-old Indian climber Saanika Shah and the Border Security Force’s all-women mountaineering team.

Nepal has issued between 493 and 502 permits for Everest climbs this spring, depending on the reporting cut-off, making this one of the busiest seasons on record. The heavy rush has been partly linked to China’s closure of the northern Everest route from Tibet, pushing more climbers to attempt the ascent from Nepal.

Crowding on Everest has again raised safety concerns, especially as climbers must move through narrow sections clipped to fixed ropes, often waiting for limited weather windows. Veteran guide Kami Rita Sherpa, who climbed Everest for a record 32nd time this week, called for tighter controls on climber numbers.

“It was very crowded this year compared to last year because there were more clients,” he told reporters in Kathmandu. “There is a need for authorities to control this number.”

Kami Rita’s closest rival, Pasang Dawa Sherpa, completed his 31st Everest ascent on Friday, his second successful summit this week.

Nepal, home to eight of the world’s 14 highest mountains, relies heavily on mountaineering tourism revenue, with Everest expeditions remaining one of its most significant seasonal draws.

— RUBIO, WONG & MOTEGI EXPECTED TO CALL ON PM MODI —

Quad meet in India: West Asia fallout among top agenda

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The foreign ministers of the Quad nations will deliberate on the fallout of the West Asia crisis and the prevailing situation in the Indo-Pacific at an India-hosted meeting on Tuesday. The New Delhi meeting will be attended by US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong, and Japanese Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar will preside over the meeting. Rubio, Wong and Motegi are also expected to call on Prime Minister Narendra Modi, besides holding separate bilateral meetings with Jaishankar. “In keeping with the Quad vision for a Free and Open Indo-Pacific, the ministers

Highlights

- » External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar will preside over the meeting
- » India is hosting the meeting in its capacity as the current chair of the coalition

will build on discussions held in Washington DC on July 1, 2025,” the MEA said. “They will exchange views on advancing Quad cooperation across priority areas, review progress on ongoing Quad initiatives, and reflect on recent developments in the Indo-Pacific region and other international issues of mutual concern,” it said. The Quad, comprising India, the US, Australia and Japan, has emerged as a key grouping largely focusing on peace, security and stability in the Indo-Pacific region.

» The Quad, comprising India, the US, Australia and Japan, has emerged as a key grouping largely focusing on peace, security and stability in the Indo-Pacific region

India is hosting the meeting in its capacity as the current chair of the coalition. There is no official word yet on the planned meeting. People familiar with the preparations for the meeting said the Quad foreign ministers will deliberate on the pressing global challenges, including the conflicts in Ukraine and the West Asia, and will take stock of cooperation in the Indo-Pacific, a region that has been witnessing increasing Chinese assertiveness. In the last few years, the

Quad has rolled out a number of initiatives addressing some of the most pressing needs and challenges of the Indo-Pacific region, including in areas of maritime security, infrastructure and connectivity. In the last Quad summit held in Wilmington in the US in 2024, top leaders of the grouping unveiled major steps to expand maritime security cooperation in the Indo-Pacific. The upcoming meeting is also likely to set the broad agenda of the Quad summit that is likely to take place in India later this year. “During their visit to New Delhi, the Foreign Ministers of Australia and Japan, and the United States Secretary of State are also expected to hold bilateral meetings with the External Affairs Minister and call on Prime Minister Narendra Modi,” the MEA said.

Malaysian PM Ibrahim to visit India for BRICS summit in Sept

KUALA LUMPUR: Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim on Friday said that he will visit India in September to attend the BRICS summit. Ibrahim made the remarks during a telephonic conversation with his “friend” Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Chandrasekar Joseph Vijay. In a post on X, Ibrahim said he told the actor-turned-politician about his visit to India, during which he might also make a “brief visit” to Tamil Nadu. “I also informed him that I will be traveling to India in September to attend the BRICS Summit and hold a meeting with Prime Minister Modi, and if the opportunity arises, I will make a brief visit to Tamil Nadu,” Ibrahim said. India, as the chair of the BRICS, will host the annual summit of the grouping in September.

AGENCIES

Punjab civic polls to be held using ballot papers: HC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHANDIGARH: Local body elections in Punjab will be held using ballot papers with the high court here on Friday dismissing petitions seeking polling by EVMs, observing that the petitioners had approached the court quite late and elections were barely days away. Declining interference, the court dismissed the three petitions seeking elections through EVMs. Polling for 104 municipal bodies including eight municipal corporations in Punjab will be held on May 26. The counting of votes will take place on May 29. The PILs before the Punjab and Haryana High Court had challenged the Punjab State Election Commission’s decision of holding the elections for municipal corporations, municipal councils and nagar panchayats through ballot papers. Punjab’s Additional Advocate General Ferry Sofat told reporters on Friday, “Three petitions were filed that elections should be held through EVMs. State Election Commission had maintained that even

Closer Look

- » Declining interference, the court dismissed the three petitions seeking elections through EVMs
- » Polling for 104 municipal bodies including eight municipal corporations in Punjab will be held on May 26

after EVMs, which were stated to be in transit by the Election Commission, reach the state, the whole process (involved in preparation, arrangements and conduct of polls through EVMs) takes at least 15 days.” A bench of Chief Justice Sheel Nagu observed that the election programme had progressed to an advanced stage with only the polling remaining after last of withdrawal of nominations on May 19. “The high court has dismissed petitions and observed that the matter had reached an advanced stage and the petitioners had approached the court quite late in the day,” Sofat said. These elections will now be held using ballot paper, he said.

Centre okays Ladakh DGP Mukesh Singh’s deputation to Manipur

‘He is likely to be appointed as state police chief’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Centre has approved inter-cadre deputation of Ladakh Police chief Mukesh Singh to Manipur, according to an official order. Singh is a 1996-batch Indian Police Service (IPS) officer of AGMUT (Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Mizoram, and Union Territories) cadre. The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved the inter-cadre deputation of Singh to Manipur for a period of three years as a special case in public interest, an order, dated May 21, by the Personnel Ministry said.

The vacancy was necessitated following the appointment of Manipur DGP Rajiv Singh as Secretary (Security) in the Cabinet Secretariat

He is likely to be appointed as Manipur Police chief, officials said. The vacancy was necessitated following the appointment of Manipur DGP Rajiv Singh as Secretary (Security) in

the Cabinet Secretariat. The secretary (security) is the administrative head of the Special Protection Group (SPG) that provides security to the Prime Minister and members of his immediate family residing with him at his official residence. Manipur has been witnessing incidents of ethnic violence, which started after a “Tribal Solidarity March” was organised in the hill districts to protest the Meitei community’s demand for Scheduled Tribes status, since May 3, 2023. It has left at least 260 people dead, besides displacing thousands of residents.



A Red Cross worker disinfects after transporting the bodies of people who died of Ebola from a health center in Rwampara, Congo, Wednesday

AP/PTI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Union Health Ministry has asked all states and Union territories to step up surveillance, hospital preparedness and screening of international travellers following the WHO’s declaration of the Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo and Uganda as a public health emergency of international concern (PHEIC). In a letter to chief secretaries and administrators of UTs on May 21, Union Health Secretary Punya Salila Srivastava said countries bordering DRC and Uganda, including South Sudan, have been assessed to be at high risk of disease transmission. “While the current assessment indicates that the risk to countries outside the affected African region remains low, the substantial quantum of international trade and travel underscores the importance of maintaining adequate pre-

paredness and response capacities at all levels of the health system,” the letter said. The ministry directed states to strengthen surveillance under the Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme (IDSP) for unusual clusters of cases showing symptoms suggestive of Ebola disease, particularly among people with recent travel history to affected areas. The symptoms listed in the advisory include fever, weak-

ness, muscle pain, headache, sore throat, vomiting, diarrhoea, stomach pain, rash and red eyes. States have also been asked to identify designated isolation facilities and dedicated ambulances, ensure availability of trained healthcare personnel, personal protective equipment (PPE), logistics, laboratory support and critical care capacities. The ministry said ICMR’s National Institute of Virology (NIV), Pune, is fully equipped to test samples from suspected Ebola cases detected either at points of entry or in the community, and additional ICMR network laboratories would be strengthened depending on the evolving situation. The advisory stressed coordination among airport and port health authorities, state and district surveillance units and other agencies for prompt information sharing and follow-up of travellers requiring public health monitoring.

PM Modi to virtually distribute 51,000 job letters at Rozgar Mela today

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi will virtually distribute more than 51,000 appointment letters to newly appointed youth in various government departments and organisations at a ‘Rozgar Mela’ on Saturday, officials said. In keeping with the prime minister’s commitment to prioritising employment generation, the Rozgar Mela is a major initiative aimed at translating this vision into reality, an official statement said. Since its inception, around 12 lakh recruitment letters have been issued through 18 Rozgar Melas organised across the country, it said. On Saturday, Prime Minis-

ter Modi will hand over more than 51,000 appointment letters to newly appointed youth at the 19th Rozgar Mela via videoconferencing, the statement said. He will also address a gathering on the occasion, it added. “Our commitment to the bright future and empowerment of our young colleagues across the country remains unwavering. In this direction, tomorrow at 11 am, I will participate in another employment fair through videoconferencing, where I will have the privilege of handing over appointment letters to the youth for various government departments,” Modi said in a post on X in Hindi.

MP0ST

TOTAL ARRESTS NOW ELEVEN

CBI arrests Pune teacher in NEET UG physics paper leak case

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested another key accused in the alleged NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case, identifying her as a major source behind the leak of Physics examination questions. The accused, Manisha Sanjay Havaladar, currently employed at Seth Hiralal Saraf Prashala in Pune, Maharashtra, was arrested after detailed interrogation by the CBI. According to investigators, she was associated with the NEET-UG 2026 examination process and had been appointed by the National Testing Agency (NTA) as an expert, giving her access to the Physics question papers.

Details point toward her involvement well before public awareness arose. Authorities trace digital footprints leading directly to her role. While multiple persons remain under scrutiny, focus intensifies on coordination patterns preceding the test. Information surfaced through cross-referenced timelines and message logs. The nature of shared content suggests deliberate dissemination. No official confirmation beyond procedural updates has been issued. Further steps depend on forensic verification across devices seized during raids. Public access to investigation records remains restricted at this stage. Appointment came through the National Testing

Agency - this role named her as an expert participant. Access granted under that status covered Physics exam materials specifically. In April 2026, according to CBI findings, Havaladar is said to have passed multiple Physics questions - destined for the NEET-UG exam - to Manisha Mandhare. She was taken into custody later, on May 16 that year. What emerged through inquiry: the material transferred aligned precisely with portions of the test administered May 3. Though separated by time, the link between transmission and actual paper held firm under scrutiny. Among the continuing investigation, several sites nationwide have been visited

by the CBI. At such places, agents recovered written evidence, electronic devices, financial statements, along with cellular units. Examination involving both technical and digital methods now applies to those items taken. What follows depends on results yet to emerge. On May 12, 2026, the CBI opened an inquiry after receiving formal notice from the Department of Higher Education - part of the Ministry of Education - about claims that NEET-UG 2026 test materials had been disclosed prematurely. Despite routine protocols, concerns emerged through documented assertions which prompted federal involvement without delay. Though initial

details remained limited, procedural steps were initiated based on structured communication between administrative branches. Because evidence pointed toward possible compromise, oversight authorities moved forward under established guidelines. From that point onward, investigative mechanisms began activating across institutional levels. Following review of submitted records, confirmation arrived that unauthorised access may have occurred. After careful assessment, officials concluded scrutiny was warranted due to the nature of allegations. While no public statements followed immediately, internal coordination intensified during early phases.



TATA POWER-DDL

TATA POWER DELHI DISTRIBUTION LIMITED

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Regd. Office : NDPL House, Hudson Lines, Kingsway Camp, Delhi - 110 009.
CIN No. : U40109DL2001PLC111526, Website : www.tatapower-ddl.com

REQUEST FOR PUBLIC RESPONSE PETITION FOR APPROVAL OF TRUE-UP FOR FY 2023-24

May 23, 2026

Under the provisions of the Electricity Act, 2003, Delhi Electricity Reform Act, 2000 to the extent applicable, Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission Business Plan Regulations, 2017, Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission Business Plan Regulations, 2019, Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission Business Plan Regulations, 2023 and the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission (Terms and Conditions for Determination of Tariff) Regulations, 2017 issued by Commission, Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited (hereinafter referred to as 'Tata Power-DDL') has filed Petition before the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission (DERC or the Commission) for approval of True-up of ARR for FY 2023-24 based on the prevailing Acts, Policies and applicable Regulations. The Commission has admitted the Petition vide Order dated 12/12/2025.

1. The salient features of the True-up Petition are as follows:

S. No.	Particulars	UoM	FY 2023-24
A	Power Purchase (MU's)	MU	10,661
B	Billed Sales (MU's)	MU	10,028
C	Distribution Loss	%	5.93%
D	Power Purchase Cost Per Unit	Rs./KWh	6.86
E	Power Purchase Cost (Net of Rebate)	Rs. Crore	7,313
F	O&M Including Additional O&M Expenses on account of statutory levies & Taxes	Rs. Crore	947
G	Depreciation	Rs. Crore	328
H	Loss on Retirement of Assets	Rs. Crore	7
I	Return on Capital Employed (ROCE) including Income Tax	Rs. Crore	567
J	Non-Tariff Income	Rs. Crore	(129)
K	Aggregate Revenue Requirement excluding carrying cost (add E to J)	Rs. Crore	9,033
L	Revenue realized at current tariffs without 8% Surcharge	Rs. Crore	9,398
M	Incentives	Rs. Crore	(110)
N	Total Revenue Available (L+M)	Rs. Crore	9,288
O	Revenue (Gap)/Surplus at current Tariff (N-K) excluding carrying cost & 8% Surcharge	Rs. Crore	254

2. Performance of Tata Power – DDL

Particulars	Regulatory Target (%)	FY 23-24 Achieved (%)
Timely Restoration of Scheduled Outage (Maximum duration in single stretch)	95%	99.94%
Billing Complaints w.r.t. total bills issued	Shall not exceeding 0.2%	0.04%

3. Augmentation / Maintenance details

Particulars	UoM	FY 2023-24
No. of Power Transformers (Net of Addition and Removal of PTR)	Nos.	219
EHV Capacity	MVA	5,316
No. of Distribution Transformers	Nos.	30,414

4. Unrestricted Peak Demand of 2,218 MW was met in FY 2023-24.

5. Reliability Indices

Year	SAIFI (Nos.)	SAIDI (Hrs.)	MAIFI (Nos.)
FY 2023-24	1.152	0.681	0.032

6. In accordance with the provisions of the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission Comprehensive (Conduct of Business) Regulations, 2001 notified by the Commission, the consumers and stakeholders are requested to submit the response on the above Petition. The response may be sent to the Secretary of the Commission at the following address latest by 5/06/2026. The response may be submitted personally or by post or email to the Commission at the details mentioned below:

DELHI ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION

Viniyamak Bhawan, C-Block, Shivalik, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi- 110 017.

Email id: secyderc@nic.in Telefax: 011-41080416, 011-41080417

- The Commission shall conduct a Public Hearing on Hybrid Mode (Physically and Virtually) with the responding stakeholders on 5/06/2026.
- The complete Petition can be downloaded from the website of the Commission (www.derc.gov.in) and the website of the TPDDL <http://www.tatapower-ddl.com>. A soft copy of the Petition may be obtained in CD on payment of Rs 25/- per CD or a copy of the Petition may be purchased from the Head-Office of Tata Power-DDL located at NDPL House, Hudson Lines, Kingsway Camp, Delhi-110009 on working day till 5/06/2026 between 11:00 AM and 4:00 PM on payment of Rs 100/- either by cash or by Demand Draft/Pay Order in favour of “Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited” payable at New Delhi.

For Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited
Sd/-
Ritu Gupta
Head – Regulatory

BOLSTERING SURVEILLANCE & SECURITY ALONG PAK, B'DESH BORDERS

India to launch ‘smart border’ project: Amit Shah

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Friday announced plans for a “Smart Border Project” aimed at strengthening surveillance and security along India’s borders with Pakistan and Bangladesh through the extensive use of advanced technologies and integrated monitoring systems. Speaking at the BSF investiture ceremony and Rustamji Memorial Lecture in New Delhi, Shah said the project would mark a significant shift towards technology-driven border management. The initiative will involve the deployment of drones, radars, high-resolution camera systems and real-time surveillance mechanisms to improve monitoring and operational efficiency along the frontiers.



Union Home minister Amit Shah with other dignitaries during the BSF investiture ceremony and Rustamji Memorial Lecture in New Delhi

The Home Minister said the project is expected to be implemented during the Border Security Force’s 60th anniversary year, although he did not specify a timeline for its rollout. He stressed that border management needs to evolve in response to emerging security

threats and changing geopolitical conditions. Shah said challenges along India’s borders have undergone a major transformation in recent years, with illegal infiltration, narcotics smuggling, counterfeit currency networks, organised crime and drone-

assisted smuggling emerging as key concerns. He noted that conventional methods of border security alone are no longer adequate to tackle these threats effectively. Emphasising the need for coordinated action, Shah said state police forces, cen-

INSIGHT

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said the Narendra Modi government remains committed to preventing unauthorised entry into the country and identifying as well as deporting illegal infiltrators already present in India. He added that efforts are also being intensified to break the infrastructure supporting smuggling and clandestine movement across borders. Referring to incidents such as the Uri and Pulwama terror attacks, Shah said India’s response strategy has changed significantly over the years. He cited surgical strikes, air strikes and Operation Sindoor as examples of a more assertive approach adopted by the government in dealing with terrorism and cross-border threats. According to him, India now believes in decisive action rather than prolonged dialogue following terror attacks.

Punjab to remove stray dogs from all high footfall spaces: CM

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: The Punjab government on Friday launched a campaign against stray dogs, and Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann said the state government will follow the Supreme Court order in letter and spirit. “The Punjab government will strictly follow in letter and spirit the Supreme Court order given on May 19, 2026. As per the SC orders, we will remove stray dogs from all high footfall public spaces so that children, senior citizens and families can move freely without fearing for their safety,” Chief Minister Mann said in a post on X on Friday. Mann wrote: “We will create and maintain an adequate number of dog shelters where they can be cared for properly.”

Mann said the state govt will follow the SC order in letter and spirit

“...Take legally permissible measures, including euthanasia, in cases involving rabid, incurably ill or demonstrably dangerous and aggressive dogs posing a threat to human life, strictly in accordance with the Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act and the ABC (Animal Birth Control) Rules,” he said in the post. The Supreme Court, in a significant verdict, allowed euthanasia of rabid, incurably ill, dangerous and aggressive dogs to curb the threat to human lives, saying the right to live with dignity encompasses

the right to move freely without the threat of harm from canines. In a first-of-its-kind order, the top court ruled that when the safety and lives of human beings are weighed against the interests and welfare of sentient beings, the constitutional balance must necessarily and unequivocally tilt in favour of the preservation and protection of human life. A bench of Justices Vikram Nath, Sandeep Mehta and NV Anjaria, which dismissed all the petitions and applications for recall, modification of the November 7, 2025, order, including the directive on relocation and sterilisation of dogs from institutional areas, said the right guaranteed under Article 21 of the Constitution stands at the “highest pedestal of constitutional protection”.

HC seeks details of arms licences of Brij Bhushan Singh, 18 others

PRAYAGRAJ: Observing that display of arms publicly is harmful for social harmony, the Allahabad High Court has asked the Uttar Pradesh government to furnish details of arms licences of 19 people in the state including politicians Brij Bhushan Singh, Raja Bhaiya and Dhananjay Singh. In his order passed on Wednesday, Justice Vinod Diwaker said, “In the name of self-defence, weapons that become instruments of intimidation promote fear rather than genuine security. A society in which armed individuals assert dominance through visible force and threats does not become more free or peaceful, rather it erodes public trust.” “It is the prima facie view of this court that the public display of weapons may create an illusion of dominance,

strength and protection, but it often disrupts social harmony and generates fear and insecurity among ordinary people. Although the open carrying of guns is sometimes justified in the name of self-defence, weapons that become instruments of intimidation promote fear rather than genuine security,” the court added. Besides Raghuraj Pratap Singh alias Raja Bhaiya, Brij Bhushan Singh and Dhananjay Singh, the 16 other people whose details have been sought are Sushil Singh, Vineet Singh, Ajay Marhad, Sujit Singh Belwa, Upendra Singh Guddu, Pappu Bhaukali, Indradev Singh, Sunil Yadav, Farar Azeem, Badshah Singh, Sangram Singh, Sullu Singh, Chulbul Singh, Sunny Singh, Chhannu Singh and Dr. Uday Bhan Singh.

Before seeking details, the court also observed, “During the course of arguments it’s realized and also considering similar matters pending before this court wherein licences have been cancelled in respect of persons engaged in public and political life, it has been found it necessary that further information is required for arriving at a logical conclusion.” “This court is of the considered view that equity is one of the foundational principles of the rule of law; therefore, in order to ensure good governance and maintain public confidence, the State must not only observe fairness and non-discrimination in policy, but such principles must also be reflected in day-to-day administration,” the court further said. AGENCIES

Maharashtra: Tiger kills 4 women in Chandrapur

CHANDRAPUR: Four women collecting tendu leaves were killed in a tiger attack in Maharashtra’s Chandrapur district on Friday morning, a forest official said. The incident occurred under compartment 1836 of the forest near Gunjewahi village in Sindewahi tehsil, nearly 70 km from the district headquarters, said the official, adding it is yet not known if the women were killed by one tiger or more than one. A group of 10-13 women had gone to a forested patch to collect tendu leaves, which are predominantly used as the natural wrapper for ‘bidis’ (hand-rolled cigarettes). As they were busy collecting the leaves, a tiger killed four of them, identified as Kawadabai Mohurle (45), Anitabai Mohurle (40), Sunita Mohurle (38) and Sangita Chaudhary (50), all residents of Gunjewahi. To monitor the tiger/s movements, 30 camera traps and three live cameras have been installed, and patrolling by field staff and special squads has been intensified, he said. After being alerted, a team of forest officials reached the area, said Chief Conservator of Forests (Chandrapur Circle) R M Ramanujan. For the time being, collection of tendu leaves in the area has been stopped, an official said. A forest department team under Dr Kumaraswamy S R, Deputy Conservator of Forests, Brahmapuri division, was at the site along with personnel from Sindewahi police station for site inspection as well as other aspects of the probe related to the incident. “The bodies have been shifted to Sindewahi rural hospital for post mortem. Compensation of Rs 25,000 each was given to the kin of the deceased,” the official said. Measures such as broadcasting alerts via loudspeakers in every village, displaying posters, and raising public awareness regarding the presence of tigers are being consistently implemented, and these will be strengthened following this incident, he added. MPOST

Haryana poised to emerge as EV & auto manufacturing hub: Saini

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Friday said the state government is moving rapidly towards establishing Haryana as a leading hub for electric vehicle (EV) and automobile manufacturing in the country. The Chief Minister made the remarks during a high-level meeting held at Haryana Bhawan in New Delhi, where he held detailed discussions with industry representatives, investors and senior officials on industrial development, investment opportunities and the creation of an integrated EV and automotive manufacturing ecosystem in the state. A presentation related to global EV manufacturer VinFast was also made during the meeting, highlighting potential investment and manufacturing opportunities in Haryana. Saini



also test-drove a VinFast vehicle on the occasion. Addressing the gathering, Saini said Haryana is among the fastest-growing industrial states in the country and offers investors transparent industrial policies, strong law and order, skilled manpower, modern infrastructure and excellent connectivity. He said the state’s proximity to the Delhi-NCR region, coupled with an extensive network of national highways and logistics facilities, makes Haryana an ideal destination for the automobile and EV industry. He said the Haryana Enterprise Promotion Centre is providing investors with all necessary approvals and services in a time-bound manner through a single-window system, thereby strengthening the ease of doing business framework in the state. Saini said the government is fully committed to promoting green energy, sustainable industrial growth and emerging technologies. He added that Haryana presents immense opportunities for investment in EV manufacturing, battery production, auto components and research and development. He said close coordination between the government and industry would help Haryana build a global identity in electric mobility and automobile manufacturing in the coming years. MPOST

ation for the automobile and EV industry. He said the Haryana Enterprise Promotion Centre is providing investors with all necessary approvals and services in a time-bound manner through a single-window system, thereby strengthening the ease of doing business framework in the state. Saini said the government is fully committed to promoting green energy, sustainable industrial growth and emerging technologies. He added that Haryana presents immense opportunities for investment in EV manufacturing, battery production, auto components and research and development. He said close coordination between the government and industry would help Haryana build a global identity in electric mobility and automobile manufacturing in the coming years. MPOST

India, Cyprus elevate ties to strategic partnership

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India and Cyprus on Friday elevated their ties to a strategic partnership and unveiled a five-year roadmap for defence cooperation as Prime Minister Narendra Modi held wide-ranging talks with Cyprus President Nikos Christodoulides. The two sides signed six agreements to provide for deeper cooperation in areas of innovation, technology, education and culture besides agreeing to soon conclude a comprehensive partnership on migration and mobility. The pacts firmed up included one on establishing a joint working group on counter-terrorism. The talks between the two leaders primarily focused on boosting ties in trade and investment, critical technologies, education, and implementation of the ambitious



PM Narendra Modi and Cyprus President Nikos Christodoulides during their meeting in New Delhi

India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor. In his media statement, Modi highlighted that the strategic partnership will unlock commercial capital and open new avenues for Indian companies in Cyprus’s infrastructure, energy, and agriculture sectors, while simultaneously boosting investment in India’s booming shipping and maritime industries. “The relationship between India and Cyprus has stood the test of time and again, with today’s decision to upgrade the ties to strategic partnership, we are going to give new ambition and new momentum to our relationship,” he said. Following the talks, the two sides also announced the establishment of a cyber security dialogue. Modi also referred to the upswing in India-

Europe relationship and said it has entered a new golden era. “Cyprus is one of India’s top 10 investors; over the past decade, investment from Cyprus to India has almost doubled. Trust has grown between the two countries.” In his remarks, Christodoulides, who kick started his three-day visit to India on Wednesday, said India and Cyprus decided to set up a joint task force for cooperation in key sectors such as infrastructure and shipping. The president said the partnership between the European Union and India must become even stronger in “these times of growing geopolitical uncertainty”. “Because together, the EU and India, the world’s largest democracy, can play a defining role not only for our regions, but also for global stability and prosperity,” Christodoulides said.

Nation Briefs

LUCKNOW JUDGES CYCLE TO COURT TO PROMOTE FUEL CONSERVATION

LUCKNOW: In a unique initiative aimed at spreading awareness about rising fuel consumption and environmental protection, around 70 judges in Lucknow cycled to court on Friday morning. The campaign was led by District Judge Malkhan Singh and flagged off by Justice Rajesh Chauhan of the Lucknow bench of the Allahabad High Court. All judicial officers gathered at the Dalibagh residence of District Judge Malkhan Singh before setting out for court on bicycles around 9 am. Through the initiative, the judges appealed to people to adopt fuel-saving measures and environmentally friendly modes of transport.

TINSUKIA: NFR COMPLETES MAJOR CURVE REALIGNMENT WORK

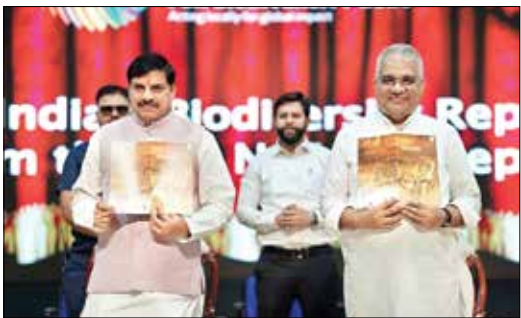
MALIGAON: The Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) has successfully completed a major curve realignment work in the Simaluguri-Moranhat section under Tinsukia Division in connection with the permanent removal of a Permanent Speed Restriction (PSR). The significant infrastructure improvement involved conversion of an existing 3-degree curve into a smoother 2-degree curve through cut and connection of track along with shifting of Overhead Equipment (OHE) masts and wires. The work was executed successfully with close coordination among the Engineering, Operating and Traction Distribution (TRD) departments during the traffic block period, reflecting the strong teamwork and operational efficiency of the division.

INTERNATIONAL DAY FOR BIOLOGICAL DIVERSITY 2026

MP CM, Union minister pitch local action for global biodiversity goals

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Friday said the state has emerged as a major centre for biodiversity conservation and wildlife protection in the country, highlighting the success of Project Cheetah and community-led conservation initiatives. Addressing the national-level celebration of the International Day for Biological Diversity 2026 at the Indian Institute of Forest Management in Bhopal, the Chief Minister said Madhya Pradesh, already recognised as the “Tiger State of India”, possesses rich ecological diversity comprising forests, wetlands and river ecosystems that support both livelihoods and ecological security. The event, themed “Acting Locally for Global Impact”, was organised by the Environment Ministry in collaboration with the state government, the National Biodiversity Authority and the International Big Cat Alliance. Highlighting the reintro-



duction of cheetahs in the state, CM Yadav described Project Cheetah as a landmark achievement in India’s conservation journey and a symbol of ecological restoration and biodiversity recovery. He said the project has strengthened habitat conservation, scientific wildlife management and community participation in conservation efforts. The Chief Minister also said the state has taken major steps to strengthen biodiversity governance through Biodiversity Management Committees and the preparation of People’s Biodiversity Registers, empowering local communities to conserve traditional knowledge and

biological resources. Union Environment, Forest and Climate Change Minister Bhopender Yadav said the theme of this year’s International Day for Biological Diversity underscored the importance of empowering communities and local institutions to achieve environmental sustainability and ecological security. He said India’s diverse ecosystems and community-led traditions such as sacred groves reflect the deep relationship between people and nature. Bhopender Yadav said nearly Rs 145 crore has been released under the ABS mechanism, benefiting around 11,000

HIGHLIGHTS

- » MP at forefront of wildlife conservation efforts: CM Yadav
- » MP strengthens biodiversity governance through local participation: CM
- » Bhopender Yadav calls for mission-mode biodiversity conservation



EDITORIAL

RETAIL ILLUSION

India's inflation debate is entering a far more complicated phase than recent retail inflation numbers suggest. On the surface, the situation appears reassuring. Consumer Price Index (CPI)-based inflation remains below the RBI's medium-term target of 4 per cent, offering policymakers some breathing space and consumers temporary relief. But beneath this apparent calm, wholesale inflation has surged sharply, exposing deep vulnerabilities building within the economy. The recent increase in petrol and diesel prices, implemented in two phases, is likely to intensify those pressures further. Economists estimate that the fuel price hike alone could add roughly 20 basis points to retail inflation over the coming months. More importantly, it signals that inflationary risks are no longer confined to isolated sectors but are spreading across the broader economic system. India may therefore be witnessing the beginning of a delayed inflation cycle.

The sharp divergence between wholesale and retail inflation tells an important story. While CPI inflation rose only marginally to 3.48 per cent in April from 3.40 per cent in March, Wholesale Price Index (WPI)-based inflation surged dramatically to 8.3 per cent — a 42-month high. This difference is not accidental. CPI reflects the prices ordinary consumers pay for food, transport, housing, healthcare and education, whereas WPI captures price movements at the wholesale level before products reach consumers. It is therefore often treated as an early warning signal for future inflation trends. The latest WPI surge has been driven overwhelmingly by fuel and energy prices. Inflation in the fuel and power category jumped to nearly 25 per cent in April from just over 1 per cent a month earlier, while crude petroleum inflation rose by more than 88 per cent following disruptions caused by the ongoing West Asia conflict. India's heavy dependence on imported crude oil makes it particularly vulnerable to such geopolitical shocks, and the consequences are now beginning to filter through the economy.

The concern lies not merely in the direct impact of higher petrol and diesel prices but in their powerful second-round effects. Fuel may carry a relatively smaller weight in the CPI basket, but its influence extends across nearly every sector of the economy. Diesel, especially, powers India's transport and logistics backbone — trucks, buses, agricultural pumps, industrial generators and freight systems. When diesel prices rise, transportation costs increase almost immediately. That, in turn, raises the cost of moving vegetables, milk, packaged goods, cement, steel and other essentials across the country. Farmers face higher irrigation and logistics expenses, manufacturers encounter rising input costs, and service providers eventually pass on these additional burdens to consumers. Inflation, in such situations, spreads quietly through supply chains before becoming fully visible in household budgets.

The inflation outlook is further clouded by uncertainty surrounding the monsoon and the possible impact of El Niño conditions. Food inflation continues to hold enormous significance in India because food items occupy a substantial share of the CPI basket. Any weather-related disruption affecting crop production could push up prices of cereals, vegetables and pulses at a time when fuel-driven inflationary pressures are already mounting. Recent increases in milk prices offer an early indication of how vulnerable food inflation remains. This places the RBI in a particularly delicate position. For much of the past year, the RBI has managed to maintain stability by keeping interest rates unchanged while benefiting from easing food inflation trends. However, the sharp rise in WPI inflation complicates the policy outlook considerably. Economists now expect wholesale inflation to remain elevated in the near term, particularly if crude oil prices stay high due to continued geopolitical tensions in West Asia.

The RBI is likely to maintain a cautious pause on interest rates rather than rushing toward monetary easing. The central bank will closely monitor global crude oil prices, the monsoon's impact on food production and the extent to which wholesale inflation passes through into retail prices. At the same time, it must also focus on protecting currency stability as rising oil import costs continue to pressure the rupee. The broader concern, however, extends beyond immediate policy decisions. India's economy is becoming increasingly exposed to global geopolitical instability, commodity price shocks and supply chain disruptions. Events unfolding thousands of kilometres away now directly shape fuel prices, transport costs and eventually grocery bills within Indian households. The recent rise in wholesale inflation is a warning that deeper inflationary pressures are building beneath the surface. Policymakers would be mistaken to interpret low retail inflation as a sign that the inflation battle has been won.

STATECRAFT



PRABHU DAYAL

THE WRITER IS A RETIRED INDIAN DIPLOMAT AND HAD PREVIOUSLY SERVED AS CONSUL GENERAL IN NEW YORK

The demands of a diplomat are fundamentally different from those of a domestic administrator

IFS Needs its Own Exam

The traditional UPSC framework has produced capable diplomats, but the growing complexity of global geopolitics demands a more specialised, aptitude-driven recruitment system for the Indian Foreign Service

The Indian Foreign Service (IFS) serves as the vanguard of India's global interests, shaping foreign policy and representing the nation in a complex, multipolar world. Currently, IFS officers are recruited through the same competitive Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) Civil Services Examination (CSE) used to select administrators for domestic services like the IAS and IPS. While this traditional route has produced highly capable diplomats, India's expanding global footprint demands a reevaluation. Institutionalising a separate entrance examination tailored for the IFS would ensure that the country's diplomatic corps possesses the specialised skill sets, academic backgrounds, and temperamental fitness required in modern international relations.

The demands of an IFS officer are fundamentally different from those of domestic civil servants. An IAS or IPS officer requires deep grassroots-level understanding, local language proficiency, and crisis management in a regional context. Conversely, a diplomat must navigate international law, complex global trade agreements, strategic geopolitics, and cross-cultural negotiations. A separate entrance exam



A specialised IFS exam can produce diplomats better equipped for modern global complexities

can be structured to test domain knowledge in subjects like International Relations, global economics, strategic studies, and world history. This would ensure that recruits hit the ground running, rather than relying solely on post-selection training to build a foundational understanding of foreign affairs.

Currently, candidates are allocated to the IFS based on their rank in the UPSC CSE and their personal preferences. Because the top choices are

often dominated by the desire for domestic administrative power (IAS), some candidates are allotted to the foreign service as a second or third preference. A separate exam would guarantee that every candidate who enters the service does so out of a genuine passion for diplomacy and global affairs. It would attract individuals inherently suited to the nomadic lifestyle, cultural adaptability, and representational duties required of a career diplomat.

The current UPSC CSE framework is broad but does not specifically test qualities that are non-negotiable for a diplomat. A specialised exam for the IFS could incorporate rigorous testing of foreign language proficiency, superior written and spoken English, and high-level negotiation or public speaking skills. As noted by parliamentary panels, the ability to fluently articulate India's perspective on the world stage—and to understand the nuances of foreign cul-

tures—requires a distinct testing mechanism that goes beyond traditional general studies.

Today's global diplomacy extends far beyond traditional political alliances; it encompasses climate change negotiations, cyber diplomacy, space cooperation, and global health. To effectively engage in these specialised fields, India needs a foreign service that can recruit experts, academics, and individuals with interdisciplinary academic backgrounds. A separate entrance mechanism could be designed to accommodate diverse educational profiles and even lateral entry models, helping to expand India's diplomatic corps to a size commensurate with its global aspirations.

While the traditional UPSC examination has served India well, the evolution of global diplomacy and India's rising prominence necessitate a modernised recruitment approach. Implementing a separate entrance exam for the Indian Foreign Service will transform it into a highly specialised, aptitude-driven corps. By selecting candidates who have a genuine passion and specific skill set for international relations, India can ensure its diplomats are fully equipped to navigate the strategic, economic, and cultural complexities of the 21st century. Views expressed are personal

AT VANTAGE



SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

What's the future and how do we deal with the steamrolling of "real story fakes" into every aspect of our lives? That's a tricky one

Artificial Lies, Real Damage

AI-generated deepfakes are now obfuscating sensitive legal matters including a high-profile sexual harassment case on Wall Street

I'm so sick of reading AI dribble. Perfectly framed sentences and yet devoid of depth. You read them but glean nothing much out of it. The meandering sentences, the repetitions, the "not only - but also" tropes, a stream of utterly disinteresting AI consciousness lacking human imperfections and heart. There are now AI creators dishing out all kinds of wisdom from financial health to physical wellness. They are so convincing in their sage advice that it takes multiple checks to reconfirm the veracity. Without knowing the authority figure behind them, I find their suggestions hard to accept. Call it the doubting mind of a former journalist, but I'm cynical like that.

Artificial intelligence has its uses, of course. It's quickening innovation at breakneck speed, and enterprising individuals are changing the world with the help of AI. It's making quick work of hours of grunt labour, and obviously, its real impact on jobs is an unfolding saga. But using precious resources (remember that running AI models expends massive amounts of water and electricity) to create AI-generated images for pleasure and writing LinkedIn-worthy glib, is plain lazy and destructive. God gave us a brain to use it, to sharpen it with exercise, not dull it with lack of practice. And in the age of AI exacerbating human superfluity, not using one's natural talents is sacrilege, and plain dumb if you ask me. All in all though, the use of AI to create videos, avatars, and puke-worthy social media posts isn't immediately insidious; its long-term effect may lead to dumber humans but largely its impact on social content is meh! What's problematic though is when AI is used to defraud people, create dangerous deepfakes, and as we are seeing in a recently unraveling case, muddy perceptions in sensitive matters.

It read like a high-powered bordering-on-sleazy Hollywood flick. Sexual harassment in the corridors of Wall Street; the perpetrator — an attractive woman banker at one of America's largest multinational banking institutions. A rare instance indeed that grabbed headlines and assumed virality rather quickly due to the case's prurient and titillating content. A former JPMorgan employee filed a sexual assault and discrimination lawsuit against a female co-worker. There were explosive allegations of drugging, rape, sex under duress, racial slurs, abuse of power, of



AI-generated falsehoods are no longer harmless internet clutter; they are becoming weapons of perception

being treated like a "sex slave" with threats of blocked promotion and bonus, and so on. The suit was filed under the pseudonym "John Doe" against Lorna Hajdini accusing her of sexual misconduct. The complainant's identity was later revealed as one, Chirayu Rana, who apparently refused to cooperate with the firm's investigations. JPMorgan is said to have offered Rana USD 1 million to prevent the case from going public; an offer that Rana refused. Since the salacious allegations, Hajdini, who has been denying all charges, has filed a countersuit against the ex-banker, claiming that his complaints were fabricated and defamatory in nature.

The case was sensitive and controversial enough, and then came AI, adding fuel to the fire. A slew of AI-generated deepfakes and sexually suggestive memes have flooded the Internet, besmirching the case. Hajdini and Rana are shown to be on dates, addressing the camera in finely tailored clothes, running through a city engulfed in flames with Hajdini shoving Rana aside — all of them intended to confuse and obfuscate. Women at the receiving end of sexual harassment cases are rare, and while one doesn't discount that they may exist, the reported reality proves that such cases are few and far between. Therefore, the JPMorgan case, with its reversal of stereotypical gender reversal, caught

the attention of content farms that ride news trends with "real story fakes" and exploit them for monetisation. They also simultaneously, and eventually, deplete the public's trust in actual journalistic reporting.

Keeping in mind the troubled legacy of women mostly being the victims, the misuse of AI is extremely dangerous, also because it's akin to a kind of tech-driven gaslighting. Public discourse, perceptions, debates, and social thinking will get polluted by the misapplication of AI. If the JPMorgan case turns out to be phoney, the proliferation of such content on social media would have already destroyed the reputation and emotional balance of executives. If Rana's allegations turn out to be true, AI has helped introduce an element of frivolity through cheeky memes to the rather grave issue of sexual harassment at the workplace. Deepfakes claiming that Hajdini and Rana were involved in a consensual relationship once again add inauthentic layers to the case.

What's the future and how do we deal with the steamrolling of "real story fakes" into every aspect of our lives? That's a tricky one. Social platforms would have to moderate and remove false content with speed. We, as consumers, would need to question everything that we read and see; report fake content whenever required. Views expressed are personal

Decline of Civic Reason

Plato's warning on rhetoric and spectacle echoes in modern Indian democracy

DEBAPRIYA MUKHERJEE

As an observer of electoral politics — and increasingly of democratic life across India — one is compelled to confront an uncomfortable truth: Indian democracy, though vigorous in participation, appears increasingly fragile in purpose. Elections, through which citizens are expected to exercise sober judgment, too often unfold as theatres of rhetoric, partisan spectacle, and emotional mobilisation rather than serious contests of ideas, competence, and national vision. Political competition intensifies, yet democratic deliberation steadily weakens. In this troubled times, the political philosophy of Plato acquires renewed relevance.

Democracy remains one of civilisation's noblest achievements. It rests on the principle that political power must arise from the consent of free and equal citizens. Yet democracy contains a paradox: it guarantees the right to choose rulers, but not the wisdom to choose them well. It was precisely this contradiction that troubled Plato.

In *The Republic*, Plato warned against democracy's vulnerability to manipulation and the decline of public reason. Citizens, he feared, could be swayed by rhetoric instead of sound judgment. Leaders might rise not through wisdom or moral discipline, but by mastering the art of pleasing the crowd. Politics, in such a condition, becomes governed by spectacle and factional rivalry rather than rational deliberation.

His warning carries striking relevance in contemporary India. Across the democratic landscape, substantive political discourse is increasingly eclipsed by spectacle. Electoral campaigns are often dominated by slogans rather than policy, symbolism rather than governance, and confrontation rather than constructive debate. Questions that should shape India's future — education, healthcare, scientific advancement,

employment generation, environmental sustainability, and institutional accountability — frequently receive less attention than narratives designed to polarise or emotionally mobilise voters.

Democracy enters dangerous terrain when political influence penetrates institutions that should remain guided by professionalism and constitutional principles. Education suffers when intellectual freedom yields to ideology. Healthcare weakens when priorities are shaped by optics rather than scientific planning. Administrative institutions lose credibility when merit is overshadowed by patronage. Public trust weakens, institutional independence erodes, and democracy retains its outer form while its inner spirit slowly decays.

Yet Plato's enduring lesson lies not merely in criticism, but in what governance requires: knowledge, ethical discipline, and enlightened leadership. Modern democracy may reject rule by a philosophical elite, but it cannot dismiss Plato's central truth that a complex society cannot be sustainably governed by ignorance, impulse, or spectacle.

India today stands at a democratic crossroads. It possesses immense intellectual capital, youthful energy, constitutional strength, and developmental potential. But institutions alone cannot secure democratic vitality. A republic flourishes only when citizens demand seriousness in leadership and when leaders rise above partisan calculation to embrace national purpose.

The urgent task before India is not merely to preserve democracy's machinery, but to restore its moral and intellectual foundations. Civic education must cultivate critical thought and scientific temper. Political discourse must return to policy, evidence and reasoned debate. Above all, leadership must once again be measured not by spectacle or popularity, but by competence, integrity, and vision. Views expressed are personal

THE TALKS CONFIRMED BY TWO IRANIAN OFFICIALS TO NYT

Iran, Oman in talks over Strait of Hormuz ship payment system

DUBAI: Iran is quietly negotiating with the Gulf state of Oman over a plan to charge vessels for passing through the Strait of Hormuz, a move that puts Tehran on a direct collision course with US President Donald Trump even as both sides claim to be working toward a diplomatic resolution, according to a New York Times report.

Behind the public posturing of ceasefire declarations and diplomatic overtures, Iran and Oman have been holding discussions over something far more concrete: a system that would generate revenue from one of the busiest and most consequential shipping lanes on heart- Strait of Hormuz.

The talks, confirmed by two Iranian officials to New York Times, centre on a proposed arrangement in which vessels transiting the Strait of Hormuz would be charged fees, with Oman receiving a share of the proceeds.

The recent New York Times report provided deeper context



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to US Secretary of State Marco Rubio's warnings, confirming that Tehran is indeed engaged in low-profile discussions with Muscat over a collaborative economic blueprint.

According to the report, two Iranian officials confirmed that the proposed arrangement would charge vessels for passing through the Strait of Hor-

muz, with Oman receiving a share of the revenue.

While Muscat was initially cool to the idea due to potential international friction, its perspective shifted considerably after calculating the projected financial upside of participation.

This quiet revenue-generation plan, however, puts Tehran

Highlights

- » This quiet revenue-generation plan, puts Tehran on a direct collision course with US President Donald Trump
- » Rubio warned that Tehran is indeed engaged in low-profile discussions with Muscat over a collaborative economic blueprint
- » Trump explicitly backed the robust maritime restrictions enforced by US forces

robust maritime restrictions enforced by US forces, declaring, "We have total control of the Strait of Hormuz with our blockade."

Iran will not get nuclear weapons, or we'll do something drastic."

Trump claimed the naval encirclement has been "100 per cent effective", describing it as a "steel wall" preventing unauthorised movement.

He emphasised that Washington's ultimate objective is to restore completely free international passage, noting, "We want it free, we don't want tolls. It's international; it's an international waterway."

Beyond the shipping lane, the nuclear dimension remains a major fault line driving this naval blockade.

Trump reaffirmed that Washington will not allow Tehran to keep its highly refined nuclear stockpiles, estimated by experts at 900 pounds of highly enriched uranium -- an amount ample for weapons application.

AGENCIES

NATO allies bewildered over US troops deployment in Europe

HELSINGBORG: NATO allies and defence officials expressed bewilderment on Friday at US President Donald Trump's announcement that he would send 5,000 US troops to Poland just weeks after he ordered the same number of forces pulled out of Europe.

The apparent change of mind came after weeks of statements from Trump and his administration about reducing -- not increasing -- the American military footprint in Europe. Trump's initial order set off a flurry of action among military commanders and left allies already doubtful about America's commitment to Europe's security to ponder what forces they might have to backfill on NATO's eastern flank with Russia and Ukraine.

Earlier this month, the Trump administration said it was reducing levels in Europe by about 5,000 troops, and US officials confirmed about 4,000 service members were no longer deploying to Poland. The dispatch to Germany of US personnel trained to fire long-range missiles was also halted.

But in a post on Truth Social on Thursday, Trump said he would send "an additional 5,000 Troops to Poland", citing



US Secretary of State Marco Rubio meets the press after the NATO Foreign Ministers' meeting in Helsingborg on Friday AP/PTI

Earlier this month, US said it was reducing levels in Europe by about 5,000 troops

his strong ties with Polish President Karol Nawrocki, whom Trump endorsed in elections last year.

"It is confusing indeed, and not always easy to navigate," Swedish Foreign Minister Maria Malmer Stenergard told reporters at a meeting Friday that she was hosting of her NATO counterparts, including

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio. Ministers from the Netherlands and Norway were sanguine about Trump's latest move, as was Latvian Foreign Minister Baiba Braze, who said allies knew the US troop "posture was being reconsidered, and now there is no change of posture. For now".

US defence officials also expressed confusion. "We just spent the better part of two weeks reacting to the first announcement. We don't know what this means either," said one of two officials who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive military matters. AGENCIES

UPGRADES RISK ASSESSMENT

Ebola spreading rapidly in Congo: WHO chief

BUNIA: The World Health Organisation chief said Friday that the Ebola outbreak in Congo is spreading rapidly and now poses a "very high" risk there, as a lack of medical resources and anger among the population hamper the response in a vulnerable and conflict-ridden region.

WHO Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus said the risk of global spread remains low, but that the UN health agency was revising upward its assessment of the risk within Congo from its previous categorization of "high."

The WHO chief noted that 82 cases have been confirmed in Congo, with seven confirmed deaths, though he said the outbreak is believed to be



Director-General of the World Health Organisation, Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus

"much larger." He said there are now almost 750 suspected cases and 177 suspected deaths.

Supplies were being rushed to Ituri province in the northeastern corner of the country, where the illness has been spreading for weeks in areas where many people have been displaced by

BODIES OF EBOLA VICTIMS CAN BE HIGHLY CONTAGIOUS, AND MEDICAL AUTHORITIES ARE TRYING TO CONTROL BURIALS WHENEVER POSSIBLE

armed conflict.

Frontline medical staff have struggled with a lack of resources and, in some cases, pushback due to what has been characterised as misinformation or situations where medical policy has clashed with local customs such as burial rites.

On Thursday, an Ebola treatment centre in Rwampara was set on fire by youths who were angered when they were blocked from retrieving the body of a friend who apparently had died of Ebola, according to witnesses and police.

Bodies of Ebola victims can be highly contagious, and medical authorities are trying to control burials whenever possible.

Julienne Lusenge, president of Women's Solidarity for Inclusive Peace and Development, a local aid group, said the population's anger is mostly due to misinformation.

"We have lived through years and years of conflict and hardship so rumours spread easily," she said. AGENCIES

Pak Army Chief leaves for Tehran amidst efforts to end US-Iran war

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan Army Chief Field Marshal Asim Munir on Friday left for a crucial visit to Tehran amidst efforts to broker a peace deal between the US and Iran to end the war in the region, according to security sources. His second visit to Tehran in little more than a month comes after progress was reported in talks held by Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi, who has been in Iran since Wednesday, with top Iranian leadership, including twice with Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi, according to sources.

Field Marshal Munir will meet with important Iranian dignitaries and discuss Iran-US talks, peace in the region and other important issues during his visit to Iran, they said.

Separately, Iran's state-run Press TV quoted the official IRNA news agency as saying that Field Marshal Munir is en route to Tehran to hold talks with Iranian officials. His visit comes after Foreign Office spokesperson Tahir Andrabi, when asked about it, said he could "neither deny nor confirm" reports about a "high-level delegation" visiting Iran from Pakistan. US Secretary of State Marco Rubio on Thursday said he believed that "Pakistanis will be travelling to Tehran today", while Naqvi was already in Tehran and holding meetings with the political leadership. AGENCIES

Israeli strikes on southern Lebanon kill 10, including paramedics, child

BEIRUT: Israeli airstrikes on southern Lebanon Friday killed 10 people, including six paramedics and a Syrian girl, Lebanon's Health Ministry said, the latest in near-daily attacks from both sides that have not stopped despite the fragile, US-brokered ceasefire in the Israel-Hezbollah war.

The first strike hit the village of Hanouiyeh, killing four paramedics working for Hezbollah's Islamic Health Association and wounding two others including one paramedic, the ministry said.

Another strike Friday morning on the village of Deir Qanoun al Nahr in the coastal Tyre province killed six people, including a



A damaged mosque being seen next of the destroyed Hezbollah paramedic center (right), which was hit in an Israeli airstrike on Tuesday in the village of Maashouk AP/PTI

Syrian child and two paramedics from the Al-Rissala Scouts Association, a paramedic group

affiliated with Hezbollah's ally, the Amal movement, the ministry said. AGENCIES

Pak PM to visit China from May 23-26

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan on Friday announced that Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif will travel to China from May 23-26, during which he will hold talks with President Xi Jinping and Premier Li Qiang.

His visit assumed special significance as the two countries are also commemorating the 75th anniversary of the establishment of diplomatic ties, Foreign Office spokesperson Tahir Andrabi said in a statement.

A day earlier, Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun in Beijing announced PM Shehbaz's visit

at the invitation of Premier Li. "The visit will provide an opportunity to reaffirm the abiding strength of the Pakistan-China all-weather strategic partnership and advance a shared vision of building an even closer Pakistan-China community of a shared future," Andrabi said. He said that during the visit, PM Shehbaz would hold meetings with the Chinese leadership, including President Xi and Premier Li.

"The two sides will review bilateral relations, and cooperation in political, economic and strategic domains," he said. AGENCIES

US hasn't notified it of any pause in a planned \$14 bn arms sale: Taiwan

TAIPEI: Taiwan hasn't been notified of any pause in a planned \$14 billion US arms sale to the self-governing island, a government official said Friday, after the acting US Navy secretary told a Senate committee in Washington that some foreign military sales were being delayed to ensure the American military has enough munitions for the Iran war.

Days after US President Donald Trump raised doubts about continuing arms sales



Taiwan's President Lai Ching-te

to Taiwan, which China claims as its own territory, acting US Navy Secretary Hung Cao said Thursday that

the sales would resume when the administration considers it appropriate.

"Right now we're doing a pause in order to make sure we have the munitions we need for 'Epic Fury,'" Cao told the US Senate Appropriations Defence Subcommittee, referring to the Trump administration's name for the Iran operation.

"Then the foreign military sales will continue when the administration deems necessary." AGENCIES

INDIANS AFFECTED THE MOST H-1B visa applications drop 38.5% after Trump admin tightens rules

WASHINGTON: Registrations for H-1B visas dropped by 38.5 per cent in fiscal year 2027 with the US saying it had approved more applicants with advanced degrees and higher salaries of those "making a real impact on the economy."

The decision by the US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) is likely to affect the Indians the most, who made up an estimated 71 per cent of all approved H-1B applications in recent years.

In a post on X on Thursday, the USCIS said only 17.7 per cent of all selected registrations were in the lowest wage category.

"The number of properly submitted registrations plummeted by 38.5 per cent, from 3,43,981 in fiscal year 2026 to just 2,11,600 in fiscal year 2027," the USCIS said.

Nearly three-fourths of the applications approved were of persons holding masters degrees or higher, the USCIS said. "We're approving more

applicants with advanced degrees and higher salaries -- especially those who studied at US universities. An overwhelming 71.5 per cent of selected aliens hold a US master's degree or higher, compared to 57 per cent last year," it said.

It said these skilled workers are making a real impact on the economy and the US was closing the door on the low-wage and low-skilled foreign labour pipeline approved under Biden administration policies.

"This year, only 17.7 per cent of all selected registrations were in the lowest wage category," the USCIS said.

"This data is a clear sign that the days of abusing the programme with mass, low-wage registrations are over, and that the programme is better serving its intended purpose of attracting highly skilled foreign workers and protecting the wages, working conditions, and job opportunities of American workers," it said. AGENCIES

Pushed to limit, Republicans show rare defiance to Trump's demands

Anger in the Senate over Trump's 'payout for punks'

WASHINGTON: The day arrived when the Senate just said, No.

President Donald Trump's political revenge tour met its potential match this week as angry, upset Republican senators, pushed to a breaking point by his seemingly insatiable and outlandish demands -- particularly a USD 1.776 billion fund for January 6 rioters and others he believes were wrongly prosecuted -- did the unthinkable.

They simply refused, closed up shop, and went home.

The moment was as rare as it was daring, a sudden flex from the Congress that has become a shell of its former self as a coequal branch, the Republican majority almost always more willing to accommodate the Republican president than to confront him.

The result left in shambles, for now, the GOP's top priority of passing a roughly USD 70 billion budget package that would fuel Trump's immigration and deportation operations for



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the remainder of his presidential term, into 2029. The voting was postponed until Congress resumes next month, blowing Trump's June 1 deadline to have it on his desk.

Trump, asked during an event at the Oval Office if he was losing control of the Senate, shrugged.

"I really don't know," the president said.

It all caps a bruising week after the presi-

dent swept midterm primary elections, taking down one Republican after another -- Sen Bill Cassidy in Louisiana and Rep Thomas Massie in Kentucky, and endorsing the challenger to Sen John Cornyn in Texas -- turning the might of his Make America Great Again (MAGA) movement against those who have stuck to their own views, rather than yield to his.

And it wasn't just the Senate.

Trump's political revenge tour met its potential match this week as angry, upset Republican senators, pushed to a breaking point by his seemingly insatiable and outlandish demands

In the Republican-led House, for the first time this year, enough GOP lawmakers broke ranks to signal support for a war powers resolution from Democrats designed to halt Trump's military action in Iran.

House Speaker Mike Johnson postponed voting until he could ensure an outcome that avoids confronting the president.

The endgame leaves Trump and the party exposed in new ways. AGENCIES

World Briefs

BLAST AT HUNGARY PETROCHEMICAL PLANT KILLS 1, INJURES 7

TISZAUJVAROS: An explosion at a petrochemical plant in Hungary on Friday killed one person and injured several others, according to a statement by Hungarian energy company Mol Group, which owns the plant. The explosion in Tiszaujvaros, in eastern Hungary, occurred during a restart of the plant following maintenance, Prime Minister Peter Magyar said in a post on social media. He added that seven people had suffered burn injuries during the blast. Five helicopters transported the injured to hospitals in the cities of Miskolc and Debrecen, according to Minister of Economy and Energy Istvan Kapitanay.

US APPROVES MODEST ARMS SALE FOR UKRAINE TO SUSTAIN AIR DEFENCES

WASHINGTON: The Trump administration has approved a modest \$108 million arms sale to Ukraine that will help the country maintain and sustain its midrange air defence missile system. The US State Department announced the sale of ground-to-air Hawk missile components, spare parts and logistic support late Thursday. The administration has notably reduced military support for Ukraine over the past 18 months. The sale "will improve Ukraine's capability to meet current and future threats by further equipping it to conduct self-defence and regional security missions with a more robust integrated air defence capability," the department said in a statement.

millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS LOST & FOUND
It is notified to public information that my 2nd year original marksheet of B.Tech(CSE) course 2016-2020, Roll No. 1681010045, Enrollment number- 168101076320 issued By Greater Noida Institute of Technology have been lost/ misplaced during my travel to home from a job interview. Tushar Bhardwaj S/o Balram Krishan R/o C-1 third floor, C-222, Street no. 15 Chattarpur enclave phase 2, Delhi, 110074.

JHARKHAND BIJLI VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED (CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd. Office:- Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004. fax # 0651-2400483 e-mail : cesp.jseb@rediffmail.com/ gmssp.jbvn@rediffmail.com CANCELLATION NOTICE
CANCELLATION NOTICE
Due to some unavoidable circumstances NIT No. 213/PR/JBV/NL/2025-26 & 216/PR/JBV/NL/2025-26 is hereby cancelled.
स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचावों। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को टोल फ्री नं० 1800 345 6570 पर दर्ज कराये।
PR No. 363738 Sd/- Dy. General Manager Purchase
PR 380540 (Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd) 26-27 (D)

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BARIPADA
"e" Procurement Notice for Bridge Works
Identification No.- Online Tender- Bridge N.C.B. No. 414 for 2026-27.
Letter No. 2823 / Date, 14/05/2026 //
1. Name of the work :- Bridge works under SBY in the District of Mayurbhanj
2. Total No. of work :- 03 Nos (Three)
3. Estimated Cost :- Rs.337.84 lakhs to Rs.470.63 lakhs (approximately)..
4. Eligible Class of Contractor :- As per annexure.
5. Period of Completion :- As per annexure.
6. Other details :-
Further details can be seen from the website: www.tendersorissa.gov.in.
Any Corrigendum / Addendum will be displayed in the above e_tender website only.
Sd/- Er. A.K. Naik Chief Construction Engineer, R.W. Circle, Baripada.
25001/25130/1/26-27/0011

D.D. VENTURES LIMITED
CIN No. :- L50102DL1984PLC017834
Regd. Office :- 68-68/1, Basement-1, Najafgarh Road, Industrial Area, Moti Nagar, West Delhi, India, 110015
Email Id: a.bhaskar@ddmotors.net, Website: www.ddventures.in, Tel. No. 011-44400444
Extract of Statement of Standalone Audited Financial Results for the Quarter & Year ended March 31, 2026
(Rs. in Lakhs)
Sr. No. Particulars QUARTER ENDED 31.03.2026 31.03.2025 YEAR ENDED 31.03.2026 31.03.2025
1 Total Income from Operations 8.16 16.30 8.16 28.80
2 Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items) 6.59 15.06 1.27 0.24
3 Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items) 6.59 15.06 1.27 0.24
4 Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items) 6.63 15.02 1.31 0.20
5 Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)] 6.63 15.02 1.31 0.20
6 Equity Share Capital 94.60 94.60 94.60 94.60
7 Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet -92.64 -96.57 -92.64 -96.57
8 Earning Per Share (of Rs. 1/- each) P.Y Rs. 10/- Each 0.07 1.59 0.01 0.02
2. Diluted : 0.07 1.59 0.01 0.02
We declare that the Audit Report issued by the Statutory Auditors of the Company on the Quarterly & Annual Audited Financial Results for the period ended on March 31, 2026 is unmodified.
Notes:
1. The above result has been reviewed by the Audit Committee and adopted by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on May 22, 2026
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Audited Financial Results for the Quarter and Year ended 31.03.2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly and Yearly Audited Financial Results is available on the websites of the Stock Exchange www.mseil.in and the Company www.ddventures.in.
For and on behalf of the Board of D. D. Ventures Limited
Sd/- Renu Gambhir Director DIN: 01239511
Place : New Delhi Date : May 22, 2026

BSES BSes Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi
TENDER NOTICE Date: 23.05.2026
Sealed tenders under two parts (Un priced & priced) are invite for the supply of following materials from all bidders:-
NIT No. Brief Item Description Estimated Cost (₹) Cost of EMD (₹) Due Date & Time of Submission Date & Time of Opening
CMC/BR/26-27/FK/CR/SS/1362 CIVIL WORKS FOR PROVIDING CABLE DUCT FOR LAYING 72 NOS. CABLES IN FRONT OF PULLMAN HOTEL AT IGI AIRPORT, DIAL – AEROCITY, NEW DELHI. 2.70 Crores 5.40 Lakhs 12.06.2026 15:00 HRS 12.06.2025 15:15 HRS
CMC/BR/26-27/FK/PR/SS/1363 SUPPLY OF 7561 NOS. 9MTRS (160KG) AND 3327 NOS. 11MTRS (365KG) PSC POLES. 6.35 Crores 6.35 Lakhs 05.06.2026 15:00 HRS 05.06.2026 15:30 HRS
Cost of each Tender Document: ₹ 1180/-
For any query call on 011-49107235 or e-mail on Brpl.Eauction@relianceada.com
For details in respect of Equipment/BOM/Services, Qualifying requirements, Terms & conditions, purchase/submission of tender documents etc. please visit our website www.bsesselhi.com Head (Contracts & Materials)
Regd. Off. : BSes Rajdhani Power Limited, BSes Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019 | Corporate Identification No.: U40109DL2001PLC111527 Telephone No. : +91 11 4910 7235 | Website : www.bsesselhi.com

DELHI ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION
Viniyamak Bhawan, C-Block, Shivajik, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-110 017
Website: www.derc.gov.in. | Telefax: 41080417
PUBLIC NOTICE
PETITIONS FOR TRUE-UP OF EXPENSES OF FY 2023-24 FILED BY GENERATION COMPANIES (IPGCL & PPCL) AND DISTRIBUTION COMPANIES (NDMC & TPDDL)
1. The Generation Companies viz. Indraprastha Power Generation Co. Ltd. (IPGCL) & Pragati Power Corporation Ltd. (PPCL) and Distribution Companies viz. New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) and Tata Power Delhi Distribution Ltd. (TPDDL) have filed their Petitions for approval of True-up of expenses of FY 2023-24 before the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission ("DERC") of "The Commission".
2. The Petitioners have filed their respective Petitions under the provisions of the Electricity Act, 2003, DERC (Comprehensive Conduct of Business) Regulations, 2001, DERC (Terms and Conditions for determination of Tariff) Regulations, 2017 and DERC (Business Plan) Regulations, 2017, 2019 & 2023. The Commission has admitted the Petitions vide its Order dated 12/12/2025 and 23/04/2026 subject to clarifications/additional information, if any, that may be sought from time to time.
3. The Commission has prepared and uploaded the Executive Summary of these Petitions on its website https://www.derc.gov.in/
4. In accordance with the provisions of the DERC (Comprehensive Conduct of Business) Regulations, 2001, the Commission hereby seeks comments/ suggestions from the consumers and other stakeholders on the above Petitions. The comments/suggestions may be sent to the Secretary of the Commission at the above office address latest by 5/06/2026. The comments/suggestions may be submitted personally or by post or through E-mail to the Commission. The comments/suggestions can also be E-mailed to the Secretary, DERC at the e-mail address secy@derc@nic.in
5. The Commission shall hold a Public Hearing on Hybrid Mode (Physically and Virtually) with the responding stakeholders on 5/06/2026 and the procedure of registration for Public Hearing is also uploaded on the website of the Commission.
6. The Commission shall scrutinize the True-up Petitions and seek further clarifications from the Petitioners, if required. By way of an Order, the Commission shall approve the True-up of expenses of FY 2023-24 after prudence check. The Orders on the True-up Petitions shall be issued after

considering the comments/suggestions received from various stakeholders.
7. The Commission may extend assistance to consumers in understanding the True-up Petitions and may also help them to file their comments in this regard. Accordingly, the Commission has nominated the following officers to extend necessary assistance to all such consumers, who may so desire. Discussions may be held after seeking prior appointment.
● Sh. Amit Arora, Joint Director (Tariff-Engineering), Ph. No. 41080417 Ext. 117
● Sh. Kushalkumar Laxmanrao Bhosikar, Joint Director (PS&E), Ph. No. 41080417 Ext. 120
● Sh. Abhishek Srivastava, Dy. Director (T&D), Ph. No. 41080417 Ext. 142
● Sh. Shray Saxena, Dy. Director (Tariff-Engineering), Ph. No. 41080417 Ext. 127
● Sh. Praveen Kumar, Manager (Technical), Ph. 41080417 Ext. 111
8. The complete Petitions filed by the utilities can be downloaded from the website of the Commission i.e. https://www.derc.gov.in/ and the Petitioners. A soft copy of the Petition may be obtained in CD on payment of Rs. 25/- per CD or a copy of the Petition may be purchased from the respective Petitioner's Head Office on any working day till 5/06/2026 between 11.00 AM to 4.00 PM on payment of Rs. 100/-either by cash or by Demand Draft/Pay Order payable at New Delhi as per the details given below:
Indraprastha Power Generation Corporation Ltd. Himadri, Rajghat Power House Complex, New Delhi-110 002 Website: www.ipgcl-ppcl.gov.in Phone: 011-23273542/44
Pragati Power Corporation Ltd., Himadri, Rajghat Power House Complex, New Delhi-110 002 Website: www.ipgcl-ppcl.gov.in Phone: 011-23273542/44
New Delhi Municipal Council, Palika Kendra, Sansad Marg, New Delhi-110001 Website: www.ndmc.gov.in Phone: 011-23341605
Tata Power Delhi Distribution Ltd., Substation Building, Hudson Lines, Kingsway Camp, New Delhi-110 009 Website: www.tatapower-ddl.com Phone: 19124
Sd/- Joint Director (Tariff-Engineering) Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission
PRASHASTI DE Deputy Director (Pers.) Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission C-Block, Shivajik, Malviya Nagar New Delhi-110017
DIP/SHABDARTH/CLASSIFIED/0065/26-27

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!
IMPORTANT INFORMATION
INTRODUCTION OF REGULAR RUN OF BHUJ - DELHI JN. - BHUJ EXPRESS TRAIN
For the convenience of rail passengers Railways have decided to introduce the regular run of Train No. 19403/19404 Bhuj - Delhi Jn. - Bhuj Express as per the details mentioned below :-
19403/19404 BHUJ - DELHI JN. BHUJ EXPRESS TRAIN (DAILY)
Train No. 19403 STATIONS Train No. 19404
ARR. DEP. ARR. DEP.
--- 11:15 Bhuj 19:35 ---
11:45 --- Delhi Jn. --- 16:40
Days of run :- 19403 Ex. Bhuj on everyday from 23.05.2026 and 19404 Ex. Delhi Jn. on everyday from 24.05.2026.
Composition : 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper and General.
Stoppages : Anjar, Gandhidham, Bhachau, Bhildi, Dhanera, Raniwara, Marwar Bhinmal, Modran, Jalor, Mokalsar, Samdari, Luni, Pali Marwar, Marwar, Beawar, Ajmer, Kishangarh, Jaipur, Gandhinagar Jaipur, Bandikui, Alwar & Rewari Stations.
For detailed information, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in
Visit RailMadad website:- www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in Download RailMadad app.
NORTHERN RAILWAY Always at your service Visit us at : www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in
Serving Customers with a Smile

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, LOWER SUKTEL IRRIGATION PROJECT, BALANGIR, AT- LALTIKRA, DIST:- BALANGIR, PIN-767002. email-id: ccsp@ngmail.com
Government of Odisha "e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE
No.3/2026-27 of CCE, LSP, Balangir
1 Type of work CONSTRUCTION, RENOVATION OF TANKS AND CONSTRUCTION OF LINK ROAD AT RR COLONIES HARDATA, DHULSAR, KUSMEL NORTH AND KUSMEL SOUTH UNDER LSP, BALANGIR.
2 Nos. of works 5 (five) no. of package
3 Class of Contractor 'B' or 'A' Class Contractor
4 BID identification number 8/2026-27 to 12/12/2026-27 of CCE, LSP, Balangir
5 Estimated Cost Rs.1,05,60,361 /- to Rs.1,27,77,078/-
6 Period of completion 6 (Six) months
7 Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal 28.05.2026 at 10.30 AM to 12.06.2026 up to 05.30 PM
8 Last date/time for receipt of bid in the portal 12.06.2026 up to 5.30 PM
9 Date of opening of technical bid 16.06.2026 at 10.30 AM.
10 Name& Address of the Officer inviting Bid Chief Construction Engineer, Lower Suktel Irrigation Project, Balangir, At- Laltikra, Dist- Balangir, PIN-767002
(i) Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal http://tendersodisha.gov.in
(ii) Any corrigendum / addendum/ cancellation will be displayed in the Govt. Website only.
Chief Construction Engineer, Lower Suktel Project, Balangir.
32001/32448/1/26-27/0004

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.
1. Name of Work Annual P. Way Zone work for 2026-27 in the section of SSE/Pway/NDLS under ADEN/NDLS.
2. Approx. Cost of work Rs. 1,49,00,381.09/- (Rupees One Crore Forty Nine Lakh Three Hundred Eighty One and Nine Paise Only)
3. Earnest Money to be Deposit Rs 2,98,000.00/- (Rupees Two Lakh Ninty Eight Thousand Only)
4. Cost of tender document Rs. 0.00/-
5. Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender, 15.06.2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.
6. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen www.ireps.gov.in
The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. • For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. • No manual offers are acceptable. • Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only. No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/22/2026-27/W-3 Dated:-22.05.2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1728/26

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, MINOR IRRIGATION DIVISION, JAMSHEDPUR. 831001
e-Procurement Notice
Tender Reference No. WRD/MID/JAMSHEDPUR/F.04/2026-27
Letter No. : 257
Dated: 22.05.2026
Sl. No. Name of the work Estimated Cost (In Rs.) Initial Bid Security (In Rs.) Cost of Bidding Document
01 Construction of Mukhyamantri Solar Lift Irrigation Scheme at Vill Naldhua Under Block Dhalbhumgarh of East Singhbhum District. 10664391.83 214000.00 10000.00
02 Initial Bid Security in the shape of To be Deposited as per S.O.P. Uploaded.
03 Time of Completion 11 Months
04 Date of Publication of Tender on website 08.06.2026 from 2.00 P.M
05 Start Date of Bidding 08.06.2026
06 Last date & Time for Online Bidding 15.06.2026 up to 5.00 P.M
07 Last Date & Time for upload of Bid Security and other Documents in online form 15.06.2026 up to 5.00P.M Through e-Tender portal www.jharkhandtender.gov.in (As per SOP issued by Information Technology & e-Governance Department, Government of Jharkhand vide letter no. 120 Dated 03.10.2023)
08 Date & time for Opening of Technical Bid 17.06.2026 up to 4 .00 P.M in the Office Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation Division, Jamshedpur
09 Name & Address of Inviting Tender Executive Engineer, Minor irrigation Division , Jamshedpur
10 Contact no. of Procurement officer 9162471448
11 Helpline no. of e-Procurement cell 9162471448
Note :-
Work will be awarded to those bidders (specially MNRE approved channel partners/ MNRE approved manufacturers/ MNRE approved PV system integrators/ A registered manufacturers/ Company/ Firm/ Corporation in India (including MSME of Jharkhand) of at least one of the major sub system namely pumps or PV System electronics (confirming to National/ International Standards) any other agencies having experience of installation and commissioning of such solar powered irrigation schemes). Empanelled indigenous manufacturers of 10HP pumps (AC Surface water pumps) in the department with all accessories for off-grid stand alone SPV water pumping systems can also takes part in the bid for executing the whole work of the bid. However those bidders who have not yet registered in Water Resources Department can also submit their bid provided they will have to get themselves registered in Water Resources Department within two months from the date of allotment of work.
Only e-tender will be accepted.
Further details can be seen on websitehttp://jharkhandtender.gov.in
Executive Engineer, PR 380491 Minor Irrigation (26-27)*D Minor Irrigation Division, Jamshedpur.

VANI COMMERCIALS LIMITED
CIN : L74899DL1988PLC106425
Regd. Off.: 201, 2nd Floor, BMC House, N Block, Near Maruti Suzuki Arena, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001. PH: +91- 9560066230 | Website : www.vanicommercials.com | Email ID: info@vanicommercials.com
EXTRACT OF AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED 31ST MARCH, 2026
(Rs. In Lakhs)
Particulars 3 Months ended 31.03.2026 (Audited) Preceding 3 Months ended 31.12.2025 (Unaudited) Corresponding 3 Months ended (Previous Year) 31.03.2025 (Audited) Year to date (Current Year) 31.03.2026 (Audited) Previous Year Ended 31.03.2025 (Audited)
Total income from operations (net) 155.00 102.00 1.00 571.00 339.00
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items) 9.00 23.00 34.00 65.00 48.00
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items) 9.00 23.00 34.00 65.00 48.00
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items) 9.00 23.00 12.00 36.00 26.00
Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss)] for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive Income (after tax) 9.00 23.00 12.00 36.00 26.00
Equity Share Capital (Paid-Up) 2,940.00 1,174.00 1,174.00 2,940.00 1,174.00
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year 0.00 0.00 0.00 0.00 0.00
Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations)
1. Basic: 0.03 0.19 0.01 0.12 0.02
2. Diluted: 0.03 0.19 0.01 0.12 0.02
*Paid up Equity Share Capital & Earning Per Share provided above relates only to Vani Commercials Limited.
NOTES:
1 The above financial results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at the meeting held on 21st May, 2026.
2 The Audited Financial Results of the Company for the Quarter and financial year ended on 31st March, 2026 are also available on website of the Company (www.vanicommercials.com) and BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com).
3 Previous year's/period's figures have been regrouped / rearranged, wherever required.
4 This Statement is as per Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.
5 The Company operates in a service segment in India.
6 The Statutory Auditors of the Company have carried out Audit of the Standalone Financial Results for the Quarter and Financial Year ended 31st March, 2026 in terms of Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 and have expressed their unqualified opinion.
For Vani Commercials Limited
Sd/- Vishal Abrol Managing Director DIN : 06938389
Place : New Delhi Date : 21st May, 2026

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (CIVIL PROJECT-I), CSPGCL, Shed No. 02, Dangania, Raipur-492013 Phone No. 0771-2574567, website www.cspc.co. in E-mail:- cspgcl.coal@gmail.com
PROJ/1247/2026-ED (CIVIL- PROJ) OFC SECTION 1/431834/2026
E-TENDER NOTICE
Online bids are invited through CSPCL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from eligible bidders fulfilling the eligibility criteria as mentioned in detailed NIT and having experience of similar nature of work in Govt./Public Sector Undertaking/Power Generating Companies in India only may also be considered on submission of experience certificate for following work as mentioned below :-
Sl. No. Tender Specification No. Description NIT value i/c GST (Rs.) EMD (Rs.) Completion period (incl. Rainy season) Rfx No.
1 CE/CP-I/ 2x660MW/W/ 2026-27/T-139 Deployment of manpower on outsourcing basis viz. carpenter, fitter, bar bender & helper to expedite the various construction activity of proposed 2x660MW Super Critical Thermal Power Project, CSPGCL, Korba West (C.G.) 3,84,04,340/- 3,84,050/- 06 Months 8100051451
Cost of tender form is Rs. 1180/- (Rs.1000/- + 18% GST). Due date & time for submission of bids, Tender Cost & EMD is 12.06.2026 (up to 16:00 Hrs) and bid opening date (Techno commercial bids) is 15.06.2026 (at 16:30) Hrs respectively. The tender document can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in:50724/irj/portal. The detailed NIT can also be downloaded from our website using link https://cspc.co.in/ cspgcl tender notices → Central office. Amendment/ Corrigendum /Extension, if any, will only be uploaded on company's website and shall not be published in newspaper.
Note: - I. In case, the rate quoted by the contractor is on extremely lower side than estimated contract value, a performance guarantee @ 5% of contract value i/c GST in addition to Security Deposit shall have to be deposited by the contractor.
Chief Engineer (Civil-Project-I) SAVE ELECTRICITY samvad 47911/1 CSPGCL, Raipur

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE
ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005
The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.
Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.
Sr. No. Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand (Rs) Name of Branch
1. Anil Kumar/ Nishi/ LBGH200005126650/ LBGH200007073752 Flat No. Mol 19/05, 1st Floor, Situated in Indrapuram Shipra Suncity-II, Ghaziabad Development Authority, Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh- 201001/ May 19, 2026 January 28, 2026 Rs. 13,02,97,148/- Delhi & Ncr
2. Surendra Kumar Bhatia/ Shashi Bhatia/ TBFTN00006420389 Flat No. 305, 3rd Floor, Tower No. O-6, Oxirich Square One, Scottish Garden, Ahinsa Khand-II, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh/ May 19, 2026 July 16, 2025 Rs. 28,76,211/- Delhi & Ncr
3. Mohammad Shahbaaz Alam / Nikhat Khatoun / LBDEL00005719514 Flat No. F-3, Mig First Floor, Without Roof Rights, Built On Plot No. II/ 79, Shakti Khand, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad- 201010, Owned By Mohammad Shahbaaz Alam & Nikhat Khatoun/ May 19, 2026 February 25, 2026 Rs. 16,28,773/- Delhi & Ncr
The above-mentioned borrowers (s)/guarantors (s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.
Date: May 23, 2026 Place: Delhi & Ncr Sincerely Authorised Officer, For ICICI Bank Ltd.

Markets rebound on buying in bank stocks, Sensex rises 232 pts

Rupee appreciates for 2nd day in row by 76 paise to 95.60 against dollar

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Stock markets recovered on Friday with the benchmark Sensex closing higher by nearly 232 points following buying in blue-chip bank shares amid positive global trends.

The 30-share BSE Sensex climbed 231.99 points, or 0.31 per cent, to settle at 75,415.35. During the day, it surged 627.61 points, or 0.83 per cent, to 75,810.97.

The 50-share NSE Nifty edged higher by 64.60 points or 0.27 per cent to end at 23,719.30.

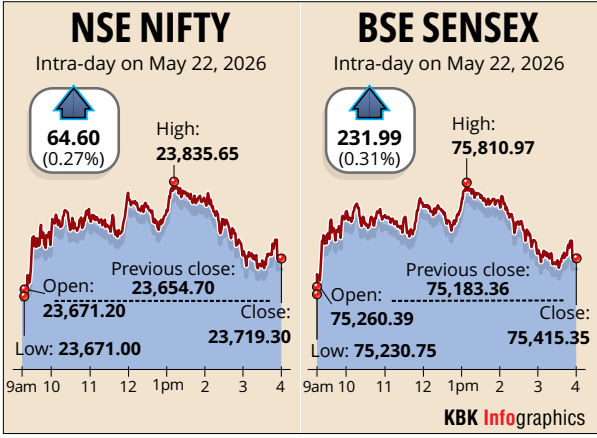
Hopes of progress in the US-Iran peace negotiations added to markets' optimism, analysts said.

Among 30 Sensex firms, Trent, Axis Bank, ICICI Bank, Asian Paints, Hindustan Unilever, HDFC Bank, Kotak Mahindra Bank and Bajaj Finance were the major winners.

Sun Pharma, ITC, Power Grid and Bharat Electronics were among the laggards.

The BSE MidCap Select index went up by 0.30 per cent, while SmallCap Select index declined 0.60 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, Private Banks Index rallied 1.35 per cent, Top 10 Banks jumped 1.23 per cent, Bankex by 1.18



Among 30 Sensex cos, Trent, Axis Bank, ICICI Bank, Asian Paints, Hindustan Unilever, HDFC Bank, Kotak Mahindra Bank and Bajaj Finance were the major winners. Sun Pharma, ITC, Power Grid & Bharat Electronics were among laggards

per cent, Telecommunication by 0.93 per cent and Financial Services by 0.90 per cent.

Hospitals dropped the most by 1.39 per cent, followed by Healthcare (1.23 per cent), IT (0.32 per cent), Focused IT (0.29 per cent), Power (0.18 per cent) and Energy (0.09 per cent).

A total of 2,213 stocks advanced, while 1,971 declined and 179 remained unchanged

on the BSE.

On the weekly front, the BSE benchmark climbed 177.36 points, or 0.23 per cent. The Nifty went up by 75.8 points, or 0.32 per cent.

The rupee rose for the second consecutive session on Friday to close at 95.60, up by 76 paise against the US dollar on softening of crude oil prices and supposed intervention by the RBI.

Highlights

» Among sectoral indices, Pvt Banks Index rallied 1.35%, Top 10 Banks jumped 1.23%, Bankex by 1.18%, Telecom by 0.93% and Financial Services by 0.90%

» A total of 2,213 stocks advanced, 1,971 declined & 179 remained unchanged on BSE

» BSE MidCap Select index went up by 0.30%, while SmallCap Select index fell 0.60%

» FII's offloaded equities worth Rs 1,891.21 crore in the previous session, according to exchange data

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, climbed 2.3 per cent to \$104.7 per barrel.

FII's offloaded equities worth Rs 1,891.21 crore in the previous session, according to exchange data.

On Thursday, the 30-share BSE benchmark declined 135.03 points, or 0.18 per cent, to settle at 75,183.36. The Nifty skidded 4.30 points, or 0.02 per cent, to end at 23,654.70.

Forex stocks fall \$8 bn to \$688.894 bn

MUMBAI: India's forex reserves dropped \$8.094 billion to \$688.894 billion during the week ended May 15, the Reserve Bank of India said on Friday.

The overall reserves had jumped by \$6.295 billion to \$696.988 billion during the week ended May 8.

For the week ended May 15, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, decreased by \$6.483 billion to \$545.904 billion, the central bank's data showed.

Value of gold reserves also declined \$1.536 billion to \$119.317 billion during the week, the RBI said.

The special drawing rights (SDRs) were down by \$49 million to \$18.824 billion, the apex bank said.

India's reserve position with the IMF was also down by \$25 million to \$4.85 billion at the end of the reporting week, according to the apex bank's data.

RBI flags supply-side risks to India's near-term outlook

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: India's near-term outlook is somewhat clouded by supply-side pressures, and the spillover impact of the West Asia conflict on domestic inflation needs to be monitored, according to the RBI Bulletin.

While the global economy remained shadowed by uncertainties in West Asia, an article in the Bulletin said domestic economic activity exhibited resilience in April.

"The conflict in West Asia continued to exert pressure on commodity markets, global trade flows and supply chains, contributing to the volatility in financial markets. India has entered this phase from a position of macroeconomic strength," the article on the state of the economy said.

"Domestic demand continues to be the key driver of growth. However, the near-term outlook is somewhat clouded by supply-side pressures.

"Although headline inflation remains firmly within the tolerance band, the pass-through to domestic prices needs to be monitored," it said.

Retail inflation rose to 3.5 per cent in April, driven mainly by food inflation, while core inflation remained steady.

Against the backdrop of the Iran war, the article said constricted shipping routes and trade flows increased supply chain pressures to their highest levels since 2022.

Prices of commodities for which the Strait of Hor-



India is witnessing a trade reconfiguration amidst the emerging geopolitical situation

muz is a critical transit route remained elevated in April and early May.

The base metal prices, including aluminium, zinc and nickel, rose due to supply disruptions and higher fuel costs.

"The financial conditions, crude oil prices and capital flows continue to pose challenges to the external sector outlook," it said.

The merchandise trade deficit widened in April 2026 over March 2026 primarily on account of crude oil and gold imports.

Nevertheless, robust services exports, positive net FDI flows, foreign exchange reserve buffers and a number of proactive policy measures undertaken by the government and the Reserve Bank are likely to cushion the Indian economy against external headwinds,

it said.

India is witnessing a trade reconfiguration amidst the emerging geopolitical situation. Its trade through the Strait of Hormuz, which had declined sequentially in March, went up in April 2026.

The article further said that economic activity showed a mixed trend in April, as evidenced by several high-frequency indicators such as fuel consumption, trade, and logistics.

E-way bills continued to achieve double-digit growth backed by GST rate rationalisation.

While petrol and diesel consumption continued to grow, overall petroleum consumption declined in April due to a sharp fall in the consumption of naphtha, liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) and other petroleum products, it said and added higher temperatures led to a sharp increase in electricity demand.

The central bank said the views expressed in the Bulletin article are those of the authors and do not represent the views of the Reserve Bank of India.

Gold drops to ₹1.64 lakh/10g as Iran talks temper mkt anxiety



NEW DELHI: Gold prices retreated by Rs 600 to Rs 1.64 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Friday as tentative progress in US-Iran negotiations reduced precious metals buying, though unresolved tensions around the Strait of Hormuz kept traders cautious.

Snapping a three-day winning streak, the yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity depreciated by Rs 600 to Rs 1,64,900 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes), according to local marketmen.

Gold prices witnessed a slight decline on Friday. The recent fluctuations in the bullion market are largely influenced by ongoing geopolitical tensions, particularly concerning US-Iran relations, alongside the volatility of the Indian rupee and movements in crude oil prices, Gaurav Garg, Research Analyst at Lemonn Markets Desk, said.

However, silver prices remained flat at Rs 2,71,000 per kilogram in the bullion market.

In the global markets, spot gold fell marginally lower to \$4,522.32 per ounce, while silver slipped 1 per cent to \$75.87 per ounce.

India's gold demand likely to decline by 50-60 tonnes in 2026 due to increase in import duty

MUMBAI: India's gold demand is expected to contract by 50-60 tonnes this calendar year, around 10 per cent lower than the previous year, following the import duty hike, according to the World Gold Council (WGC).

"Looking at 2026 as a whole, we estimate that combined jewellery and bar and coin demand could decline by around 50-60 tonnes, around 10 per cent lower than the previous year, due to the impact of the import duty hike," WGC said in its India gold market update.

The gold import duty was raised sharply from 6 per cent to 15 per cent, making it the single-largest increase on record and fully reversing the duty cut of July 2024. The Prime Minister has also appealed to consumers to avoid buying gold for a year.

Other factors, such as the gold price, changes to income levels, inflation, or effects from the monsoon, would further influence annual demand, it added. "Our econometric models suggest that changes in import duties tend to impact gold demand in both the short and long term, although the impact differs across jewellery and investment products such as bars and coins. Investment demand appears more sensitive to duty changes, while jewellery demand has shown greater resilience," said WGC.

WGC said jewellery consumption is influenced more by prices and inflation, and import duties have less of an impact.

This is likely because jewellery purchases are often required, particularly for weddings and social occasions, said

WGC. Investment demand, on the other hand, is linked to income levels and import duties, with higher duties and restrictions tending to weigh on demand, it said, adding that in the short term, factors such as inflation and rainfall also influence investment demand alongside taxes.

Further, WGC said import data points to a consistent relationship between higher import duties and the inflow of unofficial gold. Between 2013 and 2026, increases in import duty were mostly followed by higher levels of unofficial or smuggled gold, while duty reductions coincided with sharp declines in such inflows.

Following the 4 per cent duty hike in 2013, unofficial imports increased sharply from around 10 tonnes in the first

quarter of that year to 70 tonnes by the same period of 2014, a seven-fold increase in under a year. Even when duties were steady at 10 per cent through the second half of 2013 until the second quarter of 2019, unofficial inflows remained elevated, averaging 34 tonnes per quarter, suggesting that once smuggling networks are established, they are difficult to unravel.

A similar pattern was observed after duty was hiked from 10.75 per cent to 15 per cent in July 2022.

Unofficial imports rose from 17 tonnes in the second quarter of 2022 to nearly 50 tonnes by late that year and stayed elevated through much of 2023. However, after the duty was cut to 6 per cent in July 2024, unofficial imports fell almost immediately to near zero, added WGC.

GreenLine flags off LNG trucks for Tata Steel at Meramandali, Odisha

MUMBAI: GreenLine Mobility Solutions Ltd, an Essar venture, has expanded its partnership with Tata Steel by flagging off LNG-powered trucks at Tata Steel's Meramandali facility in Odisha to support greener long-haul logistics.

The deployment is aimed at reducing carbon emissions and promoting cleaner fuel adoption in freight transport.

GreenLine currently operates more than 1,000 LNG- and EV-powered trucks across sectors including steel, cement, mining, FMCG and chemicals.

Its fleet has covered over 90 million km, helping cut more than 24,000 tonnes of CO2 emissions.



The company plans to deploy over 10,000 LNG and EV trucks supported by 100 LNG refuelling stations, EV charging hubs and battery-swapping facilities.

GreenLine CEO Madhur

Taneja said LNG is emerging as a scalable alternative for long-haul logistics, while Tata Steel's Prabhat Kumar highlighted the importance of partnerships in achieving greener logistics operations.

Delhi HC grants interim protection to IndiGo from coercive action over ₹458 cr GST demand

The dispute relates to compensation paid by the foreign supplier after engine malfunctions during 2018-19 and 2019-20 forced IndiGo to ground aircraft

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Friday granted interim protection to InterGlobe Aviation, owner of IndiGo Airlines, against coercive action over a GST demand of about Rs 458 crore linked to compensation received from a foreign aircraft engine supplier.

A Division Bench of Justices Nitin Wasudeo Sambre and Ajay Digaipal observed that, prima facie, the amount received by IndiGo appeared to be "compensation" and not "supply" under GST law.

The Court was hearing the



airline's plea challenging the tax demand and an equivalent penalty. The dispute relates to compensation paid by the foreign supplier after engine malfunctions during 2018-19 and 2019-20 forced IndiGo to ground aircraft. Under a supplementary

agreement, the supplier issued credit notes worth around Rs 2,000 crore to offset loss of flying hours and business.

The tax department argued that IndiGo had effectively agreed to "tolerate" the supplier's failure to meet performance benchmarks, making the payment taxable under the reverse charge mechanism.

Senior advocate V Lakshmi-kumaran, appearing for IndiGo, argued that the amount was compensation for losses and not consideration for any service.

Relying on a 2022 CBIC cir-

cular, the airline said payments for breach or non-performance cannot automatically be treated as taxable supply.

IndiGo further argued that even if considered a service, the transaction would qualify as export of service since payment was received in foreign exchange from an overseas entity.

After hearing the matter, the Court directed that no coercive action be taken against the airline. The case will be heard further after the court vacation.

GOVT EXERCISES GREEN SHOE OPTION

Institutional buyers over-subscribe Central Bank of India's Offer For Sale

NEW DELHI: Institutional investors on Friday put in over Rs 2,380 crore worth of bids in the Offer For Sale (OFS) of Central Bank of India shares, which got over-subscribed more than two times.

The government has decided to exercise the green shoe option and put the entire 8 per cent stake in Central Bank of India on the block, Department of Investment and Public Asset Management Secretary Arunish Chawla said in a post on X.

"Offer for Sale in Central Bank of India received enthu-

siastic response from investors and was over-subscribed 2.35 times on the first day," Chawla said.

Retail investors and employees will be able to bid in the share sale offer on Monday. The government had said it will sell a 4 per cent stake in Central Bank of India, with a green shoe option of an additional 4 per cent at a floor price of Rs 31 per share. If the 8 per cent stake on offer is fully subscribed, the stake sale would fetch Rs 2,456 crore to the government.

Till the close of trading hours on Friday, institutional

investors put in bids for over 76.86 crore shares, as against 32.58 crore shares on offer.

At the indicative price of Rs 31.01 a share, non-retail investors put in over Rs 2,380 crore worth of bids for Central Bank OFS on Friday. This is the first OFS by the government in the current fiscal.

The floor price of Rs 31 a share is 8.58 per cent lower than the stock's Thursday closing price of Rs 33.91 on the BSE.

The OFS will help the government inch towards meeting the SEBI's minimum public shareholding norm.

IOC faces rising pressure as high crude prices squeeze margins: S&P

‘Disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz and elevated crude prices could widen the gap between domestic retail fuel prices & raw material costs’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: S&P Global Ratings on Friday said state-owned Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) faces rising pressure to balance fuel affordability with profitability as prolonged tensions in West Asia increase crude oil prices and squeeze marketing margins.

The ratings agency said disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz and elevated crude prices could widen the gap between domestic retail fuel prices and raw material costs, potentially hurting the company's earnings, cash flow and liquidity position over the next 12 months.

India, the world's third-largest oil importer, relies heavily on imported crude to meet domestic fuel demand, with diesel accounting for nearly 39 per cent of total petroleum consumption.

“IOC faces a conundrum. Its earnings and cash flow over the next 12 months are turning increasingly uncertain as the Middle East conflict becomes protracted. IOC has to balance its role of meeting the country's energy needs while absorbing losses due to high crude oil prices,” it said. “Given the widening gap between the pump prices and crude oil input price,



India, the world's third-largest oil importer, relies heavily on imported crude to meet domestic fuel demand, with diesel accounting for nearly 39 per cent of total petroleum consumption

we cannot rule out the possibility of a material base-case revision.”

Shipping disruption in the Strait of Hormuz, resulting in elevated crude oil prices, potential feedstock shortages should the conflict prolong, and limited changes to the domestic pump prices are factors driving that possibility.

“We believe a prolonged Middle East conflict and high crude oil prices could erode

the company's financial cushion and liquidity position,” the rating agency said. “However, IOC's strong banking relationships and access to funding markets could mitigate short-term liquidity stress.”

IOC has available committed and uncommitted working capital lines with banks and a track record of raising funds through commercial paper issuances.

“In our view, IOC's minor-

Highlights

» 'IOC faces a conundrum. Its earnings and cash flow over next 12 months are turning increasingly uncertain as the Middle East conflict becomes protracted'

» 'IOC has to balance its role of meeting country's energy needs while absorbing losses due to high crude oil prices'

» 'Given widening gap between pump prices & crude oil input price, we cannot rule out the possibility of a material base-case revision'

ity stakes in Oil and Natural Gas Corp (ONGC), Oil India Ltd, and Gail (India) Ltd, with a combined market value of more than \$3 billion, aid financial flexibility, if required,” S&P said.

In addition, there is an extremely high likelihood of extraordinary support from the government should the IOC come under financial stress. Recent government support came in the form of excise duty cuts and a 3-4 per cent increase

in petrol and diesel prices.

The standalone credit profile and issuer credit rating on IOC are on par with the sovereign credit rating on India (BBB/Stable/A-2).

IOC reported stronger-than-expected earnings for the fiscal year ended March 2026, helped by healthy fuel demand growth, improved refining margins and working capital gains, S&P added.

The results “were better than our expectations with free operating cash flows of Rs 40,000 crore and S&P Global Ratings adjusted debt of close to Rs 1.3 lakh crore,” it said.

Healthy volume growth, higher refining margins, and working capital gains have translated into an EBITDA of more than Rs 76,000 crore for the year.

S&P Global Ratings believes there is a high degree of unpredictability around the duration and scale of the Middle East war and its potential effect on commodity prices, supply chains, economies, and credit conditions. “As a result, our baseline forecasts carry a significant amount of uncertainty. As situations evolve, we will gauge the macro and credit materiality of potential shifts and reassess our guidance accordingly.”

Capital Group raises stake in Adani Group cuts RIL exposure

NEW DELHI: The Capital Group, one of the world's largest investment management firms, has been increasing its exposure to Adani Group companies while steadily paring holdings in Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL), marking a shift in foreign investor preference between India's biggest conglomerates.

The Los Angeles-based money manager has acquired stakes worth more than \$2 billion across three Adani Group companies in recent weeks, according to people familiar with the matter.

On May 5, Capital Group bought nearly a 2 per cent stake in Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd. for 74.86 billion rupees (\$776 million) through open-market transactions, according to BSE block-deal data, Bloomberg reported.

The investor, which oversees more than \$3.3 trillion in assets globally, has also accumulated between 1.5 per cent and 2 per cent stakes in Adani Power Ltd. and Adani Green Energy Ltd through market purchases, the people said, asking not to be identified because the information is private.

In a market that's fallen out of favor with some investors because of its lack of companies tied to the global artificial intelligence buildup, Adani companies are increasingly viewed as rare leveraged plays on India's infrastructure development, energy transition and manufacturing push.

That shift is also emblematic of a broader transition toward



'On May 5, Capital Group bought nearly a 2% stake in Adani Ports & SEZ for \$776 million through open-market transactions'

bets on the next phase of India's economic expansion.

Adani Power, Adani Green and Adani Ports shares surged 94 per cent, 35 per cent and 25 per cent, respectively, in one year. A Capital Group spokeswoman said she's unable to comment on individual stocks or shareholdings. A representative for Adani Group didn't respond to a request for comment.

The pivot toward Adani stocks in particular signals a recovery in investor confidence after months of regulatory scrutiny and market volatility. The group was able to remove a major overhang when the US Justice Department recently sought to drop criminal charges against Gautam Adani, bringing the billionaire founder closer to resolving a legal risk that had once threatened the future of

Key Points

» The investor also accumulated between 1.5% and 2% stakes in Adani Power Ltd and Adani Green Energy Ltd

» On the other side, Capital Group's exposure to Reliance has declined sharply over the past several years

» 'It held about 142 mn shares in Reliance at end of March, against about 500 mn six years earlier & peak of 755 mn in March 2017'

his sprawling ports-to-power empire.

On the other side of the ledger, Capital Group's exposure to Reliance has declined sharply over the past several years.

The firm held about 142 million shares in Reliance Industries at the end of March, compared with about 500 million six years earlier and a peak of 755 million in March 2017, according to data compiled by Bloomberg.

While Reliance remains one of the country's most widely held and closely tracked companies among global funds, its earnings growth and stock performance have moderated after years of rapid expansion across telecom, retail and energy.

Reliance Industries shares have declined 8.36 per cent over one year. AGENCIES

Reliance Power posts ₹494 cr loss in Jan-March quarter

NEW DELHI: Reliance Power has reported a consolidated net loss of Rs 494 crore for the quarter ended March 31.

The company had posted a consolidated net profit of Rs 125.57 crore in the corresponding quarter of the previous financial year, according to a regulatory filing.

Total income declined to Rs 1,946.33 crore during the quarter under review from Rs 2,065.64 crore in the year-ago period.

The company has reported a loss of Rs 336.89 crore for the fiscal year 2025-26, compared with a net profit of Rs 2,947.83 crore in 2024-25.

Total income dipped to Rs 7,988.52 crore in FY26 from Rs 8,257.04 crore in the previous fiscal.

The board approved a proposal for raising funds up to Rs 6,000 crore through the issuance of equity shares, equity-linked instruments and/or other eligible securities to qualified institutional buyers via a Qualified Institutions Placement and /or a follow-on-public offer or a combination of both.

The board also approved a proposal for issuance of secured / unsecured, redeemable, non-convertible debentures up to Rs 3,000 crore, in one or more tranches / series, on a private placement basis or otherwise. PTI

Goyal meets industry representatives, officials to discuss ways to boost mfg

NEW DELHI: An inter-ministerial meeting was held with industry associations to discuss ways to boost the country's manufacturing, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Friday.

He said that the government is committed to working closely with the industry to expand manufacturing capacities, enhance quality standards and strengthen competitiveness.

A comprehensive meeting with officials from key ministries and leading industry associations was held to strategise on boosting domestic manufacturing, he said in a social media post.

The meeting comes at a time when the government is working with the industry to identify about 100 products -- including those from the auto, chemicals, plastics and petrochemicals sectors — that are either not produced or manufactured inadequately in India, as part of efforts to boost domestic production.

The exercise is aimed at reducing the import bill of the country, as outflows of foreign exchange are impacting the value of the domestic currency against the US dollar.

The Indian rupee, on Friday, closed at 95.73 against the greenback.

The country's imports stood at \$775 billion in 2025-26 as against \$721.2 billion in 2023-24. India mainly imports crude oil, gold, silver, machinery, fertiliser, vegetable oil, chemicals, plastic materials, metals, transport equipment, and electronic goods.

The West Asia crisis has led to an increase in input costs for certain sectors like plastics. India's industrial production growth decelerated to a five-month low of 4.1 per cent in March on account of subdued manufacturing growth and almost flat expansion in the power sector amid the West Asia crisis.

Meanwhile, Goyal also co-chaired a meeting with minister of Ports, Shipping and Waterway Sarbananand Sonowal, on issues related to exporters, importers and port authorities.

“We are committed to ensuring coordinated, time-bound measures to address concerns and create opportunities to make Indian traders more competitive globally,” he said in a separate post.

Exporters and importers are facing issues in the West Asia region as the US-Iran war is impacting the movement of ships across the Strait of Hormuz. PTI

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Dalmia Bharat to acquire JAL's cement assets in ₹2,850 crore deal after Adani takeover

NEW DELHI: Dalmia Bharat on Friday said it will acquire the cement assets of debt-ridden Jaiprakash Associates, which has been acquired by billionaire Gautam Adani-led Adani Enterprises through insolvency proceedings.

Dalmia Cement (Bharat) Ltd (DCBL), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Dalmia Bharat, has already executed a Business Transfer Agreement (BTA) with Jaiprakash Associates Ltd for the transaction, which is expected to complete within two weeks, a statement said.

Following the takeover, Dalmia Bharat's cement capacity will increase to 54.7 million tonne per annum (MTPA).

Following the takeover, Dalmia Bharat's cement capacity will rise to 54.7 MTPA

The BTA has been signed for acquisition of cement plants at Rewa (Madhya Pradesh), Churk, Chunar and Sadwa (Uttar Pradesh), with 5.2 MTPA cement capacity and 3.3 MTPA clinker capacity, at an enterprise value of Rs 2,850 crore, Dalmia Bharat said. Besides, the acquired assets also entail 99 MW of thermal power capacity with railway siding. Terming

the deal “Strategic Fit”, Dalmia Bharat said it will also help in market diversification, reducing regional volatility. Over funding, Dalmia Bharat said it will be a mix of debt & internal accrual.

“In addition to this, the ongoing expansion projects at Belgaum, Pune and Kadapa will further augment the company's cement capacity to 66.7 MTPA by Q2-Q3 FY28,” it said.

MD & CEO of Dalmia Bharat Puneet Dalmia said: “Our familiarity with these assets under the earlier tolling arrangement gives us a deep understanding of the facilities and helps us establish strong connect with channel partners and vendors. We believe that

this will help us in faster ramp up of capacities and quicker inroads into the market.”

DCBL had entered into framework agreement in December 2022 with JAL (before initiation of insolvency) for sale of business assets along with other relevant agreements in pursuant thereof including a BTA and cement sale purchase agreement. These agreements were entered into with a view to settling all disputes with JAL including under the 'long-term clinker supply agreement'.

However, while the consummation of the same was pending, JAL was admitted to insolvency and the sale could not be completed. PTI



ers (registered or unregistered) are eligible to participate in this open offer at any time prior to the closure of the tendering period, it said.

Earlier this month, the finance ministry granted approval to Dubai-based Emirates NBD Bank (P.J.S.C) for the acquisition of up to 74 per cent stake in RBL Bank.

Emirates NBD Bank received a letter from the

Department of Financial Services dated May 14, 2026, approving its proposed acquisition in RBL Bank.

The proposed investment, by way of primary infusion of approximately \$3 billion (about 26,850 crore) represents one of the largest international investments in the Indian banking sector, and is expected to position RBL Bank strongly for its next phase of growth.

The progression of the transaction reflects sustained engagement across stakeholders in India and the UAE, and underscores the continued strengthening of economic and financial linkages between the two countries.

Last month, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) accorded approval to Emirates NBD Bank to acquire up to 74 per

cent stake in RBL Bank.

The approval was granted following Emirates NBD Bank, the second largest in the UAE, expressing its interest in October 2025 to acquire a majority 60 per cent stake in RBL Bank for Rs 26,853 crore.

As per the approval letter, Emirates NBD (ENBD) would acquire and maintain a shareholding of at least 51 per cent of the paid-up share capital of RBL Bank and the bank would be classified as a foreign bank in subsidiary mode, with the investor as its parent foreign bank.

Earlier in January, fair trade regulator CCI had approved Emirates NBD Bank's proposal to acquire a majority stake in private sector lender RBL Bank. PTI

Vedanta subsidiary Talwandi Sabo Power Ltd faces ₹127 crore penalty

NEW DELHI: Vedanta Limited has said that its subsidiary Talwandi Sabo Power Limited (TSPL) has been held liable to pay approximately Rs 127 crore, plus applicable late payment surcharge, to Punjab State Power Corporation Ltd (PSPCL) following a Supreme Court judgment.

In a regulatory filing on Thursday, Vedanta said the Supreme Court has set aside the judgment passed by the Appellate Tribunal for Electricity (APTEL), and has restored the order passed by the Punjab State Electricity Regulatory Commission (PSERC).

By the said order, the apex court has upheld the alleged



penalty on TSPL for misdeclaration of availability for January 2017 in terms of the Grid Code, along with the applicable Late Payment Surcharge, the filing said.

Talwandi Sabo Power Ltd is a 1,980 MW super-critical coal-based thermal power plant located at Banawala in Mansa district, Punjab.

The filing further said that TSPL will pay an amount of

approximately Rs 127 crore and applicable Late Payment Surcharge to PSPCL.

TSPL supplies 100 per cent of its generated power to Punjab State Power Corporation, playing a critical role in supporting 35 per cent of Punjab's energy requirements through dependable, large-scale electricity generation.

Talwandi Sabo Power Ltd was established by the Punjab State Electricity Board as a special-purpose vehicle to develop a large-scale thermal power project in the state. The project was awarded to Vedanta Ltd (erstwhile Sterlite Energy Ltd) under a Build-Own-Operate model. PTI

RIL becomes first Indian firm to surpass \$120 bn revenue mark

NEW DELHI: Reliance Industries Limited (RIL) has become the first Indian company to surpass the \$120 billion revenue mark in FY26, reporting revenue of \$124 billion.

In a post on X, the Mukesh Ambani-led conglomerate said it had grown from a textile company founded in 1966 into a global business group with operations spanning energy, telecom and retail.

The milestone comes nearly a month after the company became the first Indian firm to cross \$10 billion in annual net profit. Reliance reported a net profit of Rs 95,610 crore before



accounting for non-controlling interests, translating into \$10.1 billion at the year-end exchange rate of 94.4 against the dollar.

The company posted EBITDA of \$21.9 billion and profit after tax of \$10.1 billion in FY26. Reliance said its net profit exceeded the combined

earnings of IT majors Tata Consultancy Services, Infosys and HCLTech.

Reliance's digital business recorded 18 per cent year-on-year growth, driven by subscriber additions, better 5G and fixed broadband mix, and higher customer engagement. Its retail business grew 8 per cent year-on-year aided by expansion in hyperlocal commerce and softer food and grocery demand. The oil-to-chemicals business posted 10 per cent EBITDA growth despite sanctions and disruptions towards the end of the financial year. AGENCIES

NEW DELHI: Venezuela has emerged as India's third-largest crude oil supplier in May, overtaking Saudi Arabia and the US, as Indian refiners increased purchases of cheaper Venezuelan crude amid disruptions in global oil markets.

According to Kpler data, Venezuela supplied around 417,000 barrels per day (bpd) of crude oil to India this month so far, up sharply from 283,000 bpd in April after no supplies during the previous nine months. Only Russia and the United Arab Emirates (UAE) supplied more crude to India in May.

The surge comes as India



reshuffles its crude sourcing strategy due to the West Asia conflict, disruptions around the Strait of Hormuz and changing supply dynamics.

Venezuelan crude is currently cheaper than many global oil grades, making it attractive

CLOSER LOOK

- » According to Kpler data, Venezuela supplied around 417,000 bpd of crude oil to India this month so far
- » The surge comes as India reshuffles its crude sourcing strategy due to disruptions around the Strait of Hormuz
- » Reliance Industries Limited remains among the largest buyers of Venezuelan crude

for refiners facing elevated oil prices and geopolitical uncertainty.

Analysts said Indian buyers prefer Venezuelan heavy crude because it is compatible with complex refining systems such as Reliance Industries' Jamnagar

refinery in Gujarat. Reliance remains among the largest buyers of Venezuelan crude.

India's overall crude imports rose 8 per cent month-on-month to around 4.9 million bpd in May, though still below the 5.2 million bpd recorded in

February before the Iran conflict disrupted shipments from West Asia. Iraqi supplies remain sharply lower, while Iranian cargoes have stopped again amid renewed tensions.

Saudi Arabia's exports to India nearly halved to around 340,000 bpd in May from 670,000 bpd in April, with analysts attributing the decline to aggressive pricing of Saudi crude.

The shift highlights how geopolitical tensions and volatile oil markets are forcing Indian refiners to diversify supply sources to manage costs and secure energy supplies. AGENCIES

Sun sets on SRH’s top-2 hopes

Hyderabad outclass RCB but fail to clinch top-two spot

HYDERABAD: Sunrisers Hyderabad maintained their now familiar hell-for-leather template, but even a thumping 55-run victory couldn't prevent Royal Challengers Bengaluru from topping the points table at the end of their IPL league stage engagement here on Friday.

Abhishek Sharma's bat-swing, Ishan Kishan's daredevilry and Heinrich Klaasen's brute muscularity took SRH to a meaty total of 255 for 4.

For RCB, the primary target was to score 166 to finish in top two and ensure two shots at qualifying for the IPL final and they did that with ease despite losing the contest by a big margin. They finished on 200 for 4.

RCB (NRR +0.783), thus, topped the group league phase with Gujarat Titans (NRR +0.695) and SRH (NRR +0.524) finishing second and third respectively despite all three teams getting 18 points apiece. The chase was always out of question even as Venkatesh Iyer (44 off 19 balls) provided a solid start. Virat Kohli (15 off 11 balls) and Devdutt Padikkal (21 off 14 balls) didn't get too many.

Once RCB understood that they can't win the match, veterans Rajat Patidar (56 off 39 balls) and Krunal Pandya (41



SRH's Ishan Kishan made 79 off 46 balls

PFI

not out off 31 balls) concentrated on the 'Magic Figure' of 166 with a 84-run stand.

Once Patidar played Pat Cummins over deep point for a six, RCB ensured a top-two finish. He was out at the team score of 178, which was required to finish on top of the table. Among SRH bowlers, Eshan Malinga (2/33 in 4 overs) was once again brilliant with his lengths, while Bihar youngster Sakib Hussain (1/31) also didn't let the batters get away during middle overs.

Earlier, when SRH bat-

ted, Abhishek (56 off 22 balls) scored another 20-ball half-century and nullified Bhuvneshwar Kumar in his first spell. Vice-captain Kishan found the gaps while displaying both precision and cheekiness to pummel his way to 79 off just 44 balls. Klaasen (51 off 24 balls), probably the most consistent batter across teams below No. 3, literally toyed with a world-class operator like Josh Hazlewood, taking as many as 27 runs off his third over and the team's 13th, as the Orange Army ensured that they would

cross the 250-run mark on a batting featherbed.

The mayhem was started by Abhishek when he elegantly lofted a Bhuvneshwar delivery over wide of long-off to get his first six. Bhuvneshwar, who found a second wind in this IPL, wasn't allowed to settle down as he flicked him twice -- once over square-leg and then over deep mid-wicket off back-to-back deliveries. Romario Shepherd's friendly, occasional medium pace wasn't suppose to trouble the world's No. 1 ranked T20 batter. AGENCIES

Padikkal still on a learning curve

BENGALURU: Royal Challengers Bengaluru batter Devdutt Padikkal says opening alongside Virat Kohli in his debut IPL season helped him understand the art of constructing an innings, a lesson that continues to shape his approach in T20 cricket.

Padikkal, who burst onto the scene with RCB in the 2020 IPL, said watching Kohli operate from close quarters gave him invaluable insight early in his career.

“When I made my IPL debut with RCB in the 2020 season, I felt ready. I had a solid run of scores in domestic cricket behind me,” Padikkal said. “And batting with Virat Kohli was a huge help. At that age, watching him build an innings gave me so much clarity and understanding of how to construct a knock. That made a big difference in my growth,” he added. AGENCIES



Oscar Bruzon has completely transformed East Bengal

ISL

“I will say the same thing that I've been saying throughout the season -- I will not make any move till June

Oscar Bruzon

clarity over the next ISL season and had said the last round match (Friday's against Inter Kashi) would be his "last" at the club with lack of clarity about the next season.

But after scripting history with East Bengal, the Spaniard

hinted he is open for further discussions.

“If by June 1 the club has a proper plan, then I will be very happy to sit and talk,” he said.

“But if the club itself does not have clarity or planning after June, then it's not only difficult for me but for the whole group of players and coaches. Without planning, there cannot be discussions.”

Reflecting on the title-winning campaign, Bruzon credited the club management and support staff for backing his vision through uncertain times.

“We were working quietly behind the scenes. I am very happy and proud to leave as champions,” he said. “On behalf of the coaching staff, I want to thank Emami for their support and belief in the project.” AGENCIES

Animesh regains 100m NR from Gurindervir

RANCHI: The national record was smashed twice within minutes in men's 100m race as drama unfolded on the opening day of the National Senior Athletics Federation Competition here on Friday.

Gurindervir Singh of Reliance first shattered Animesh Kujur's 10-month-old national record of 10.18 seconds, clocking 10.17 seconds in the first semifinals heat. The new mark survived just a few minutes as Animesh ran 10.15 seconds in second semifinals heat to regain his record.

Both Gurindervir and Animesh will have another showdown in the final on Saturday.

Animesh, representing Odisha, went past the 2026 Commonwealth Games qualifying standard of 10.16 seconds set by the Athletics Federation of India (AFI).

“It's all about hard work,” said a jubilant

Animesh after the race.

Fierce competition was also witnessed at the jumping arena on the opening day.

Shaile Singh and Ancy Sojan, India's two heavyweights in women's long jump, battled it out to stay ahead of the other.

Eventually it was Ancy's day out as she won the event with a distance of 6.75m, bettering the meet record of 6.64m set by Shaile last year in Kochi. Ancy, who was representing Indian Navy, had a steady series of 6.47m, 6.56m, 6.69m, 6.75m, 6.68m and 6.57m.

Shaile, representing Anju Bobby George Sports Foundation, settled for the second place with a jump of 6.58m. Seema was the second athlete on day one to achieve CWG qualification mark in the women's discus throw. Her gold winning throw of 57.29m was better than the CWG qualification mark of 56.85m. AGENCIES

Can PBKS turn it around vs LSG?

LUCKNOW: Punjab Kings will need something spectacular to arrest a disastrous slide and keep their fading playoff hopes alive when they take on already-eliminated Lucknow Super Giants, in their IPL clash, here on Saturday.

Punjab's campaign has unravelled dramatically since their record 265-run chase against Delhi Capitals on April 25.

From remaining unbeaten till the midway stage and looking like genuine title contenders with six wins in seven matches, the last season's runners-up have crashed to six successive defeats, leaving their playoff hopes hanging by a thread.

Now placed fifth, Punjab not only need to beat LSG in their final league game here on Saturday but also depend on Sunday's double headers (MI vs RR and KKR vs DC) to earn a place in the playoff.

The Shreyas Iyer-led side would hope both Mumbai Indians and Kolkata Knight Riders lose their respective matches.

A Rajasthan Royals win over Mumbai would officially end Punjab's hopes, while a KKR victory over Delhi Capitals could bring net run rate into play.

At present, PBKS hold a slight edge in NRR over KKR.



Punjab Kings' captain Shreyas bats at nets

PFI

With six successive defeats, Punjab's playoff hopes are hanging by a thread

But before permutations come into the picture, Punjab first need to rediscover their form after a prolonged slump that has exposed flaws across departments.

Their aggressive top order of Priyansh Arya, Prabhsimran Singh and Cooper Connolly has failed to provide the explosive starts that defined the first half of their season.

Priyansh has managed just one fifty in his last seven innings and was dismissed for a duck in the previous game, while Prabhsimran too has

struggled for consistency with only one fifty in his last five innings. Connolly has shown glimpses but has not converted starts into substantial scores.

Having remained among the leaders in run-getters' tally, captain Iyer's returns too have dipped sharply during the losing streak, crossing fifty only once in the six defeats.

The middle order, which scripted the memorable chase against Delhi, has also lost momentum, while their bowling unit has leaked runs regularly at both ends of the innings.

Fielding has further hurt their campaign, with dropped catches proving costly in crucial moments. LSG, meanwhile, have endured a forgettable season and are out of playoff contention after managing just two wins in their last 10 matches. AGENCIES

Chaliha's run ends

KUALA LUMPUR: India's Ashmita Chaliha produced a spirited performance before going down narrowly to world No. 23 Line Højmark Kjaersfeldt of Denmark in the women's singles quarterfinals of the Malaysia Masters Super 500.

Returning after an eight-month rehabilitation following a medial meniscus tear in her right knee, the 71st-ranked Indian squandered a

hard-fought opening game advantage to lose 23-21 18-21 11-21 to the eighth seed in a contest lasting a little over an hour at the Axiata Arena.

Chaliha started brightly, opening up an 11-6 lead at the interval in the opening game.

Line clawed her way back after the break to narrow the gap to 13-12 and later moved ahead 19-18, but the Indian held her nerve. AGENCIES

‘Nothing is eternal’: Pep to leave City after decade-long reign

MANCHESTER: Pep Guardiola confirmed Friday what Manchester City fans had been fearing. The club's most successful manager is leaving, bringing to a close a trophy-laden, 10-year spell in which he established City as one of major forces in Europe and changed the face of English soccer.

Guardiola, who had a further year left on his City contract, will take charge of his final game against Aston Villa in the Premier League on Sunday.

“Don't ask me the reasons I'm leaving. There is no reason, but deep inside, I know it's my time,” Guardiola said. “Nothing is eternal, if it was, I would be here. Eternal will be the feeling, the people, the memories, the love I have for my Manchester City.”

City said Guardiola would



Under Pep, City became the first team to win four-straight EPL titles

AP

take up a role as global ambassador.

Enzo Maresca — the former Chelsea manager who was previously assistant to Guardiola at City — is the favorite

to take on the daunting task of filling Guardiola's shoes after a decade of unprecedented dominance.

Since joining City in the summer of 2016, Guardiola led

the Abu Dhabi-backed team to six Premier League titles and the Champions League for the first time in 2023.

He won 17 major trophies in all, including a domestic double this season of the English League Cup and the FA Cup. He has won 35 major titles across his coaching career including his time at Barcelona and Bayern Munich.

City was far his longest job in management, having never previously stayed more than four years in a role.

He set new benchmarks, with City becoming the first team to win four-straight English league titles and the first to amass 100 points in a single season in 2018. The following year City became the first team to win the domestic treble of the league, FA Cup and League Cup in the same season. AGENCIES

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Ltd.
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
1st Floor Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Teibandha, Raipur (C.G.)
Pin code- 492006 Phone: 0771-6621000
[Website: www.csidcraipur.com](http://www.csidcraipur.com), Email: info@csidcraipur.com, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

Notice Inviting Request for Proposal

No CSIDC/IPPD/2025-26/	Date: 22/05/2026
NIT No.	Title
02/26	RFP for Empanelment of Agencies for conducting MSEs on Alternate Financing Methods, SME Exchange and Industry & Bankers Connect Programmes- 2 nd Call

The Request for Proposal (RFP) documents and other detail can be downloaded from the web portal <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from 25-05-2026 and shall be submitted online only.

Amendment in RFP, if any, will be only published on the e-Proc website and shall not be published in any newspaper. The last date for online submission of RFP through e-Proc is 16-06-2026 at 4.00 pm.

The interested Agencies for online submission of RFP may contact E-Proc Helpdesk operated by Mjunction Services Ltd. They may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (From 9.00 AM to 11.00 PM) (Thereafter press 2 for CG e-Proc) or can email helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in.

samvad 47912/4

Managing Director

समाहरणालय, कैमूर
(मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद शाखा)
वाहन नीलामी हेतु अति अल्पकालीन आम सूचना
(बिहार मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम 2016 एवं संशोधित अधिनियम 2018 के सुसंगत प्रावधानों के तहत राज्यसात किये गये वाहनों की (अल्पकालीन सार्वजनिक नीलामी सूचना)
एतद् द्वारा सर्व साधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि कैमूर जिलासर्गंत विभिन्न थाना काण्डों / उत्पाद वादों में निम्न वाहनों का बिहार मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम 2016 एवं संशोधित अधिनियम 2018 के सुसंगत प्रावधानों के तहत विभिन्न अधिहरण वादों में न्यायालय समाहर्त—सह—जिला दण्डाधिकारी, कैमूर (भमुआ) एवं उनके द्वारा प्राधिकृत न्यायालयों द्वारा राज्यसात (Confiscate) किये गये वाहनों की सार्वजनिक नीलामी (Public Auction) जहाँ है, जैसे है” के रूप में समाहर्त, कैमूर द्वारा गदित नीलामी समिति के द्वारा 11.00 बजे पूर्वाह्न से समाहरणालय स्थित सभाकक्ष, कैमूर (भमुआ) में निम्न प्रकार से की जायेगी।

आवेदन प्राप्त करने की तिथि		वाहन नीलामी की तिथि		आवेदन प्राप्त करने का स्थान	
29.05.2026	नीलामी की पहली तिथि	30.05.2026	कार्यालय अधीक्षक मद्यनिषेध, कैमूर		
01.06.2026	नीलामी की दुसरी तिथि	03.06.2026			
04.06.2026	नीलामी की तीसरी तिथि	06.06.2026			

दिल्ली अंतर्गत प्रेस विज्ञप्ति हेतु वाहनों की विवरणी

क्र 0	थाना	थाना काण्ड संख्या	वाहन प्रकार	निबंधन सं0	वाहन स्वामी का नाम एवं पता	अधिहरण वाद सं0/ अधिहरण आदेश तिथि	मुल्यांकित राशि	SOP के आलोक में आती नीलामी का 10% कम राशि दिनांक	SOP के आलोक में आती नीलामी का 10% कम राशि दिनांक	SOP के आलोक में नौवी नीलामी का 10% कम राशि दिनांक	SOP के आलोक में दसवी नीलामी का 10% कम राशि दिनांक	
1	मद्यनिषेध	701/24	HYUNDAI CAR-	Rg.No-DL10CA-9097 Ch.No- MALBB51BLBM30 6899 Eng.No- G4LABM682288	श्री ब्रजेश रावत, पौ-जयप्रकाश, सा0-हाउस न0 151, गली न0 54 एस0 ब्लॉक, ई 03, मोहनदाबाद, मन् बदनपुर, जैतपुर साउथ दिल्ली	708/24 09.01.2025	200000	94478	85030	8503	76527 03.06.26	68874 06.06.26

विस्तृत जानकारी कैमूर जिला के वेबसाईट www.kaimur.nic.in या अधीक्षक मद्यनिषेध, कैमूर से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
अधीक्षक मद्य निषेध, कैमूर (भमुआ)
नीलामी की विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR- 003924 (Excise) 2026-27

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार।

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Said@Sittu@Sahid, S/o: Bulbul, R/o: Gali No. 01, Village Gamri, Bhajanpura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 507/20, U/s: 392/411/34 IPC, Police Station Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Said@Sittu@Sahid** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Said@Sittu@Sahid** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Said@Sittu@Sahid of Police Station Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Pankaj Rai
JMFC-01, North East,
5th Floor, Room No. 73,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/6731/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Fazal S/o Kamrul Hassan R/o Footpath Meena Bazar, Jama Masjid, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 249/19, U/S 380/411 IPC, PS Kotwali, North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Fazal** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Fazal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Fazal** the said accused of **FIR No. 249/19, U/S 380/411 IPC, PS Kotwali, North Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.06.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Sayesha Chadha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-08,
Central Distt., Court No.-272,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/6723/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Vijay Kumar @ Khauf S/o Chhotelal, R/o E-86, Laxmi Park, Nangloi, Delhi-41**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 472/2020, U/S 454/380/ 411/34 IPC, PS Nangloi, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vijay Kumar @ Khauf** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vijay Kumar @ Khauf** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **Vijay Kumar @ Khauf** the said accused of **FIR No. 472/2020, U/S 454/380/411/34 IPC, PS Nangloi, Outer Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Renu
DP/6707/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

Judicial Magistrate First Class-10 (West),
Court No.-345, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa, S/o: Kishan Lal, R/o: K-12, Gali No. 2, 25 Feet Road, Chanakya Place Part-2, Dabri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 610/2024, U/s 110(3)(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S.: Janakpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 610/2024, U/s 110(3)(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S.: Janakpuri, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Harjot Singh Aujla
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-11 (South-West)
Room No. 05, Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/6687/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.: 2420262027 Date : 20.05.2026

E-Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering) /North Central Railway /Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tender on prescribed form for the following works up to 13:30 hrs. On 15.06.2026 The details of the tenders are as under:

S.N.: 1. Tender No.: 79, Name of Work: Extension of Old Washing lines at Kanpur central under DEN/V/PRYJ.

Approx. Cost of Work: ₹ 65,70,367.67 Earnest money: ₹ 1,31,400.00

Completion Period: 08 Months | Date of Opening of tender: 15.06.2026

S.N.: 2. Tender No.: 80, Name of Work: Through Rail Renewal (Primary& Secondary), Complete Track renewal (Secondary) and other associated Pway work in section & various yards under DEN/V/PRYJ.

Approx. Cost of Work: ₹ 6,26,13,156.70 Earnest money: ₹ 12,52,300.00

Completion Period: 15 Months | Date of Opening of tender: 15.06.2026

Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: For S.N.: 1 & 2:- Any P. way work.

Note:-(1) Tender on line can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs. on. 15.06.2026. (2) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.ireps.gov.in up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e 15.06.2026. 1146/26 (MG)

North central railways @ @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

For & on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Coaching), Prayagraj North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites OPEN E-Tenders in prescribed forms, from reputed contractors with adequate experience and financial capability for the under mentioned work up to Date & time of closing of tender on GeM website-

GeM Bid No.: GEM/2026/B/7565120

Name of work: Mechanized Laundry Service for Railways (BOOT Model): Setting up of Mechanized Laundry for Linen washing on Boot Model at CNB Coaching depot for Ten Years.

Tender system: Two Packet System Tender Value: ₹ 70,71,41,553.00/-

EMD : ₹ 36,85,710.00/- Cost of E- Tender Form: Nil

Period of Work:10 Years | Date of publishing on GeM website: 20.05.2026

Bid End Date & Time: 11.06.2026 & 15:00 Hrs.

Note :- 1. The complete information along with tender booklet of above E-Tenders will be available/ uploaded since Date of publishing on GeM website and shall be remained on Website www.GeM.gov.in on the due date of tender closing. 2. Bids other than the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with GeM website. 3. Document being attached should be signed by the tenderer. 4. E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. 5. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of GeM may be approached. 6. Online E-Tender can be submitted up to Date & time of closing of tender. 7. JV bidders are allowed to participate in instant tender. 1152/26 (DG)

North central railways @ @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

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North central railways @ @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited

Regd. & Corp. office : 1101, Sharda Terraces, Plot 65, Sector - 11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai - 400614. CIN: 165923MHZ008PLC261472.

Under Section 13(2) of The Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002

Whereas the undersigned is the Authorised officer of the M/s. Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd. ("SFSBL") under Securitisation And Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued Demand Notices under Section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the following Borrower(s), Co-Borrower(s), Guarantor(s) to discharge in full their liability to the Company by making payment of entire outstanding including up to date interest, cost and charges within 60 days from the date of respective Notices issued and the publication of the Notice as given below and in way of alternate service upon you, As security for due repayment of the loan, the following Secured Asset (s) have been mortgaged to SFSBL by the said Borrower(s), Co-Borrower(s), Guarantor(s) respectively.

Name of Borrower/Co-Borrower/Guarantor	Date of Demand Notice	14.05.2026
237000000005 & 237000000006, 1.MR. INTERKHAM ALAM S/O FAKRE ALAM, 2.MRS. NAHID PRAVEEN W/O MR. INTERKHAM ALAM	Date of NPA	06.05.2026
	Total Outstanding Amount in Rs.	Rs. 92,56,763.71/- & Rs.58,302.73/- as on 07.05.2026

Description Of Secured Asset(S) /Immovable Property (ies) : ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCELS OF UNIT NO.1C, PLOT NO. C-660, GROUND FLOOR, NEW FRIENDS COLONY, NEW DELHI-110025 TOTAL AREA 800 SQ. FT. BOUNDRIES : EAST : 15 WIDE SERVICE LANE, SOUTH: PLOT NO.661, WEST : 80 WIDE ROAD, NORTH : TOT LOT.

Date : 23.05.2026, Place : NEW DELHI Authorised Officer, Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited

COURT NOTICE

(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
{UNDER GUARDIAN AND WARD ACT}
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Ashutosh Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Hansi
GJ/7/2026

1-Nitika, 2-Jasmeen, 3-Paridhi, 4-Khushmeet minors through their mother Kusum wd/o Rajender s/o Amar Lal R/o Village Gurana, Hansi as natural guardian
Vs.
General Public/Relatives
Application under section 8 of Hindu Marriage and Guardianship Act 1956 for permission to sell 193 owned by minors, petitioners 53/1933 Part, R.No. 739/1615, Khatouni No. 953, R Bakdor, 53.33 Marle, Baruje Jamabandi 2021-2022, Vakeel Manoj Guvane, Tehsil District Hansi, Bar Bina-e-Shahadati Tohri Taqriiri Har Varni.

CNR No. HRHSAO-000555-2026
Next Date: 28-07-2026

NOTICE TO:
General Public/Relatives
General Public
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s) / respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 28-07-2026 at 10:00 am.
For details logon to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distric_notice&district=Misror
Sd/- Sh. Ashutosh Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Hansi
Dated 20.05.2026

RAIL COACH FACTORY, KAPURTHALA

On-line Tenders are invited by PCMM, RCF on behalf of President of India for following items:-

Sr. No.	Tender No. / Due Date	Description	Qty.(Nos./ Sets)	EMD (Rs.)
1.	02261204/04.06.2026	Harness of Underframe & Roof Arrangement for LHB EOG Second AC Chair Car Coache		439960/-
2.	13265120/10.06.2026	Procurement of Oil Chiller Unit and Water Chiller Units PL No./Item Code: 6557002212331	01 Nos	69510/-
3.	16261007A/01.06.2026	Blast Grade Garnet for Robotic Sand Blasting Plant	236 MT	1,18,000/-
4.	17251698A/05.06.2026	Set of Seat and Berth for LHB SLR Hog Coaches (31-Seater)	76 Sets	16,82,570/-
5.	17261161/04.06.2026	Set of Seat and Berth for LHB SCN Coaches	126 Sets	
	17261161/04.06.2026	1. Supply & Installation of One Coach set of AC Duct Complete for Vande Bharat MC/NDTEC Coaches.	100 Set	
		2. Supply and Installation of One Coach set of AC Duct complete for Vande Bharat DTC Coaches.	20 Set	7,26,000/-
		3. Supply and Installation of One Coach set of AC Duct complete for Vande Bharat TC Coaches.	40 Set	
6.	05261024/18.06.2026	Underframe Complete for VB Metro NDTCTC	04 Nos	10,52,460/-
		Underframe Complete for VB Metro TC	08 Nos	
		Underframe Complete for VB Metro DTC	04 Nos	
		Underframe Complete for VB Metro MC	16 Nos	
7.	05261279A/22.06.2026	Set of Carline for LHB AC Tier Amrit Bharat 3.0 with Flat Roof PL No. 33534470	100 Set	173860/-
8.	0261025/12.06.2026	110V,120 AH, VRLA SMF Battery Set	100 Set	3,62,370/-
9.	01261034/11.06.2026	Set of Axle End Cover For LHB Bogies	1177 Set	111530/-
10.	01261035/22.06.2026	Anti Roll Bar Bracket	5244 Nos	138490/-
11.	05261033/19.06.2026	Crash Buffer for Vande Bharat	24 Nos 280 Nos	819400/-

1. For details and making On-line bids, visit Website <http://ireps.gov.in>. Drawings/specifications, wherever required can be downloaded from RCF Website <http://www.rcf.indianrailways.gov.in>. Class II/b digital signature certificate required for on-line bidding, can be obtained from licensed certifying agencies listed at <http://www.cce.gov.in>

2. Tenders will close at 14.25 HRS. on due date and tender will be opened at 14.30 HRS. Tenders Sr. No.1 to 7 will be open at RCF Kapurthala and Sr. No. 8 to 11 will be opened at Tilak Bridge, New Delhi. 3. For queries, contact IREPS Help desk at 011-24102855, 011-24105180 or RCF help desk at 011-23378658.

Note: GST Number of RCF is 03AAAGM0289C1ZT. All the suppliers are advised to quote this in dispatch documents for the supplies made by them.

PCMM
No. : 17-S/2026-27 Dated: 22.05.2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa, S/o: Kishan Lal, R/o: K-12, Gali No. 2, 25 Feet Road, Chanakya Place Part-2, Dabri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 610/2024, U/s 110(3)(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S.: Janakpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 610/2024, U/s 110(3)(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S.: Janakpuri, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Harjot Singh Aujla
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-11 (South-West)
Room No. 05, Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/6687/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-120

Approx Cost	Earnest Money	Date of closing Tender
14881335.08	297600.00	16.06.2026 at 15:00 hrs.

Description of work : Jhansi Division-- Provision for Track Machine staff Rest Room at CGN and pathway at various stations under ADEN/HQ-1/JHS jurisdiction.

Date of Completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 12 Months. • Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 16.06.2026. • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1148/26 (D)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that my clients, Smt. Sonia W/o Sh. Rajender Kumar and Sh. Nikhil S/o Sh. Rajender Kumar, both R/o RZ-C-56, Najafganj Park, Najafganj, New Delhi-110043, have voluntarily severed all relations with Sh. Rajender Kumar due to personal reasons. Henceforth, my clients shall have no concern, claim, right, interest or share whatsoever in any movable or immovable properties, assets, liabilities or obligations of Sh. Rajender Kumar, present or future. Any person dealing with Sh. Rajender Kumar shall do so at his/her own risk, cost & responsibility. My clients shall not be liable or responsible for any act, deed, transaction, debt or liability incurred by Sh. Rajender Kumar.

PRAVEEN RASTOGI (Advocate)
ENRL No.D-244/06

COURT NOTICE

(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
{UNDER GUARDIAN AND WARD ACT}
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Ashutosh Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Hansi
GJ/7/2026

1-Nitika, 2-Jasmeen, 3-Paridhi, 4-Khushmeet minors through their mother Kusum wd/o Rajender s/o Amar Lal R/o Village Gurana, Hansi as natural guardian
Vs.
General Public/Relatives
Application under section 8 of Hindu Marriage and Guardianship Act 1956 for permission to sell 193 owned by minors, petitioners 53/1933 Part, R.No. 739/1615, Khatouni No. 953, R Bakdor, 53.33 Marle, Baruje Jamabandi 2021-2022, Vakeel Manoj Guvane, Tehsil District Hansi, Bar Bina-e-Shahadati Tohri Taqriiri Har Varni.

CNR No. HRHSAO-000555-2026
Next Date: 28-07-2026

NOTICE TO:
General Public/Relatives
General Public
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s) / respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 28-07-2026 at 10:00 am.
For details logon to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distric_notice&district=Misror
Sd/- Sh. Ashutosh Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Hansi
Dated 20.05.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that my clients, Smt. Sonia W/o Sh. Rajender Kumar and Sh. Nikhil S/o Sh. Rajender Kumar, both R/o RZ-C-56, Najafganj Park, Najafganj, New Delhi-110043, have voluntarily severed all relations with Sh. Rajender Kumar due to personal reasons. Henceforth, my clients shall have no concern, claim, right, interest or share whatsoever in any movable or immovable properties, assets, liabilities or obligations of Sh. Rajender Kumar, present or future. Any person dealing with Sh. Rajender Kumar shall do so at his/her own risk, cost & responsibility. My clients shall not be liable or responsible for any act, deed, transaction, debt or liability incurred by Sh. Rajender Kumar.

PRAVEEN RASTOGI (Advocate)
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GJ/7/2026

1-Nitika, 2-Jasmeen, 3-Paridhi, 4-Khushmeet minors through their mother Kusum wd/o Rajender s/o Amar Lal R/o Village Gurana, Hansi as natural guardian
Vs.
General Public/Relatives
Application under section 8 of Hindu Marriage and Guardianship Act 1956 for permission to sell 193 owned by minors, petitioners 53/1933 Part, R.No. 739/1615, Khatouni No. 953, R Bakdor, 53.33 Marle, Baruje Jamabandi 2021-2022, Vakeel Manoj Guvane, Tehsil District Hansi, Bar Bina-e-Shahadati Tohri Taqriiri Har Varni.

CNR No. HRHSAO-000555-2026
Next Date: 28-07-2026

NOTICE TO:
General Public/Relatives
General Public
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s) / respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 28-07-2026 at 10:00 am.
For details logon to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distric_notice&district=Misror
Sd/- Sh. Ashutosh Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Hansi
Dated 20.05.2026

COURT NOTICE

(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
{UNDER GUARDIAN AND WARD ACT}
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Ashutosh Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Hansi
GJ/7/2026

1-Nitika, 2-Jasmeen, 3-Paridhi, 4-Khushmeet minors through their mother Kusum wd/o Rajender s/o Amar Lal R/o Village Gurana, Hansi as natural guardian
Vs.
General Public/Relatives
Application under section 8 of Hindu Marriage and Guardianship Act 1956 for permission to sell 193 owned by minors, petitioners 53/1933 Part, R.No. 739/1615, Khatouni No. 953, R Bakdor, 53.33 Marle, Baruje Jamabandi 2021-2022, Vakeel Manoj Guvane, Tehsil District Hansi, Bar Bina-e-Shahadati Tohri Taqriiri Har Varni.

CNR No. HRHSAO-000555-2026
Next Date: 28-07-2026

NOTICE TO:
General Public/Relatives
General Public
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s) / respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 28-07-2026 at 10:00 am.
For details logon to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distric_notice&district=Misror
Sd/- Sh. Ashutosh Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division)
Hansi
Dated 20.05.2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa, S/o: Kishan Lal, R/o: K-12, Gali No. 2, 25 Feet Road, Chanakya Place Part-2, Dabri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 610/2024, U/s 110(3)(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S.: Janakpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Nitin @ Saurabh @ Pasa** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 610/2024, U/s 110(3)(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, P.S.: Janakpuri, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Harjot Singh Aujla
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-11 (South-West)
Room No. 05, Dwarka Court, New Delhi

DP/6687/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

No. Q-15014/01/2023-CPA

Government of India
Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change
2nd floor, Prithvi Wing, Indira Paryavaran Bhawan, Jor Bagh Road, New Delhi
Subject: Appointment of two (2) Full-time (Technical) Member in the Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR and Adjoining Areas -reg.

Applications are invited from eligible candidates for selection and appointment of two (2) Full-time Member (Technical) to the Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR and Adjoining Areas, Delhi.

2. The Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR and Adjoining Areas (CAQM) is a Statutory Body established under the Commission for Air Quality Management in National Capital Region and Adjoining Areas Act, 2021 (29 of 2021). The Member shall be a full-time incumbent.

The detailed advertisement is available on the website of the Ministry at <https://moef.gov.in> and website of the CAQM at <https://caqm.nic.in>

(P V Pillai)
Director (CP)
Tele ph. 011-20819195
Email: v.pazhaniyandi@gov.in

CBC 13101/11/0003/2627

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

Corporate Office : Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra- 400 028

POSSESSION NOTICE (As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL) under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, Demand Notice(s) issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. for an amount as mentioned herein under with interest thereon.

The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Loan Account No./Branch	Brief details of secured assets	Date of Demand Notice & Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Possession Taken Date
1.	Prem Shankar Tiwari/ Alka/ DELHI-000728/ Delhi	Built-Up Second Floor (Without Roof Rights) of Property Bearing Pvt. No. 1337, Area Measuring 56 Sq. Yds., Out of Kharsa No. 44/23 & 24, Situated in The Area of Village Burari, Delhi, Abadi Known As Gali No. 5, B-Block, Baba Colony, Burari Delhi- East: Other's Property, West: Other's Property, North Other's Property, South Road 14 Ft. Wide	28-Feb-2026/ Rs. 18,71,270/- Rupees Eighteen Lakh Seventy One Thousand Two Hundred Seventy Only.	20th May 2026
2.	Ravindra Ravindra/ Shivi/ NOI-NHL-000942 & NOI-NHL-001000/ Noida	Residential House No. 90, Area Measuring 168.06 Sq. Meters, Out of Kharsa No. 1914, Situated in The Village Pabla Begamabad, Pargana Bagpat, Tehsil & Distt. Bagpat, U.P. Boundaries:- North-Plot of First Party South- Rasta 22 Ft. Wide, East- Rajkiew Degree Collage, West- Rasta 20 Feet Wide.	28-Feb-2026/ Rs. 11,29,714/- Rupees Eleven Lakh Twenty Nine Thousand Seven Hundred Fourteen Only & Rs. 8,14,508/- Rupees Eight Lakh Fourteen Thousand Five Hundred Eight Only.	20th May 2026

Date: May 23, 2026, Place: Delhi, Bagpat Sd/- Authorized Officer, Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

NORTHERN RAILWAY

NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION

Senior Divisional Commercial Manager/FS, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, in terms of Railway Board letter no. 2022/TC(FM)/10/04 dated 13.06.2022, invites bids through e-Auction (www.ireps.gov.in) for the contract of Parking cum management of vehicles (as per type and class as mentioned in the additional special conditions) and Stacking of Parcels at Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station (NZM) towards Bhogal Side, near Platform No. 1, Okhla End with area measuring of 930.74 square meters for a period of five years, through E-Auction in IREPS module as per detail and schedule given below:-

S.No. 1, Date & time of e-Auction 05.06.2026 at 11:00 hrs. Assets to be auctioned The contract of Parking cum management of vehicles (as per type and class as mentioned in the additional special conditions) and Stacking of Parcels at Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station (NZM) towards Bhogal Side, near Platform No.1, Okhla End with area measuring of 930.74 square meters for a period of five years through E-Auction in IREPS module

Important notes: 1. For more information, requirement and various aspects regarding these e-Auctions, interested bidders are advised to visit https://www.ireps.gov.in/html/helpdesk/learning_center.html. (E-Auction leasing section). 2. Earnest Money Deposit (EMD): 10% of the total contractual bid value to be deposited online during the auction. EMD of the successful bidder will be retained as Security Deposit. 3. Railway Administration reserves the full and absolute rights to short terminate these contracts at any point of time and/or for taking any decision regarding the discontinuation/continuation of these contracts with modified/additional terms and conditions depending upon the situations. 1722/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-HQ-2026-117

Description of work: Annual Sectional contract for repairs & maintenance work and supply of materials under ADEN/HQ-I/JHS for year 2026-27 (A) Zone No.-2B-2 AC Loco Shed (B) Zone no-2B-3 Diesel shed (C) Zone no-2B-4 C&W (ROH Depot).

Approx Cost : ₹ 12000000.00 Earnest Money: ₹ 240000.00

Date of closing Tender: 17.06.2026 at 15.00 hrs.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 12 Months

• Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 17.06.2026 • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in, 1149/26 FA

North central railways @ @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAIL



‘WORKING ON SPIDER-MAN: BRAND NEW DAY WAS LIKE A DREAM’

‘I get to go to work every day with my best friend, the person that I love,’ says Zendaya about Tom Holland

The film, directed by Destin Daniel Cretton, is set to be released in theatres on July 31

Hollywood star Zendaya said working on ‘Spider-Man: Brand New Day’ alongside actor and partner Tom Holland was a dream and felt like coming home. ‘Spider-Man: Brand New Day’ marks the fourth film for the actress, who has previously featured in ‘Spider-Man: Homecoming’ (2017), ‘Spider-Man: Far From Home’ (2019) and ‘Spider-Man: No Way Home’, which was released in 2021. The film is directed by Destin Daniel Cretton and is set to be released in theatres on July 31. “‘Spider-Man’ was a dream; I get to go to work every day with my best friend, the person that I love... We bring our dogs to work; it’s like a family affair. We grew up on those movies! It’s like coming home,” the ‘Dune’ star told ‘Elle’ in an interview. The actress, who will also feature with Holland in Christopher Nolan’s ‘The Odyssey’, said she won’t have any scenes with him in an epic action, adding that it allowed



her to watch her co-star on set. “I could have cried. I was so proud,” she said. The film is set to release on July 17 and features Zendaya as Athena, the Greek goddess of wisdom and protector of Odysseus and Holland as Telemachus, the loyal son of Odysseus. Zendaya and Holland dated for over five years prior to their engagement in December 2024. They reportedly got married earlier this year. When asked about the same, the actress said she won’t talk about the topic. “No, I’m not going to do that. They’re always searching for something,” she said.

‘Emily in Paris’ to end with season six

Lily Collins shared the news with a video posted on Netflix’s social media pages

Streaming service ‘Netflix’ announced that its fan-favourite series ‘Emily in Paris’ will conclude with its upcoming sixth season, which has started production in Greece.

The show’s lead star, Lily Collins, shared the news with a video posted on the streamer’s social media pages. “Season 6 will bring you everything you love about the show and serve as the final chapter in Emily’s adventure of a lifetime,” Collins said. Created by Darren Star, ‘Emily in Paris’ features Collins as an aspiring marketing executive, Emily Cooper, who moves to Paris to provide an American point of view to a French marketing firm. In Paris, she tries to overcome challenges in her work, love life and friendships. “Making ‘Emily in Paris’ with this extraordinary cast and crew has been the trip of a lifetime. As we embark on the final season, I am so grateful to

The show has started production in Greece

‘Netflix,’ ‘Paramount’ and most importantly, the fans who have taken this incredible journey with us,” said Star. The show has been a major performer for ‘Netflix’ as its earlier seasons collectively spent 32 weeks on the platform’s global top 10 English-language TV chart and reached the number one spot in 90 countries. The cast includes Philippine Leroy-Beaulieu, Ashley Park, Lucas Bravo, Samuel Arnold, Bruno Gouery, William Abadie, Lucien Laviscount, Eugenio Franceschini, Thalia Besson, Paul Forman, Arnaud Binard, Minnie Driver, Bryan Greenberg and Michele Laroque. The series is produced by ‘Paramount Television Studios,’ ‘Darren Star Productions’ and ‘Jax Media.’



I have been a huge fan of Shakun Batra’s work: Radhikka

Radhikka Madan is set to star in ‘Lust Stories 3’. Directed by Shakun Batra, the segment will see her starring opposite Ali Fazal as the male lead. Ahead of its premiere, the actress opened up about how she bagged the role. Speaking to ‘Hindustan Times’, Radhikka opened up about getting on board for Shakun Batra’s segment in ‘Lust Stories 3’. She revealed, “I have been a huge fan of Shakun Batra’s work and when I got to know about the film, I begged for an audition for ‘Lust Stories 3’ and by God’s grace, I got it.” Radhikka has proved her mettle in her previous projects, but in the same interview, the actress shared that she cannot afford to give an average performance. She added, “There are a lot of people who are there in line



Radhikka Madan is to be seen starring in ‘Lust Stories 3’

for any role. So, if I give an average performance, I don’t have anybody who will be like, ‘It’s okay; do this or do that; we’ll give you something else’. Every work is a do-or-die

situation for me. If I need to survive, I need to kill it; otherwise, I can’t.” During the conversation, Radhikka stated that she has stood in lines and worked hard to reach where she is now. The actress added that she is at a point where she can choose from projects that are offered to her. She added, “If there is some other project for which people are not thinking of me, I beg for an audition and I’m very comfortable with it. I don’t have that ego. I have a problem when I don’t get the opportunity to audition, when I’m crossed off just on the basis of my last name. If I am rejected after an audition, I can still sleep peacefully, as I know I gave my 100 per cent. If I have to stand in queues, I have no shame in it. I believe I’m an actor and I’ll do whatever it takes.”

AGENCIES

‘SPIDER-NOIR’ IS ABOUT TO JOIN THE WEB!

Nicolas Cage’s upcoming ‘Spider-Noir’ feels like such an interesting shift

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Spider-Man has always been one of the few superheroes who can somehow fit into almost any world and still feel like Spider-Man. Over the years, he has been a teenage underdog, a hopeless romantic, a reluctant mentor and even the centre of an entire multiverse. But no matter what the version, there is usually something familiar about him, whether it’s New York, youth, awkward humour or that friendly neighbourhood feeling audiences have come to expect. That is why Nicolas Cage’s upcoming ‘Spider-Noir’ on ‘Prime Video’ feels like such an interesting shift. Suddenly, Spider-Man is older, moodier and stepping into a world of crime and mystery instead of school hallways and first loves. It is a very different side of the friendly-neighbourhood Spidey that we all know and love. This feels like the perfect time to look back at the versions that audiences have loved over the years.

TOBEY MAGUIRE’S PETER PARKER



Tobey Maguire’s Spider-Man remains the emotional foundation for an entire generation. His Peter Parker was awkward, sincere and painfully earnest in a way that made the superhero fantasy feel deeply personal. He was never trying to be the coolest person in the room and that became his strength.

Maguire’s version captured the loneliness of being Spider-Man better than most. Every victory came with a cost, every choice seemed to pull him further away from a normal life, and every act of heroism felt

rooted in sacrifice. For many viewers, this is the Spider-Man who made the mask feel human.

ANDREW GARFIELD’S PETER PARKER



Andrew Garfield brought a rawer, more restless energy to Peter Parker. His Spider-Man was sharper, more wounded and more openly emotional, with a sense of humour that often felt like a defence mechanism. There was always a feeling that this Peter was trying to outrun grief before it caught up with him.

What has helped Garfield’s version age well is the vulnerability he brought to the role. His performance found the romance, guilt and heartbreak inside Peter Parker, especially after Gwen Stacy’s death. Garfield’s emotional hold on the character is something that still stays with the audience today.

TOM HOLLAND’S PETER PARKER

Tom Holland’s Spider-Man arrived in an era shaped by the MCU, team-ups, mentors and universe-level



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stakes. His Peter Parker began as an eager teenager desperate to prove himself, which gave the character a lighter, more nervous charm. But what makes Holland’s run compelling is how much that innocence is slowly stripped away. Across his appearances, he moves from wide-eyed kid to someone who understands the isolation that comes with the mask. By the end of ‘No Way Home’, his Spider-Man feels closer to the classic idea of Peter Parker than ever, someone who is alone, anonymous and still choosing to do the right thing.

SHAMEIK MOORE’S MILES MORALES



Miles Morales is the version that proved Spider-Man didn’t need to be bound to Peter Parker forever. Introduced to many audiences through ‘Spider-Man: Into the Spider-Verse’, Miles brought a completely new energy to the character and reminded people just how much room there still was to reinvent Spider-Man. Voiced by Shameik Moore, Miles felt vibrant, emotional and entirely his own, while the film’s animation gave the character a style and identity that felt completely new.

What makes Miles work so well is

that he is not trying to replace anyone. He carries the pressure of the ‘Spider-Man’ legacy, but his journey is really about finding the confidence to define the mask for himself. In many ways, Miles is the most future-facing version of Spider-Man on screen.

NICOLAS CAGE’S SPIDER-NOIR



Nicolas Cage’s Spider-Man Noir was already one of the most distinctive characters in Into the Spider-Verse. He was stylish, theatrical and deliberately out of step with everyone around him. But Spider-Noir gives the character a new kind of importance. By bringing ‘Spider-Noir’ into live action, the series takes Spider-Man in a different direction. Instead of another coming-of-age story, this version leans into crime, mystery and a hero who has already been carrying the weight of the mask for years. That is what makes Cage’s return so interesting from a franchise perspective. ‘Spider-Noir’ is not just expanding the Spider-Verse; it is testing how far the Spider-Man identity can evolve. It shows that Spider-Man doesn’t always need to exist within familiar coming-of-age territory built around youth and romance. Spider-Man can also be a damaged man in a trench coat, walking through a city that has already taken too much from him. With the series arriving on ‘Prime Video’ on May 27 and giving audiences the choice to watch in both ‘Authentic Black and White’ and ‘True-Hue Full Colour,’ ‘Spider-Noir’ already feels like one of the most distinctive superhero releases of the year.

Lupita dismisses racist backlash over her casting in ‘The Odyssey’

Lupita Nyong’o, who responded to the racist online backlash over her casting as Helen of Troy in Christopher Nolan’s upcoming epic ‘The Odyssey’, said the film is a mythological story whose diverse cast reflects the world it seeks to portray. In ‘The Odyssey’, Nolan’s follow-up to the 2023 blockbuster ‘Oppenheimer’, Nyong’o essays Helen of Troy, the legendary Greek figure famed for her beauty whose elopement with Paris, prince of Troy, is believed to have sparked the Trojan War. After Nolan confirmed that the Oscar winner has been cast as Helen, the director and the actor both faced a barrage of criticism, with some commentators, including tech magnate Elon Musk, arguing the role should have gone to a white actor. Nyong’o, best known for

Nyong’o essays Helen of Troy, the legendary Greek figure famed for her beauty

her performances in the movies ‘12 Years a Slave’ and ‘Black Panther’, dismissed the backlash in an interview with ‘Elle’ Magazine. “This is a mythological story. I’m very supportive of Chris’ intention with it and with the version of this story that he is telling. Our cast is representative of the world. I’m not spending my time thinking of a defence. The criticism will exist whether I engage with it or not,” she said.

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